CHENNAI - THURSDAY - OCTOBER 8, 2026

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Drove **10.8%** GMV growth with **YouTube full-funnel ads**

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Maximise ROI this festive season



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Drive festive business growth

YouTube

#1

YouTube ad placements in India rank **#1 in attention** versus ad placements on streaming and other online platforms[1]





1.98x

YouTube ROI was **1.98x** of linear TV and **1.94x** of OTT platforms[2]

Maximise ROI
this festive season



Sources:
1. Adelaide IN attention meta analysis commissioned by Google in 2026
2. Commissioned Analytic Edge MMM Meta Analysis 2021-2025

*Some elements edited or created with AI

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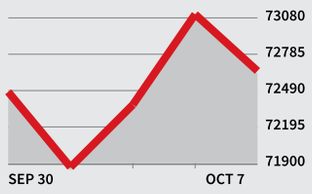
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SENSEX 72638.70 (-429.11)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	22603.05	-173.05
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	19.28	-0.12
US Dollar (in ₹)	96.77	+0.35
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	147175.00	-704
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	220866.00	-1954

EL NINO EFFECT.

A warmer September, deficit rain and below-normal night temperatures cause tomato prices to more than double **p10**



TECHNOPHILE.

With Zeiss optics and flagship hardware, the Vivo X Fold 6 delivers a great experience **p4**

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RBI turns hawkish, raises repo rate by 25 bps to 5.5%

U-TURN. MPC changes stance to 'calibrated tightening' on rising inflation expectation

K Ram Kumar
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India's rate-setting panel, after a gap of nearly four years, kicked off a fresh rate-hike cycle on Wednesday. The central bank raised the repo rate by 25 basis points (bps) to 5.5 per cent amid rising inflationary pressures driven by food and fuel prices, even as the economic momentum remained broad-based.

Citing concerns that inflation and its outlook were no longer as benign as they were last year, the six-member Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) unanimously voted for the rate increase, a move that economists and bankers had seen coming. The surprise element, though, was the change in the MPC's policy stance from "neutral" to "calibrated tightening".

Navigating uncertainty

Growth projections bumped up

Real GDP growth projections (in %)

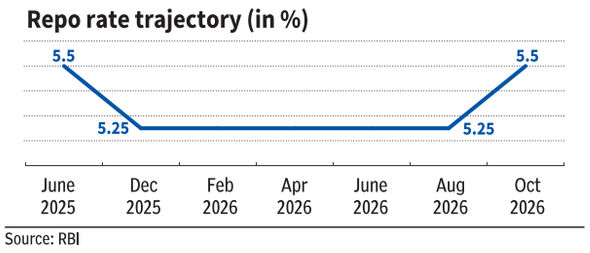
	August MPC	October MPC
Q2 2026-27	6.4	7.2
Q3 2026-27	6.5	6.9
Q4 2026-27	6.8	6.8
2026-27	6.7	7.1
Q1 2027-28	-	7.1

Inflation, a pain point

CPI inflation projections (in %)

	August MPC	October MPC
Q2 2026-27	4.7	4.9
Q3 2026-27	5.9	6.0
Q4 2026-27	5.5	5.7
2026-27	5.0	5.2
Q1 2027-28	5.3	5.6

Repo rate trajectory (in %)



Source: RBI

RAISES FY27 GDP TO 7.1%

The RBI also raised its FY27 real GDP growth forecast to 7.1 per cent from 6.7 per cent earlier, reflecting confidence in domestic demand and economic resilience. It also nudged up its CPI inflation projection to 5.2 per cent from 5 per cent, with inflation expected to peak at 6 per cent in the third quarter before easing gradually.

DEARER LOANS, EMIS

The repo rate hike will translate into higher borrowing costs for customers with floating rates set to increase. Retail borrowers, including home and auto loan customers, as well as MSMEs are likely to see higher EMIs. Deposit rates, however, may remain stable in the near term.

Giving the policy a distinctly hawkish tone, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said rate cuts are off the table for now, with future policy action likely limited to either further hikes or a pause, depending on incoming data.

"The duration and extent of the rate hike cycle will be contingent on the actual growth-inflation developments and outlook...," he said.

The decision marks the end of the 125 bps easing cycle that began in February 2025 and concluded in December, when the repo rate was lowered to 5.25 per cent. The MPC noted that while geopolitical developments continue to cloud the global outlook, India's economy remains resilient and growth broad-based.

"It is clear that inflation and its outlook are not benign as they were last year, with headline CPI inflation expected to average almost 5.8 per cent in the next three quarters and core inflation projected at 4.4 per cent this financial year. In this milieu, recalibrating the policy rate is imperative," said Malhotra.

Brajesh Kumar Singh, MD and CEO, Canara Bank, said, "The upward revision of FY27 real GDP growth reflects good growth momentum and healthy credit demand."

Economists expect another 50 bps of rate hikes in FY27, with the trajectory dependent on the West Asia conflict, the pass-through of input cost pressures to retail inflation and the impact of El Nino on crop output, among others.

More reports **p2, p3**

Rupee slides to 5-month low of 96.7/$; bond yields rise

Ashokamithran T
Mumbai

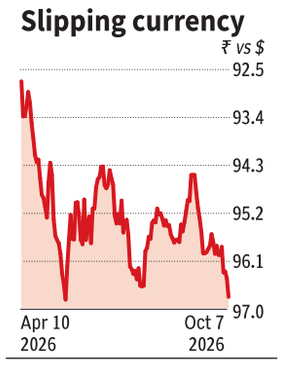
The rupee closed at a five-month low of 96.7 against the dollar on Wednesday, after the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) shifted its monetary policy stance to "calibrated tightening".

The currency opened at 96.4 against the dollar and weakened to 96.8 after RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra indicated that easing was no longer under consideration amid a higher inflation outlook, before recovering some ground by close of trade.

NOT ENOUGH CUE

"The market may be looking for stronger liquidity tightening or direct FX intervention rather than just a rate hike. Hence, the RBI move is structurally positive for the rupee but insufficient to reverse the immediate depreciation pressure. The near-term direction will depend more on RBI intervention, crude oil prices and capital flows, with 97 emerging an important psychological level," said Kunal Sodhani, Head of Treasury at Shinhan Bank.

Slipping currency



MARKET ACTION

The Nifty50 ended a tad lower at 22,603.05, while the BSE Sensex shed about 0.6 per cent

BOND YIELDS RISE

The surprise change in stance also pushed the benchmark 10-year government bond yield higher by 5 basis points to 7.24 per cent.

"The bond market had moved ahead of the RBI. The 10-year bond yield was already above 7 per cent before [Wednesday], so I don't expect the hike on its own to push it significantly higher," said Nishchay Nath, Founder and CEO of BondScanner.

STOCKS DOWN

The equity markets, too, reflected the cautious sentiment. The Nifty50 ended a tad lower at 22,603.05, while the BSE Sensex shed about 0.6 per cent to close at 72,638.70.

The Bank Nifty finished around the 55,000 mark, largely flat but under pressure through the session.

"Looking ahead, the market's focus will shift to the September quarter earnings season for further direction," said Vinod Nair, Head of Research at Geojit Investments.

QUICKLY.

AIRTEL POSTPAID PLANS

Rates up ₹50; free global roaming once a year

New Delhi: Bharti Airtel has raised postpaid tariffs by ₹50 with a revamped set of plans that bundle one free international roaming trip every year, effective today. Sources said the telco's existing postpaid subscribers will be moved to the nearest higher plan within a month, with a free international roaming offer worth ₹2,000. **p12**

CHOICE FOR CUSTOMERS

RBI allows interoperability of NBFC a/c aggregators

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India has announced interoperability among NBFC-Account Aggregators, allowing customers to choose any account aggregator to access and share their financial information across participating financial institutions. **p2**

Starlink being blocked by certain oligarchs in India, a crime against people: Elon Musk

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Elon Musk on Wednesday took to X to express his displeasure at Starlink not getting security clearance to launch services in India. He said the satellite communication services provider was being "blocked by certain oligarchs" to maintain "their monopolistic chokehold" on Indians. "This is a crime against the people of India," Musk wrote.

ON STANDBY

Standing ready to serve India when India is ready, says Lauren Dreyer, V-P Starlink Business Operations

LOCAL DATA CONTROL

Separately, the company said it had spent the past five years investing in infrastructure in India and working with regulators to adapt its services.

"We have built our operations specifically for India, in recognition of Indian security requirements and other regulations, establishing controls at every layer and keeping user data within the country," Lauren Dreyer, V-P of Starlink Business Operations, said at the Indian Mobile Congress.

"We've already made the investment and built the ground infrastructure here, [including] 20 gateway sites comprising hundreds of antennas." The antennas connect Starlink's satellite network to terrestrial internet infrastructure.

THE MISSING PIECE

Dreyer hoped the processes required to operate in India would be completed soon.

The government has granted licences to three companies — Bharti Airtel, Reliance Jio, and Starlink — to provide satcom services. They need the spectrum and security clearance that are still pending with the government.

"The last mile remains, and it's the most challenging to connect... With Starlink, people can get connected within minutes, not years," she said.

Dreyer said, hopefully, by the time she addresses the IMC next, the government's good work will be complete and "Starlink will be authorised".

"We've already done a lot together, and it's exciting to think about the next chapter we could write together. We're standing ready to serve India when India is ready. We're ready to work with the government, with operators and with the industry to descend. We are ready to help Prime Minister Modi achieve his vision of 100 per cent connectivity across India," she said.

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Reserve Bank allows account aggregator interoperability, expanding customer choice

SMARTER ACCESS. Move enables seamless consent-based data sharing, faster credit assessment and consolidated financial views

Ashokamithran T
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has announced interoperability among NBFC-Account Aggregators (NBFC-AAs), allowing customers to choose any account aggregator to access and share their financial information across participating financial institutions.

The RBI made the announcement as part of its developmental and regulatory measures, which it unveiled alongside its monetary policy decision on October 7.

"With an objective to enhance customer convenience, it has been decided to implement interoperability among NBFC-Account Aggregators (NBFC-AA). This will enable customers to access and share their financial information across different Financial Information Providers through any NBFC-AA of their choice," the RBI said.

DATA CONTROL

Earlier, customers' access to financial data was often linked to specific account aggregators integrated with their banks or financial institutions. The new framework gives customers greater flexibility by allowing them to choose their preferred account aggregator.

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra emphasised that all data sharing would remain strictly consent-based.

"Interoperability takes the account aggregator ecosystem closer to the original promise of digital public infrastructure: Choice for the individual, not choice determined by the institution," said BG Mahesh, CEO of Sahamati, the RBI-recognised self-regulatory organisation for account aggregators.


Sanjay Malhotra, Governor, Reserve Bank of India BLOOMBERG

"The AA ecosystem has already crossed 500 million fulfilled consents and enabled the delivery of over 7.4 crore financial services across lending, capital markets and insurance in FY26. At this scale, the next frontier is not simply adding more participants but making the experience genuinely seamless for customers," he adds.

FASTER LENDING

Lenders welcomed the move, saying interoperability would improve ease of doing business and support financial inclusion.

"It is a positive step for the lending industry. Greater consent-based data sharing will enable faster and more accurate assessment of borrower cash flows, particularly for self-employed and informal-income segments that are traditionally underserved," said Ajai Shukla, MD & CEO, PNB Housing Finance.

"This should enhance credit underwriting, improve customer experience through quicker approvals, and support greater financial inclusion while maintaining strong data privacy safeguards," he said.

UNIFIED ACCOUNTS

The RBI also announced that SEBI regulated depositories will be facilitated to include bank deposit account information in consolidated account statements (CAS) through the NBFC-AA framework.

"This will enable demat account holders to view information relating to their demat holdings and bank deposit accounts in a single CAS," the RBI said.

The central bank clarified that customers, including those without demat accounts, would continue to be able to obtain a consolidated view of their financial information and share it through account aggregators.

WHAT THEY SAY.



"The upward revision in the growth outlook is reassuring, even as geopolitical developments and elevated energy prices warrant close monitoring. Interoperability among account aggregators, enhanced financial data integration and the proposed Technical Consultative Committee will strengthen the financial ecosystem

CS SETTY
Chairman, State Bank of India



"The RBI's decision to raise the repo rate reflects its commitment to anchoring inflation expectations amid a challenging global backdrop, while the upgraded 7.1 per cent FY27 growth forecast underscores India's economic resilience

PD SINGH
CEO, India & South Asia, Standard Chartered Bank



"A measured start now reduces the need for sharper adjustments later and reinforces macroeconomic stability. India's fundamentals remain robust, and the RBI's proactive approach should give businesses and investors greater confidence as they plan their growth and investment decisions

K BALASUBRAMANIAN India CEO & Banking Head and Indian Subcontinent Subcluster Head, Citi



"While NBFCs may witness a gradual increase in funding costs as the rate-tightening cycle begins, resilient domestic demand, a healthy investment outlook and strong financial sector fundamentals provide confidence that the underlying credit cycle will remain healthy

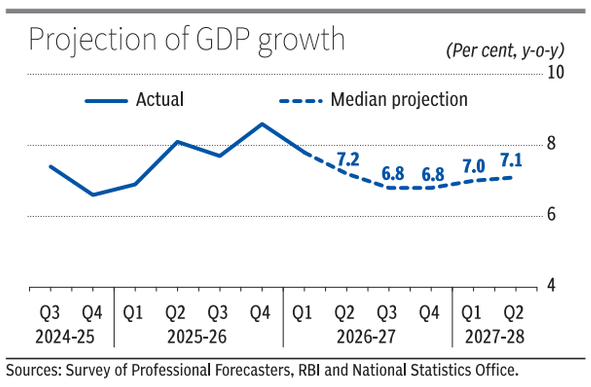
RAJIV SABHARWAL
MD & CEO, Tata Capital

RBI raises real GDP, CPI inflation forecasts for FY27

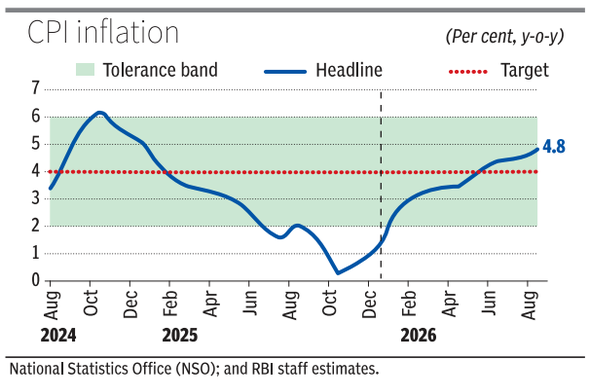
Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India has revised upwards its real GDP growth projection for FY27 to 7.1 per cent from the earlier 6.7 per cent, as the economy is expected to remain resilient even as the central bank hiked the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.5 per cent.

It also raised its CPI inflation projection for FY27 to 5.2 per cent from the earlier 5 per cent, as the near-term inflation outlook points to continued supply-side pressures due to a deficient South-West monsoon, El Nino conditions and high volatility in international oil prices.



Sources: Survey of Professional Forecasters, RBI and National Statistics Office.



National Statistics Office (NSO); and RBI staff estimates.

"Notwithstanding these persistent global headwinds, the Indian economy has remained resilient. In Q2, available high-frequency indicators for July-August suggest sustained momentum in domestic economic activity... Domestic demand remains resilient and is well supported by robust external demand, with merchandise exports registering double-digit growth," per the Monetary Policy Statement.

Governor Sanjay Malhotra cautioned that, going ahead, global economic uncertainty would continue to have some bearing on domestic economic activity.

Real GDP growth for Q1 2027-28 is projected at 7.1 per cent.

The risks are evenly balanced, according to the statement.

CPI INFLATION

The Governor noted that CPI inflation increased to 4.8 per cent in August from 4.5 per cent in July. While the increase was predominantly driven by higher inflation in the food and fuel groups, core inflation had also picked up, indicating widening price pressures, he added.

"The near-term outlook on inflation points towards continued pressures from the supply side on account of the deficient monsoon, ongoing El Nino conditions and high energy and other commodity prices, the pass-through of which is still continuing," he said.

Inflation for Q1 2027-28 is projected at 5.6 per cent, with risks evenly balanced. Core inflation is projected at 4.4 per cent for 2026-27 against 4.3 per cent projected earlier.

Hawkish stance signals more rate hikes: Economists

Our Bureau
Mumbai

THE TAKEAWAY



- Market participants said the policy marks a clear transition from a pause phase to a tightening cycle
- Economists believe the RBI has opened the door for at least two more rate hikes in FY27
- They believe the shift to a 'calibrated tightening' stance reflects the RBI's intent to contain inflation

Economists interpreted the RBI's move as a strong signal that its focus has decisively shifted towards containing inflation and that the possibility of rate cuts has been ruled out for the foreseeable future.

While the 25 basis point hike was largely in line with market expectations, the surprise element came from the change in stance. Economists said the move indicates that the RBI wants financial markets to prepare for a potentially longer rate hike cycle than previously anticipated.

CAUGHT BY SURPRISE

Gaura Sengupta, Chief Economist at IDFC First Bank, said the stance change was the biggest takeaway from the policy.

"The key surprise was the change in stance to calibrated tightness. The RBI may have wanted to highlight that rate cuts are off the table. The stance change and the lack of usage of normalisation policy rates in the language indicate that, in the RBI's assessment, the rate-hiking cycle could be deeper based on the CPI and growth outlook," she said.

Echoing a similar view, Upasna Bhardwaj, Chief Economist at Kotak Mahindra Bank, said the central bank had delivered the expected rate hike but surprised markets with a distinctly hawkish policy signal. "The MPC delivered a 25 bps rate hike in line with expectations, with a surprise shift in stance towards recalibrated tightening. We continue to see 50 bps of additional rate hikes going ahead, with further upside if global risks persist," she said.

Sengupta also said she sees the RBI increasing the policy rate by another 50 bps in FY27. "I think it is warranted, given the uncertain and inflationary global outlook."

ROBUST OUTLOOK

Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist, Bank of Baroda, who had expected the MPC to keep the rates unchanged, said, "The policy move came as a slight surprise, as we had expected the RBI to maintain *status quo* at this meeting, followed by two rate hikes in December and February. We continue to expect a similar trajectory, with the terminal policy rate reaching 6 per cent by March. This view is underpinned by our expectation that inflation will average around 5.8 per cent over the coming quarters."

Meanwhile, the RBI's confidence in pursuing tighter monetary policy stems from a relatively robust domestic growth outlook. Economic activity remains supported by strong urban demand, government capital expenditure, healthy credit growth and improving private investment.

The central bank retained its growth optimism even while cautioning that risks from global conflicts, energy prices and weather-related disruptions could complicate the inflation trajectory.

Liquidity surplus expected to get drained out within the current fiscal year: RBI Governor

Our Bureau
Mumbai

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra sees the FCNR(B) deposit-related surplus liquidity in the banking system as a temporary phenomenon, with the surplus expected to get drained out within the current financial year.

The Governor also emphasised that raising the cash reserve ratio (CRR) would be one of the least preferred ways of withdrawing liquidity.


CASH GLUT. As measured by the net position under the LAF, system liquidity stood at an average daily surplus of ₹5.9 lakh crore since the last MPC meeting in August 2026

LIQUIDITY SURPLUS

He noted that during August and September, system liquidity increased substantially on account of the recent measures undertaken to attract capital inflows.

As measured by the net position under the liquidity adjustment facility (LAF), system liquidity stood at an average daily surplus of ₹5.9 lakh crore since the last MPC meeting in August.

DUE DILIGENCE

"When you talk about the cheaper cost to the Reserve Bank, I think we need to look at the cost to the economy and the benefits to the economy," Malhotra said.

The Governor emphasised that banks should do their due diligence and take their time to use the FCNR (B) deposits ($133 billion) mobilised by them between June 8 and August 31 under the RBI's special foreign currency USD/INR swap window.

CASH CUSHION

Malhotra observed that there is more liquidity today than is required. But he said he believes this is not a very long-term phenomenon due to natural reasons like currency leakage, reserve requirements of banks, liquidity draining operations through various central bank operations such as spot, sell-buy swaps, open market operations, VRRR, etc. "So, this liquidity will get drained. We do not expect liquidity to remain in such a high surplus for a very long period of time," he said.

We do not expect liquidity to remain in such a high surplus for a very long period of time, said RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra

Rate hike to have mixed effect on residential sales

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Residential sales, especially in the affordable segment, could come under pressure due to the hike in interest rates.

But rising borrowing costs are unlikely to directly affect commercial real estate, which is driven by structural demand from GCCs and other sectors, say consultants. "The rate hike will put pressure on consumer sentiment and discretionary spending. This has a direct correlation with housing demand. The festival season is a key period for housing demand, and an increase in borrowing costs will affect buyer sentiment," said Anuj Puri, Chairman of the Anarock Group.



"With the rate hike, dearer home loans will make buyers more selective and cause decision timelines to extend, particularly in the price-sensitive segments," he added.

"For real estate, higher borrowing costs could create some affordability pressures, particularly in interest rate-sensitive and lower-priced segments, but we do not expect a material disruption to the sector's broader trajectory in the near future. The economy has remained resilient, which is adequately demonstrated by the upward revision of GDP growth for FY27 from 6.7 per cent to 7.1 per cent," said Shishir Baijal, International Partner, Chairman and MD, Knight Frank India.

HOUSING SALES

As per Anarock Research data, average residential prices rose 7 per cent y-o-y. The third quarter of CY26 recorded sales of 1,00,220 housing units across the top seven cities, up 3 per cent y-o-y. Affordable housing accounted for 16 per cent share of these sales.

While commercial real estate is unlikely to see an adverse impact, the retail sector may face challenges, and some mall projects could be deferred until demand becomes clearer, Puri said.

"Supply and demand are becoming more balanced in several markets, making product selection and execution important for developers. A higher rate will therefore reinforce the need for discipline across the sector," said Srishti S Anandd, Co-Founder and Chief Advisor, Paradigm Realty.

"Buyer sentiment remains a mixed bag, with end-user demand for quality homes continuing to hold up. Attractive offers, new launches and greater flexibility from developers could help offset some of the pressure from higher borrowing costs," said Devanshu Bansal, Director, UK Realty.

Protecting car buyers from higher costs could burn a ₹1,000-crore hole in automakers' pockets

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India's repo rate hike is unlikely to derail festival auto growth, but protecting buyers from higher borrowing costs could cost automakers and lenders nearly ₹1,000 crore over four years, according to estimates by auto and BFSI industry experts.

The calculation assumes manufacturers and financiers absorb around half the incremental financing cost across around one crore two-wheeler loans, 20 lakh passenger vehicle loans and 10 lakh three-wheeler loans. The actual cost will depend on financing penetration, lender pass-through and the extent to which manufacturers subsidise interest rates.

The pressure is greater in 2-wheelers and 3-wheelers, where financing and monthly cash flows play a larger role in purchase decisions

For individual buyers, the impact is modest. Assuming full transmission, an illustrative ₹1 lakh two-wheeler loan at 12 per cent for four years would cost roughly ₹590 over the tenure. A ₹3 lakh three-wheeler loan at 15 per cent would cost around ₹1,830 over four years. For a ₹10 lakh car loan at 9 per cent, the increase works out to about ₹5,700 over four years.

The relatively small individual impact is one reason industry executives do not expect the hike by itself to derail festival demand.

DISCOUNTS MAY DEEPEN

"The RBI repo rate hike might seem like an immediate dampener of the festival season. With the sales curve on an upswing, automakers will not want something like this to act as a speed breaker," said Avik Chattopadhyay, an auto-industry expert. "Prospective customers will expect better deals at the dealerships," he said. "Already, the festival discounts have started. They might get deeper."

The pressure is potentially greater in two- and three-wheelers, where financing and monthly cash flows play a larger role in purchase decisions.

"The 25 bps repo rate hike ... puts some pressure on affordability," said Uday Narang, Founder and Chairman, Omega Seiki Mobility.

Bharath Rao, Co-Founder and CEO of electric two-wheeler maker EMOBI, said festival demand in the two segments is supported by both aspiration and utility. Consumers, however, are likely to scrutinise monthly outgoings and overall ownership economics more closely as borrowing costs rise.

"A repo rate hike could cool festive auto demand at the margin, but it is unlikely to derail the sector's growth trajectory," said Veer Singh, MD, Kallords Technology.

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RBI expects rate hike transmission to temper credit growth in coming quarters

LIQUIDITY DISCIPLINE. Banks should undertake proper due diligence and use FCNR(B) deposits prudently: Governor

Our Bureau
Mumbai



CORE TEAM. RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra (centre), Deputy Governors Shirish Chandra Murmu (left), Swaminathan Janakiraman (second left), Poonam Gupta (second right) and Rohit Jain at a press conference in Mumbai on Wednesday PTI

The RBI's fifth monetary policy review of 2026 saw the repo rate raised by 25 basis points to 5.5 per cent, in line with market expectations. However, the central bank's hawkish stance surprised markets, with Governor Sanjay Malhotra highlighting growing global uncertainties and their potential risks to the domestic economy.

Edited excerpts:

Given that banks and NBFCs are witnessing strong credit growth, will this rate hike dampen loan demand?

Swaminathan J: Credit growth is already running at a robust 18-19 per cent. Over the long term, a growth rate of 12-14 per cent is generally seen as sustainable and supportive of economic growth. Some moderation is likely as policy rate transmission takes place over the next couple of quarters, affecting both demand and borrowing costs.

However, a moderation from current levels would still be healthy and sufficient to support economic growth.

Large banks are not planning to raise deposit rates immediately due to surplus FCNR(B) inflows. When do you expect deposit rate transmission to begin?

Sanjay Malhotra: We are already seeing FCNR(B) deposits being deployed, as reflected in strong credit growth. However, given the large inflows, we do not want banks to deploy them all at once.

They should undertake proper due diligence and use these deposits prudently. While liquidity is currently in surplus, we do not expect this to be a long-term phenomenon, as factors such as currency leakage, reserve requirements, and our liquidity management operations, including spot and sell-buy swaps, will gradually absorb excess liquidity.

When do you expect banks to utilise their FCNR(B) deposits?

Malhotra: We do not expect these surplus liquidity conditions to last very long. Within this financial year itself, a significant portion of the excess liquidity is likely to be absorbed. Currency leakage alone typically absorbs around ₹3 lakh crore, and we have already undertaken sell-buy swaps. We also have other tools at our disposal, such as OMOs, VRRRs, and spot market interventions to support the rupee. Therefore, I do not expect liquidity to remain in a high-surplus mode for an extended period.

Forex swaps are expensive for the Reserve Bank. Wouldn't a CRR hike be a cheaper option for the system?

Malhotra: As I mentioned earlier, a CRR increase is one of our least-preferred options for absorbing liquidity. I would also like to point out that when discussing the cost or benefit to the Reserve Bank, the broader economic benefits arising from FCNR (B) deposits are more important than the cost incurred by the RBI. Cost considerations are not our primary objective.

From October 15, MDR will be applicable. Many people are concerned that transaction volumes could decline. Should the RBI have borne the cost instead?

Rohit Jain: As of now, we have not seen any decline in transaction volumes, and I do not believe that a small fee will have a significant impact on volumes.

In the current geopolitical environment, does India need a higher neutral rate to attract and retain capital flows?

Poonam Gupta: Demand for capital is rising globally, driven by hyperscalers and other emerging sectors. However, India is relatively insulated due to its fiscal prudence, limited sovereign borrowing requirements, and a strong domestic savings and investment base. With corporates holding healthy cash reserves and bank credit remaining robust, India's dependence on global capital is lower than that of many other economies.

There have been several concerns regarding the new export declaration requirements under the revised FEMA rules. What is your view on this?

Jain: Individuals are not covered by the reporting requirements for personal contracts, and we will shortly issue an FAQ to clarify any misunderstandings.

The new trade regulations are aimed at simplifying compliance and reducing the burden on authorised dealers, exporters, and importers.

For export bills of up to ₹10 lakh, a self-declaration is sufficient. Reporting on EDPMS is carried out by banks and authorised dealers, not by exporters or importers.

The additional information being sought will help improve data quality and reporting standards.

GST Council likely to clarify tax treatment of e-comm logistics system

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi



CONFLICTING RULINGS. While the West Bengal Appellate Authority for Advance Ruling denied the exemption to Flipkart's logistics model, the Tamil Nadu AAR ruled in favour

E-commerce operators are likely to get clarity on the GST treatment of logistics services as the GST Council is expected to consider a proposal to settle the dispute over whether delivery of goods through newer, hub-based logistics models can qualify for the exemption available to specified Goods Transport Agency (GTA) services.

Under the existing framework, transportation of goods through specified GTA services to unregistered recipients is exempt from GST. However, some e-commerce operators such as Flipkart, have adopted logistics models involving multiple transit hubs, sorting and transshipment before goods reach the end customer. The tax treatment of such integrated logistics models has led to conflicting advance rulings.

LOGISTICS MODELS

While the West Bengal Appellate Authority for Advance Ruling (WBAAAR) denied the exemption to Flipkart's logistics model, the Tamil Nadu AAR has ruled in favour of exemption. The GST Council is now expected to consider a clarification on whether such new logistics models should be treated on a par with GTA services for the purpose of GST exemption. The clarification, if approved, could have implications across the e-commerce sector.

"Platforms on different commercial models have read the same provisions differently. The tax on a booking will depend on the service supplied and not on how a platform arranges its contracts. The same delivery will bear the same tax, whichever way it is routed," a senior government official said, explaining the rationale behind the proposal. He added that any clarification would be applied prospectively.

The proposal assumes significance as a petition filed by Flipkart is pending before the Calcutta High Court. The e-commerce company has sought GST exemption on its delivery charges by arguing that its services should be treated as those provided by a GTA.

FLIPKART CASE

The WBAAAR, however, set aside the ruling of the West Bengal AAR in Flipkart's favour, holding that its logistics operations were not eligible for the GTA exemption. It said Flipkart's delivery activities included hub-based collection, sorting, transshipment, tracking, last-mile delivery and doorstep handover, which substantially resembled an organised courier/logistics fulfilment service rather than conventional GTA services.

"Accordingly, the respondent's (Flipkart) activity cannot be classified as GTA services supplied to unregistered end customers; hence, no exemption is available. Further, 18 per cent GST will be levied," the ruling said.

Though AAR/AAAR rulings are technically binding only on the applicant and the concerned jurisdictional authorities, the conflicting rulings have made the issue significant for the wider e-commerce and logistics sectors, particularly as platforms increasingly use integrated logistics networks.

An industry executive from the logistics sector said e-commerce platforms have helped small businesses gain market access while enabling consumers to access products at lower costs.

"With help from e-commerce platforms, Indian small businesses get market access efficiently and cheaply (as PM said vocal for local) and customers get products cheaply. It's almost an essentials services and government need to look at this more broadly in line with what the Prime Minister has been advocating for vocal for local," he said.

Another logistics industry executive urged the government to reconsider the role of efficient logistics in digital commerce and formalisation-led growth. He said the issue also merits consideration given the existence of an advance ruling supporting the exemption.

"There have been differing advance rulings on the issue and the matter involves important questions around classification and interpretation under the GST framework," he said. The issue also found resonance in Parliament on Wednesday, with Congress Member of Parliament Karti P Chidambaram writing to Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman seeking clarity on the GST treatment of GTA services.

"The Finance Ministry may consider directing the CBIC to issue an appropriate classification setting out the circumstances in which transportation service associated with e commerce providers can qualify as GTA service under the applicable GST provisions. A clear and uniform framework would provide greater certainty to taxpayers, protect government revenue and ensure a level playing field between e-commerce business, logistics providers, MSMEs and traditional retailers," he said.

'A small fee on UPI transactions will not have a major impact on volumes'

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India does not expect the small fee on UPI (Unified Payments Interface) transactions to have a major impact on transaction volumes.

"Already a decision has been taken (on merchant discount rate/MDR). As of now, we do not see any drop in volumes. And I personally don't think that a small fee will have a major impact on the volumes," RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said.

The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) plans to introduce an MDR of 0.4 per cent on person-to-merchant (P2M) UPI transactions above ₹2,000. For transactions of ₹75,000- and above, the MDR will be capped at ₹300 per transaction. These charges will come into effect from October 15.

The MDR is distributed only amongst the UPI ecosystem, to further invest into infrastructure resiliency, innovation, cybersecurity and customer service.

According to NPCI, there is no impact on small-value UPI transactions up to ₹2,000, which comprise more than 95 per cent of the total volume of UPI (P2M) transactions. As per latest data, UPI processed 2,407 crore transactions valued at ₹29.37 lakh crore in September 2026.

RBI to conduct ₹2 lakh cr VRRR auction today

Press Trut of India
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India on Wednesday said it will conduct a 29-day variable rate reverse repo (VRRR) auction for a notified amount of ₹2 lakh crore on October 8 to absorb surplus liquidity from the banking system.

The auction will be conducted between 9.30 am and 10 am, with the amount parked with the RBI scheduled for reversal on November 6, the central bank said.

The decision to conduct the auction was taken after a review of the current and evolving liquidity conditions, the RBI said.

Currently, the liquidity in the banking system is estimated to be in surplus of ₹4.99 lakh crore as on October 7.

'FTA utilisation cell set up to boost trade pact gains'

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

In an effort to make India's free trade agreements (FTAs) deliver more substantial gains for Indian exporters and address low utilisation of the pacts, the Commerce Department has set up an FTA Utilisation Cell to help businesses identify and tap opportunities in partner markets, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal said on Wednesday.

"The idea behind that cell is to first explain the FTA and explain the opportunities to every entrepreneur across the country through the industry associations, through the EPCs (export promotion councils), through the state government so that people understand what does a free trade agreement provides for and how these are new opportunities that businesses need to look at," Agrawal said at the India-EFTA Prosperity Summit.

EXPORT PROMOTION

The cell will also work with export promotion councils to improve utilisation of the agreements and draw up market-specific action plans with partner countries over the next four to five years, he said.

Agrawal said the Commerce Department seeks to ensure that FTAs translate into actual business outcomes, rather than remaining instruments negotiated by governments.

"True value proposition will only come if it translates into outcome. Every time I go and brief the agreements and outcomes of provisions to the leaders... they ask



Rajesh Agrawal

when is the potential outcome going to be realised," he said, noting that India's experience with earlier FTAs had "not been that great".

"Our growth rates in FTA partner countries in the past have not been phenomenally different from how we have grown in non FTA partner countries. This question becomes important and topmost in the mind of our leaders," he said.

Agrawal said the government's argument that the latest FTAs would deliver better results was based on the complementary nature of the economies involved, but added that this would have to be demonstrated through actual trade outcomes.

FIVE-YEAR PLAN

He called for export promotion councils to prepare five-year action plans for each FTA, identifying non-tariff barriers, quality standards and potential anchor companies that could drive exports in partner markets.

"Trade agreements are being worked out by the government. But until and unless we actively use these our industry, manufacturers and farmers will not be able to benefit out of it," he said.

The government has finalised FTAs with EFTA (Switzerland, Iceland, Norway and Liechtenstein), the UAE, Australia, Mauritius, Oman, New Zealand, the UK and the European Union. Agarwal said the EFTA agreement should be viewed as part of a wider network, with the UK and EU pacts together giving Indian businesses access to 32 countries with largely zero-tariff trade.

The Commerce Secretary also stressed that the value of FTAs extended beyond tariff cuts, with tariff predictability allowing businesses to take investment decisions, build supply chains and plan long-term growth.

India's share in EFTA's total imports is currently only about $2-3 billion, or less than 1 per cent of the bloc's total combined imports of about $500 billion..

Forex transactions of personal nature remain outside new FEMA reporting: RBI

Our Bureau
Chennai

The RBI Governor on Wednesday clarified that individuals undertaking forex transactions of a personal nature will not be covered by the new service exports reporting requirements that kicked off on October 1. The central bank will soon issue FAQs to clarify the prevailing confusion, he added.

His comments come at a time when social media was abuzz with freelancers, content creators and other small service providers saying that the new FEMA reporting requirements were a hurdle to ease of doing business.

"If you are subscribing to a TV channel or an app, or to some journals or newspapers [imports of services], or you are providing services as an individual outside — could be tutoring services, could be some small software, etc — and getting paid for it, those as individuals are not required to be reported," RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said at the press conference.



The central bank will soon issue FAQs to clarify the prevailing confusion, RBI Governor said

Deputy Governor Rohit Jain added that small exporters with transactions of up to Rs 10 lakh per bill also have the option to use a self-declaration.

He added that these regulations were issued in January this year, sufficiently ahead of their October 1 implementation.

On the reporting itself, the Governor reiterated that the reporting on the portal is to be undertaken by banks and not exporters, who only have to file a declaration form.

Retail prices of diesel and petrol will have to be raised at some point, says Moody's Ratings

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

State-run oil marketing companies (OMCs) cannot continue to absorb high crude oil prices while freezing retail prices of diesel and petrol for long durations, particularly at a time when Brent is constantly hitting $100 per barrel coupled with record freight and insurance premiums.

For Indian refiners, said Moody's ratings, the EBITDA growth, or operational profitability, will only come when they are able to pass on some of the increase in prices.



Vikas Halan, Managing Director Corporate Finance Group at Moody's Ratings, told *businessline*, "I think from a pure math perspective, just adding the numbers here, when you look at the problem, it's a problem of who bears the losses. Who puts the bill here, and it has to be a combination of all three parties involved—the government, the OMCs, and the consumer. It can't be one alone." Brent crude prices have been trading near or above the psychological $100 per barrel mark for almost a month, compounding problems for India, which imports more than 85 per cent of its crude oil requirement. Record high freight rates and war risk premiums is further adding to the problem.

The scenario becomes more serious considering inflation is rising pushed up by higher energy prices and at a time the rupee is trading at around ₹96 against the US dollar pushing the current account deficit further north.

"So now, it's again not just who bears the bill, but who bears the bill when. This is getting into policy, and I don't want to get into all of that. That is something for the government to decide. But it is pretty clear if this situation continues, there has to be a point where you make the decision: Either you recapitalise OMCs so that they can continue to bear these losses or you allow them to increase (retail) prices," Halan explained.

Maulik Patel, Head of Research at Equirus Securities, said on September 11, "If crude remains above $100 per barrel, with restricted retail-price increases, OMCs could face negative petrol and diesel marketing margins, higher LPG under-recoveries, higher crude-landing, freight and insurance costs, working-capital and debt accumulation and inventory losses if crude subsequently corrects sharply."

CRUDE PRICE

Moody's Ratings expects that the 2026 baseline crude oil price will be in the range of $90-110 per barrel, which is based on the assumption that the West Asia conflict is resolved by late 2026 and supply is restored over time. It also expects the medium term price range of $55-75 pre barrel. Another factor is that sustained crude prices of $100-120 a barrel could adversely impact demand, which will eventually weaken growth and oil consumption.

CHENNAI
businessline.
THURSDAY - OCTOBER 8 - 2026

TECH DIGEST.

Lenovo announces ThinkBook 14x in India



Lenovo has launched the ThinkBook 14x in India, an ultralight laptop aimed at professionals, students and users who frequently work on the move. The ThinkBook 14x weighs under 990 g and measures 12.9 mm thick, with an aluminium chassis. It is powered by Intel Core Ultra Series 2 processors and is available with Core Ultra 5 226V and Core Ultra 7 256V options.

The top-end variant features a 14 inch 2.8K OLED display with a 120 Hz refresh rate, 500 nits peak brightness, 16:10 aspect ratio and 100 per cent DCI-P3 and sRGB colour gamut coverage. Other configurations are available with LED and touch-enabled LED panels. The Copilot+ PC comes with 16 GB of memory and 512 GB or 1 TB of storage, depending on the configuration, and the dual SSD slots allow additional storage. Connectivity includes two USB-C ports, two USB-A ports with always-on charging and full-size HDMI.

Other features include a backlit keyboard, glass touchpad, Lenovo Smart Connect and sensors for automatic keyboard-light adjustment and privacy screen blurring. The ThinkBook 14x starts at ₹1,08,990 and is available through Lenovo.com, with custom-to-order configuration options.

Sony unveils three second generation party speakers



Sony India has expanded its ULT Power Sound range with three second generation party speakers: the ULT Tower 5, ULT Tower 7 and ULT Tower Max.

The ULT Tower 5 has a 300 W output, a 230 mm woofer, two tweeters, an IPX4 rating and up to 20 hours of battery life. Connectivity includes Bluetooth 5.3, USB-C, USB-A, RCA and XLR, alongside microphone and DJ inputs.

The ULT Tower 7 increases output to 420 W, with a 280 mm woofer, two midrange drivers and four tweeters. It offers up to 30 hours of battery life, IPX4 protection, USB-C, XLR/RCA inputs, karaoke controls and multi-speaker connectivity.

The mains-powered ULT Tower Max delivers 2,150 W through three 280 mm woofers, two midrange drivers and four tweeters. It also includes XLR/RCA and USB-C connectivity, karaoke controls and wired multi-speaker support.

The ULT Tower 5 is priced ₹44,490, while the ULT Tower 7 is ₹64,990, with both available from October 8. The ULT Tower Max, priced ₹1,74,990, will be available from November 15.

Oppo launches F35 Pro 5G and F35 5G in India



Oppo has launched the F35 Series in India, comprising the F35 Pro 5G and F35 5G. Both phones feature a 50 MP ultrawide autofocus front camera with a 100-degree field of view, an 8,000 mAh battery with 80 W charging, and IP66, IP68, IP69 and IP69K ratings. The F35 Pro 5G features a 6.78 inch 1.5K 144 Hz AMOLED display and is powered by the MediaTek Dimensity 7360 MAX.

It gets a 50 MP OIS main camera paired with an 8 MP ultrawide camera and supports 4 K video recording from both front and rear cameras. The F35 5G uses a MediaTek Dimensity 6360 MAX chip and has a 6.57 inch FHD+ 120 Hz AMOLED display. Its rear camera setup comprises a 50 MP main camera and a 2 MP depth sensor, while video recording goes up to 2.5 K. Both smartphones run ColorOS 16 and include AI-based productivity, imaging and security features. The F35 Pro starts at ₹45,999, while the F35 starts at ₹38,999. Both go on sale from October 11 through offline retailers, Oppo's e-store, Amazon and Flipkart.

Samsung Galaxy Tab S12 series goes on sale



Samsung has launched the Galaxy Tab S12 Ultra and Galaxy Tab S12+ in India.

The Galaxy Tab S12 Ultra features a 14.6 inch Dynamic AMOLED 2X display with a 120 Hz refresh rate, while the Tab S12+ gets a 12.6 inch 120 Hz Dynamic AMOLED 2X panel.

Both offer peak brightness of 1,600 nits and are powered by the MediaTek Dimensity 9500, paired with 12 GB RAM and up to 512 GB storage. MicroSD expansion up to 2 TB is supported. The Tab S12 Ultra packs an 11,600 mAh battery, while the S12+ has a 10,600 mAh unit, with both supporting 45 W charging. Other features include an in-box S Pen, quad speakers, IP68 protection and Galaxy AI features.

The tablets run Android 17 with One UI 9, with Samsung promising up to seven OS upgrades and security updates. The Galaxy Tab S12+ starts at ₹1,29,999, while the Tab S12 Ultra starts at ₹1,49,999. Both are available in wi-fi and 5G variants in Gray and Silver.

The all-rounder foldable

VIVO X FOLD6. With Zeiss optics, flagship hardware and useful software features, the device delivers a great experience

Siddharth Mathew Cherian

Foldables have emerged as one of 2026's defining smartphone trends, spanning everything from clamshells to book-style devices, alongside Apple's entry into the segment with the iPhone Duo. In India, the Vivo X Fold6 takes on the likes of the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold8 series, Google Pixel 11 Pro Fold and Motorola Razr Fold. I spent some time with Vivo's latest foldable to see how it stacks up.



SLEEK DESIGN. At 228 g and just 4.4 mm unfolded, the Vivo X Fold6 combines a slim, premium profile with a glass-and-aluminium build BIJOY GHOSH



The Zeiss-backed camera system comprises a 200 MP main sensor, a 50 MP 3X periscope telephoto lens and a 50 MP ultra-wide camera BIJOY GHOSH

DESIGN

At 228 g and just 4.4 mm when unfolded, the X Fold6 feels impressively slim and premium, with a glass-and-aluminium build and a clean, understated design.

Those rounded corners make a noticeable difference in daily use. Whether folded as a phone or opened into a tablet-like form factor, the device sits comfortably in the hand without sharp edges digging into the palms. Despite the glass back, it remains surprisingly easy to grip in both modes. Vivo also bundles a partial TPU case that covers the rear panel. Its textured, rubberised finish improves grip, adds some protection and makes the foldable feel more secure during one-handed use.

The X Fold6 combines IPX8/IPX9 water resistance and IP5X dust protection with a premium finish. While the camera bump still causes some table wobble, it is less pronounced than on the X300 Ultra. The Prism Black unit I reviewed looks sleek and understated, but the Nebula Teal variant is the more eye-catching option, adding a vibrant splash of colour for those who prefer their phone to stand out.

The X Fold6 pairs an 8.02 inch inner AMOLED display with a 6.51 inch cover screen, both supporting HDR formats, including Dolby Vision and Netflix HDR. Both displays offer adaptive 1 Hz-120 Hz refresh rates, high peak brightness and comfortable low-light viewing.

In daily use, the display proved to be one of the X Fold6's standout features. I found myself binge-watching episodes of *The Rookie*, appreciating both the expansive form factor and the quality of the AMOLED panel.

Skin tones appeared natural, colours were vibrant without looking oversaturated, and contrast levels remained consistently strong. Whether streaming movies or web series, the foldable screen makes a great case as an entertainment device for long flights or road trips with the crease barely noticeable at the centre of the display.

AUDIO

Audio is handled by dual stereo speakers with Dolby Atmos support. The speaker setup delivers a noticeable improvement over the previous foldable I reviewed. Despite the speaker placement, the audio output felt balanced with minimal directional bias. Listening to tracks such as *Muthumani* and *Kalyana Virindhu* from Karthik Subbaraj's *Dorothy*, I was impressed by the stereo separation and overall clarity. Vocals, instruments and background elements were reproduced with good detail, while both highs and lows remained well-balanced across genres. The result is an enjoyable multimedia experience that complements the large immersive display.

PERFORMANCE

Powered by the Dimensity 9500 Super Edition, the X Fold6 delivers flagship-level performance, posting Geekbench 7 scores of 1,695 (single-core) and 6,792 (multi-core). The unit I reviewed featured 12 GB RAM and 512 GB storage.

Performance never felt wanting in daily use. The large foldable display made gaming particularly enjoyable, with *BGMI* running comfortably above 90 fps and *Rainbow Six Mobile* playing smoothly without stutters or noticeable heating. Even casual titles such as *HitWicket* and *Real Cricket* scaled well on the expansive screen and ran without issues.

The X Fold6 runs OriginOS 7 Fold based on Android 17, with a suite of productivity features designed to take advantage of its large foldable display. Origin Workbench supports up to five apps simultaneously, while Multi-Split Screen makes multitasking more intuitive and practical.

Vivo has also packed in a range of AI-powered tools, including AI Cross-App Drag, meeting transcription and summaries, PDF reformatting, file organisation and content summarisation, many of which require a Vivo ID login. Together, these features add genuine utility for users looking to get more done on the foldable's large display.

For users looking to replace their laptop on the go, the X Fold6 supports both wired and wireless display output with resizable windows for a desktop-like experience. In day-to-day use, these features worked reliably and added genuine utility beyond the usual foldable gimmicks.

CAMERAS

The Zeiss-backed camera system comprises a 200 MP main sensor, a 50 MP 3X periscope telephoto lens and a 50 MP ultra-wide camera.

The primary camera delivers excellent detail, natural colours and strong contrast, while the 3x telephoto lens remains impressively usable up to around 8x zoom before image quality begins to taper off. Low-light performance is equally strong, with good detail retention, balanced exposure and effective noise control.

For selfies and video calls, the X Fold6 features a 20 MP camera on each display, while the foldable design lets users use the rear cameras for self-portraits via the cover screen. Skin tones look natural, facial details are well preserved, and disabling AI beautification helps avoid excessive smoothing.

Additional features include telephoto macro photography, AI editing tools and foldable-specific shooting modes, such as split-screen previews and teleprompter support. Video recording is supported up to 4 K 60 fps with Dolby Vision.

Overall, the X Fold6 delivers one of the most complete camera experiences on a foldable, combining reliable image quality with useful shooting features.

BATTERY

The X Fold6 packs a 6,900 mAh battery and supports 80 W FlashCharge, 40 W wireless charging, and wireless reverse charging. In my testing, it consistently delivered 7-8 hours of screen-on time under heavy use and around 1.5 days on standby. Using the bundled 80 W charger, it went from 0 to 80 per cent in under 45 minutes and reached a full charge in about 70 minutes. Combined with its strong endurance, the X Fold6 easily lasts through a full day of demanding use.

VERDICT

Priced ₹2,19,999, the X Fold6 combines a refined design, excellent displays, strong battery life, flagship performance and a capable camera system, making it one of the most well-rounded foldables available today. While its premium price tag and some pre-installed bloatware may give a few buyers pause, neither detracts significantly from the overall experience. For those seeking a foldable that balances productivity, performance, battery life and photography, the X Fold6 comes highly recommended.

SNAPSHOT

Price: ₹2,19,999
Pros: Excellent displays, premium design, strong battery life, flagship performance, capable ZEISS cameras, useful productivity features
Cons: Premium price, pre-installed bloatware, telephoto camera softens beyond 8x zoom, minor camera-bump wobble

The biggest overhaul of the Apple Watch

APPLE WATCH SERIES 12. New wellness features, advanced hardware and ready for the AI era

Ashwin Rajagopalan



DIGITAL UPGRADE. The Apple Watch Series 12 runs on watchOS 27 and features the new S11 chip, which enables more frequent sensor measurements ASHWIN RAJAGOPALAN

If you haven't caught up on all the new updates on Apple's 2026 Apple Watch Series 12 and you have just seen it at a retail store near you, you're likely to assume that not a lot has changed other than new colour options. The 12th-gen Apple Watch might look like more of the same, but it's a whole new product with significant upgrades.

When the Apple Watch first debuted in 2015, it seemed to pivot more towards lifestyle and fashion: A new connected screen on your wrist that complemented your iPhone, a wearable that created a whole new gadget category that initially spelt trouble for the Swiss watch industry. In 2019, Apple shipped 30.7 million watches compared to 21.7 million by the entire Swiss watch industry (Source: Statista). But a lot has changed since that watershed year for the Apple Watch.

A whole slew of wearables have reset the rules. We see scores of high-performance athletes wearing a Whoop activity band, while the Oura ring has led the way in the smart ring category with advanced sleep and wellness tracking. The Swiss watch industry rebounded in a post-pandemic world with a slew of marketing and product initiatives.

The Apple Watch Series 12 debuts at a time when the wellness industry has moved beyond exercise tracking to areas like recovery and longevity. If last year's Series 11 played up a new sleep score and hypertension detection, this year's Apple Watch marks a major overhaul with a whole bunch of features that have now become must-haves for active lifestyles.

The Apple Watch Series 4 marked a decisive shift towards the wellness space as it became the first mainstream smartwatch to launch with an ECG feature.

The Series 12 brings the Apple Watch full circle.

DESIGN

It looks identical to last year's Apple Watch. That is, until you look underneath. The sensor array on the bottom of the smartwatch is at the centre of the Series 12's overhaul. This new range of sensors allows the Apple Watch to capture more frequent readings in a power-efficient way. In terms of cosmetics, this year's entry-level aluminium version comes in a new dark bronze colour option. Apple has also reintroduced a ceramic case that we last saw in 2019. You get the same digital crown and the standard shortcut button that we've seen for quite a few generations.

The weight varies depending on the material and the display size (42 or 46 mm) and is similar to last year's Apple Watch line. You get the same rectangular OLED retina display (the 46 mm version features a 416 x 496 pixel resolution at 326 PPI) and a peak brightness of 2000 nits. The big change is the new ceramic shield front glass (the 11 features Ion-X glass) that improves scratch and drop resistance; Apple claims the new glass is 60 per cent tougher. I'd still recommend the Ultra version if durability is your primary concern, but the Series 12 works for most active lifestyles. It's also lighter on your wrist, handy if you're planning to track your sleep with it.

PERFORMANCE

At the heart of the Apple Watch Series 12 is the new S11 chip, which powers more frequent sensor readings (with the redesigned health sensor array). It also powers a raft of new Audio Intelligence features. I tried out the faster and newer Shazam on the watch, and it worked really well. Audio Intelligence's much-touted Audio Rewind and Siri Recap, which signal the AI-centric direction in the immediate future, are not yet available on the Series 12. They're likely to drop later this year as part of an update. These features can listen in on your conversation, a feature that's likely to be polarising. Apple is leaning heavily on its privacy-centric pitch to reassure users ahead of its debut.

The new S11 chip powers more frequent measurements across sensors. Heart rate is now measured every five seconds, rather than every five minutes before. HRV, a key stress and recovery indicator, is measured 24 times more often. The new chip also ensures that the next-gen sensors don't impact battery life.

Apple claims up to 24 hours of battery life and up to 10 hours during an outdoor workout. I used the watch for over 2 weeks, and I found that battery life varied depending on everyday use case scenarios. On weekends that didn't involve gym workouts, I found the battery lasted about 36 hours with the 'Always-on' display activated. The improved fast charging feature lets you go from 1 to 100 per cent in about an hour, making it easier to keep your Apple Watch on longer.

USER EXPERIENCE

The Series 12 runs on watchOS 27, which comes with quite a few upgrades and is also available for previous generations of Apple Watch. You might not be able to use some of the newer wellness features that are powered by the new hardware and S11 chip, though. One feature I find useful, particularly during a gym workout, is the new dynamic app grid that automatically rounds up the five most frequently used apps.

The Apple Watch Series 12 becomes the first Apple Watch to introduce 'Readiness,' a score that assesses your recent activity, training load, vitals and sleep score to determine your capacity for the day ahead. Wearables like Garmin and Oura have offered a readiness score for a while now.

The Apple score uses a 0-10 scale; I like that it's a dynamic score. A restful period or nap can increase your score, while a vigorous workout might reduce the score. You'll need to wear it for a week for your first score. I found the sleep tracking quite accurate, but nap detection is a mixed bag; this is the case with quite a few wearables.

The Apple Watch Series 12 provides two variants of HRV, including Recovery HRV (for identifying daily signals of stress and recovery). The overall HRV captures insights into your broader health, including cardiovascular health. While Apple has released a white paper on its heart rate accuracy that is built on rigorous research and comparisons with the competition, it's still best to consult with your physician for an expert view.

Apple Pay's launch in India adds additional functionality to the Apple Watch. Apple Pay is currently available for Axis Bank credit cards (both Visa and Mastercard) and can be activated on the Apple Watch, along with your iPhone. If you prefer leaving your phone behind during an early morning cycle ride or trip to the gym, you can use your Apple Watch to make payments (available for GPS + cellular models).

VERDICT

The Series 12 marks a new chapter for the Apple Watch. Apple has made one of its biggest leaps in wellness with this device. While some of this represents a catch up with some of its rivals, it also signals Apple's clear wellness push, with AI at the centre of it.

Over the last few years, we've seen quite a few users combine a fitness ring or an activity tracker with their Apple Watch. The Series 12 covers enough bases to offer a more comprehensive wellness proposition, backed by a robust battery and an intuitive interface. All the new metrics don't require a subscription currently. If you've made the move away from the Apple Watch to augment your rigorous wellness routines, the Series 12 might tempt you to move back.

SNAPSHOT

Price: ₹56,900 onwards
Pros: User interface, new wellness features and sensors, dependable battery
Cons: Some features are not available yet, privacy concerns around Audio Intelligence

QUICKLY.

BPCL, Shell, Tiki Tar sign joint venture agreement



New Delhi: State-owned Bharat Petroleum Corp Ltd (BPCL) said it has signed a joint venture pact with Shell and Tiki Tar Industries to produce and market value-added bitumen products, seeking to tap rising demand from India's road, highways and airport infrastructure sectors. The new company, Bharat Tiki Tar Shell Pvt Ltd, has begun operations following a joint venture and share subscription agreement signed on June 26, BPCL said. PTI

Dixon Technologies signs JV pact with Gemtek

New Delhi: Electronic manufacturing services major Dixon Technologies India has entered into a joint venture agreement with Gemtek Technology Co to manufacture optical transceivers and other telecom products in India. Upon completion of the transaction, Dixon Technologies will hold a 60 per cent stake in the JV entity, Dixon Electroconnect, while Gemtek will own the rest. PTI

Euler Motors eyes to double revenue in FY27

New Delhi: Hero MotoCorp backed electric commercial vehicle maker Euler Motors is targeting to double its revenue to around ₹800 crore during the current financial year as it scales its four-wheeler business while expanding its retail network, according to a senior company official. The firm is eyeing around 100 per cent growth this year, as the top-line has already surpassed the full-year revenue in FY26. PTI

Amid inflationary pressures, apparel industry eyes a strong festival season

TIME TO CHEER. For organised players, the period accounts for 35-40 per cent of annual sales

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi



PROLONGED JOY. Apparel players expect the longer season to provide a tailwind for the sector

Apparel industry is gearing up for a robust festival season supported by positive consumer sentiment despite inflationary pressures amid an uncertain geopolitical environment. Players expect the longer festival season, compared to last year, to also provide a tailwind for the sector.

For organised apparel players, festival season is critical, accounting for 35-40 per cent of their annual sales.

Bhavay Pruthi, SVP - E-commerce & Product Management, Libas, said the company expects to garner growth to the tune of 20-25 per cent year-on-year.

"While inflationary pressures continue to influence consumer spending, we are seeing consumers remain willing to spend during key festive occasions, particularly on products that offer a strong value proposition. The longer festive window is also expected to provide a positive tailwind and allow retailers and brands to engage consumers across multiple occasions rather than concentrating demand around a few peak days, he added."

Pruthi noted that while consumers are becoming increasingly value-conscious, festive spending remains aspirational, with consumers willing to trade up for products and experiences that they perceive as meaningful or premium.

Ajay Kapoor, President – Retail, Fabindia, said, "Consumers had been holding back on discretionary spending amid geopolitical uncertainties, but market indicators have been encouraging, and we expect high single-digit growth during the festive period. Onam has been decent for us and the projections for Puja in the East are also positive. We expect this momentum to continue across markets as the festival season progresses."

SHOPPING WINDOW

Akhil Jain, CEO, Madame, said the company is expecting to garner 15-20 per cent year-on-year growth during the period, supported by a longer shopping window and improving consumer sentiment.

"What we are seeing is a more value-conscious but not value-averse consumer. Customers are still willing to spend on fashion, but they are looking for stronger reasons to buy, whether that is versatility, quality, newness or the relevance of the product to an occasion. We are also seeing consumers start their festival shopping earlier, with greater digital discovery, followed by store visits and purchases," he added.

Jain said the brand is preparing for the festival season with "sharper occasion-led collections, stronger newness across categories and a more agile inventory approach."

A spokesperson for Myntra said that early trends during Raksha Bandhan and Onam have set the tone for the festival season and as it gathers pace, the platform is witnessing a strong momentum across fashion, beauty, jewellery and gifting.

Post-settlement GST up 16.1% in H1, says TN Finance Secretary

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai



MA Siddique, Tamil Nadu Finance Secretary BIJOY GHOSH

As successive months of decline in Tamil Nadu's SGST collections raise questions around economic activity of the State, the State's Finance Secretary told *businessline* that post-settlement GST revenue is the right metric to assess it, and for H1 of FY27 (April-September) this is up 16.1 per cent to ₹44,266 crore — the highest first-half revenue in recent times.

"It is being wrongly portrayed that tax collection growth is a proxy of economic activity growth. Tax collections are proportional to turnover or economic activity only if tax rates and the cash ratio remain unchanged. But in September 2025 and 2026, both tax rates and cash ratios were significantly different due to GST2.0," MA Siddique, Additional Chief Secretary to the Government and Finance Secretary, said.

Post-settlement GST is the amount available to the State as revenue after the Centre settles the IGST portion to them. Cash ratio refers to the share of the GST liability settled by businesses in cash. The other way of settling is the use of accumulated input tax credits (ITC).

In the last few months, while Tamil Nadu's Gross GST (State, Central levies and IGST) has been showing a marginal decline, the post-settlement GST has seen a healthy double-digit rise. Gross collections fell 5 per cent and post-settlement GST grew 16 per cent in September.

GST 2.0

The Finance Secretary attributed the divergence to GST 2.0 implemented in September 2025. Tamil Nadu's consumption base is B2C-heavy, and most products such as durables and vehicles went from 28 per cent to 18 per cent and others from 12 per cent to 5 per cent under GST 2.0, he said. Further in some sectors, the increase in GST on inputs but slash in rates of output also led to more GST being settled via accumulated credits, he added.

As per Finance Department data, the share of GST settled in cash (to total tax liability) in August 2025 was 19.9 per cent compared to 16.6 per cent in August 2026. In automobiles, for instance, the turnover is up 16.3 per cent but cash tax is down 33 per cent, official data showed. Similarly in cement, while the input coal saw replacement of cess with GST of 18 per cent, the cement output tax itself was reduced to 18 per cent, resulting in lower SGST liability and higher ITV credit.

Regarding other top States, the Finance Secretary said SGST collection growth in Karnataka and Maharashtra has been affected less due to higher service sector share, where GST 2.0 did not have an impact.

Experts *businessline* spoke to also noted that post-settlement revenue is a better measure of what actually accrues to the State's coffers.

The second-half figures starting from November 2026 collections will likely give a clear view. However, the proposals of the GST Council Meeting on October 8, especially around ITC, will also likely have a direct bearing on the State's collection and revenue, he added.

TCS' margin could rise despite modest revenue growth

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) is expected to report healthy margin expansion despite just a modest revenue growth in the September-ending quarter, according to analysts.

The company's performance is likely to be shaped by ongoing investments in the business and geopolitical developments.

Tier-1 IT companies are expected to report modest growth of around 1 per cent this quarter, with TCS seen as a laggard, posting revenue growth of just 0.4-0.6 per cent.

This is largely attributed to continued business investments, the slow ramp-up of large deals, pricing pressures and weakness in the West Asian market, according to PL Capital.

While steady execution in the BFSI, technology and services segments is expected to support growth, softness in the consumer vertical may offset some of the gains. However, rising AI-related revenues are expected to provide support.

AI REVENUE

"Annualised AI services revenue is likely to maintain its strong momentum (after growing more than 13.6 per cent sequentially in Q1), driven by increasing demand for AI-led modernisation, autonomous GBS, cybersecurity and sovereign cloud offerings," said Motilal Oswal Financial Services.

Analysts estimate margin expansion of 40-100 basis points, taking margins to the 26-28 per cent range.

"Continued investments in AI capabilities, talent and partnerships could act as a drag on margins," it said.

Further, total contract value is expected to come in at $8-11 billion, representing about 5 per cent growth, supported by the Porsche mega deal.

GROWTH OUTLOOK

"Deal-wins are likely to remain strong, led by large contracts from MHP, BSNL and Metro. We will closely watch the growth outlook for BFSI and developed markets," said Nuvama Research, which noted a slower-than-expected recovery in the latter part of the quarter.

JM Financial expects the ramp-up of the BSNL project to be delayed until Q3, with operational efficiencies providing some support to margins. Meanwhile, Anand Rathi expects a front-loaded quarter, with strong momentum in July and August, followed by a softer September.

Tata Chemicals awaits Kenya panel decision on Magadi mining ban

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai



R Mukundan, Managing Director, Tata Chemicals Ltd

Tata Chemicals is awaiting the outcome of a high-level technical committee set up by the Kenyan government to resolve issues surrounding the suspension of soda ash mining at Lake Magadi, said R Mukundan, Managing Director of Tata Chemicals Ltd.

The committee, which includes Tata Chemicals Magadi, will examine the issues and determine the way forward for the suspended operations, Mukundan told *businessline* on the sidelines of CII-organised National Leadership Summit here on Wednesday.

"We have the lease of the mine for another 30 years and will wait for the outcome of the committee before moving forward," he said.

STRATEGIC CLARITY

Mukundan also stressed that businesses navigating uncertainty must focus on strategic direction, ask fundamental questions and be prepared to take difficult decisions rather than get caught up in immediate operational challenges.

Mukundan said the more important issue is how companies respond to uncertainty through strategic clarity and principled decision-making.

Drawing on his experience of working closely with Ratan Tata, Mukundan said one of the key lessons he learnt was to be "directionally right, not accurately wrong".

He recalled that when the Tata group was evaluating an entry into auto components, consultants had prepared a detailed report covering the industry and individual components. Tata instead asked when India would reach one million cars, the average component value per vehicle and the market share the group should target.

The questions helped establish the potential scale of the opportunity before the group delved into execution, Mukundan said.

He cited another instance involving a proposed voluntary retirement scheme for temporary workers. Instead of examining the compensation calculations, Tata asked whether workers did not want to work for a full year or whether the company was failing to provide them with enough work. The question exposed an underlying flaw in the proposal.

"Where we cannot win, we exit," Mukundan said, citing the group's exit from telecom, while adding that Tata companies continue to invest in businesses where they believe they can compete.

'Eveready using battery to enter home-care segment'

Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

> In about two-and-a-half to three years from now, we should get 2.5-4 per cent market share
>
> **ANIRBAN BANERJEE**
> CEO, Eveready Industries



Eveready Industries, which is launching the country's first portable liquid vaporiser, is using its strength of batteries to make inroads into home-care segment, according to CEO Anirban Banerjee.

He said that the company is leveraging its knowledge of batteries and distribution network to make innovations too.

The weak monsoon has been a challenge, especially impacting flashlight sales.

Edited excerpts:

Eveready Industries is launching the country's first portable liquid vaporiser. What is the addressable market? How does the company plan to grow in the category?

In the anti-mosquito segment, called the household insecticide segment, there are many categories.

The largest category is liquid vaporisers and the size of this market in India today would be about ₹2,800 crore. This would be growing at around 6-10 per cent.

Currently, most of the liquid vaporisers are designed to remain connected to fixed plug-points.

Our invention lies in making a rechargeable, portable liquid vaporiser. It can drive mosquitoes away.

My sense is that in about two-and-a-half years to three years from now, we should get 2.5-4 per cent market share.

How do you plan to grow distribution and sales in the liquid vaporisers category in the next three years?

This category is subject to licences. All retailers and distribution partners will have to get licence to sell household insecticides.

We will be selling it through all the e-commerce channels.

We will be available in certain modern trade. We will be selling the product in four or five States to start with.

By the end of this financial year, we might have about 0.5-1 per cent market share.

We already are selling mosquito rackets.

So, both of them are a part of our effort to increase our presence in home care.

What will be your strategies to grow the home-care category further, going ahead?

Wherever there is a play of batteries and power, that part we will be slowly addressing.

Our strength lies in power, portable power, knowledge of household batteries.

We are trying to use the best of that knowledge to make products in home care.

In the last couple of months, we have also done many innovations in our flashlights category.

We have launched flashlights for farmers to ward off animals from their farms.

In the last one or two years, we have been launching some of these innovative products.

And, that is why, if you see in our growth track for the last seven-eight quarters, we are holding double-digit top line for a company, which did not have any growth for decades.

We are using our strength of batteries to leveraging in the flashlight category and home-care category.

In the next three years, what percentage of the company's total revenue could be coming from these new and innovative products?

That is difficult to say, but what I can tell you is in the two-three years from now, ideally half of our revenue should come from batteries, and the other half would be from non-batteries.

Currently, around two-third of our revenue comes from batteries, and around one-third comes from flashlight and lighting.

Are you witnessing any impact on demand currently due to the weak monsoon this year?

Yes, there has been a bit of an impact on the demand.

Monsoon has been a challenge, then there is the war.

The monsoon has been a bit of a challenge, especially impacting a bit of the flashlight sale.

It was a bit of a late monsoon. So, the sale got postponed a little bit, but we are still growing in our flashlight segment.

The war has had some impact on raw material costs, which we have tried to kind of mitigate by passing on some of the price to the consumers.

AI overtake human web traffic, reshaping online monetisation

Rohan Das
Chennai

There used to be a time, not too long ago, when a Google search actually involved searching. With AI taking over the Internet, a new paradigm has emerged.

Unlike search engines of the past that sent human traffic to sites, agents today summarise web content in seconds without a human ever having to land on a webpage.

A recent analysis from network services provider Cloudflare said that heavily-crawled web categories, such as retail, computer software, IT & Services and financial services, had seen human traffic decline as much as 40 per cent in less than one year.

The report suggested that as the audience that pays stops reaching sites, revenues — whether through referrals, impressions or subscriptions — had begun to fall, while websites continue to pay for compute and bandwidth.

AI AGENT

Speaking to *businessline,* experts said that businesses and digital marketers will need to treat AI agents as a new distribution channel rather than an extension of traditional search.

Mahesh Makhija, Partner and Technology Consulting Leader, EY India, said he believes that going forward, the web will increasingly be built for two audiences — humans and their agents.



"Businesses will start to maintain two public interfaces: a visual interface designed for people, and a machine interface designed for personal agents like Muse and Dots," he said.

He suggests that while the mix of monetisation through subscriptions, advertising and transactions will most probably change, websites can continue to bring in money by giving agents structured access to content, data and services, measured through usage and transactions.

Cloudflare also highlighted the emergence of a new model where use of web content and datasets by agents are charged by a pay-per-use access, with publishers being compensated when their content is used in an AI-generated answer. Businesses will also have to assess how AI tools currently describe their brands.

Kavir Advani, Co-Founder and Lead Growth Strategist at NorthSight, said that companies will have to first evaluate the gaps between their intended positioning and how they are represented in AI-generated answers.

"They should begin by testing different AI tools to see exactly how these programs describe their brand," he said.

Meanwhile, Cloudflare's analysis also added that the network service handled an average of 115 million HTTP requests in 2026. It also added that over the past year, daily requests from AI agents on its network grew more than 1,700 per cent, with 2026 being the first year where more than half of Internet traffic wasn't human.

Meta finds 5.3 m pieces of child sexual abuse content on its platforms in Jan-June 2026

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Meta, on Wednesday, said it has put additional measures in place to combat child sexual exploitation on its platforms, and in India, it has actioned 5.3 million pieces of child sexual exploitation content on Facebook and Instagram between January and June this year, "with over 98 per cent found and proactively addressed before anyone reported it".

"We identified and improved the efficacy of our systems for identifying ads that either feature CSAM (child sexual abuse material) or that direct people to violating activity off-platform," it noted. The disclosure comes amid a government crackdown on CSAM. In July, the Ministry of Electronics and IT issued a notice to Meta over such ads on Instagram, ordering them to be disabled, and summoned its global executives to India. Meta has since agreed to report child safety cases directly to the I4C cybercrime portal.

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NEW VENDOR REGISTRATION NOTICE

Supplyco invites new vendors to register and participate in its monthly e-tenders and e-auctions for the supply of essential commodities (Rice, Sugar, Pulses & Spices). For detailed registration guidelines, visit www.supplycokerala.com (link-https://www.supplycokerala.com Files/N_143.pdf). For information on e-auctions, visit www.market.neml.in., www.bsebeam.com

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The hike and after

Deft liquidity moves as important as rate hike

The Monetary Policy Committee surprised no one when it announced a 25 basis point hike in repo rate to 5.5 per cent. With growth looking good and inflation rising as a visible concern, a central bank with an inflation-targeting mandate had no option but send a clear message.

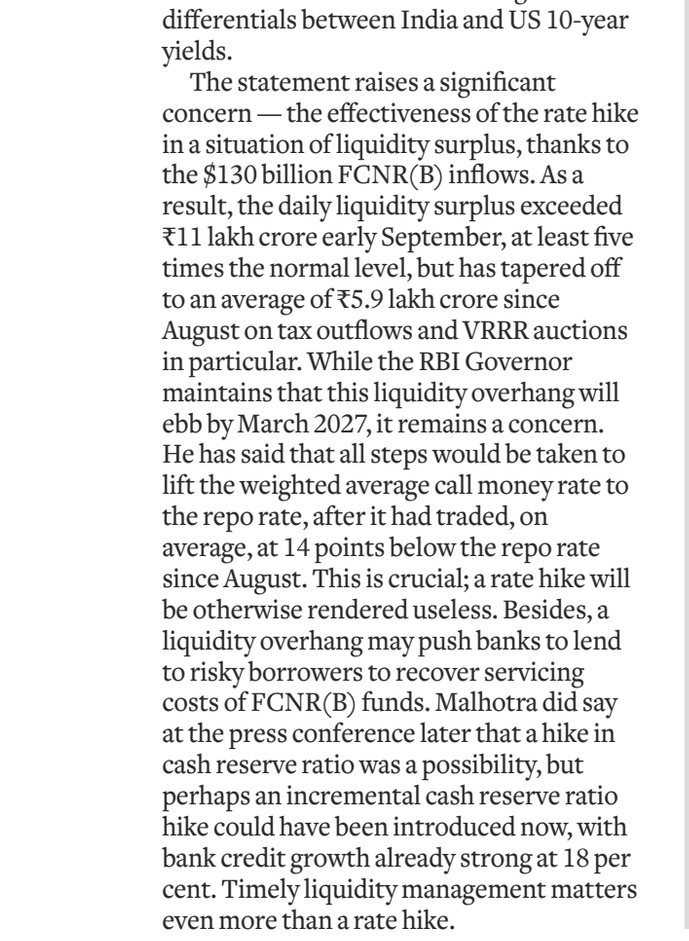
It has announced a new cycle of calibrated tightening after more than three years of neutrality or dovishness. Both global and domestic factors point to the need to raise rates. With headline inflation pegged at 5.2 per cent this fiscal (5.8 per cent in the remaining three quarters) and 5.6 in Q1 of FY28, there is a need to adjust the real interest rate as well. Meanwhile, it may seem surprising that real GDP growth for FY27 has been projected sharply upwards by 40 basis points from the August policy to 7.1 per cent in an El Nino year. Inflation for this fiscal has been upped by 20 basis points, well above the comfort zone under the Flexible Inflation Targeting regime of about 4 per cent.

A core inflation rate of 4.4 per cent for FY27 (lower when precious metals are excluded) underscores signs of inflation being generalised, with expectations too building up as the RBI surveys suggest. This could influence firms' pricing behaviour. An RBI July 2025 paper observes that a 10 per cent increase in oil prices could lift inflation by 30 basis points under incomplete pass through. Since this looks inevitable, second order effects need to be checked. As for the external account, Governor Malhotra referred to a possible rise in current account deficit from Q1 levels of 0.5 per cent of GDP due to rising trade deficits. This arguably called for a pre-emptive response by way of a rate hike to curb currency volatility, given that portfolio outflows have risen on narrowing differentials between India and US 10-year yields.

The statement raises a significant concern — the effectiveness of the rate hike in a situation of liquidity surplus, thanks to the $130 billion FCNR(B) inflows. As a result, the daily liquidity surplus exceeded ₹11 lakh crore early September, at least five times the normal level, but has tapered off to an average of ₹5.9 lakh crore since August on tax outflows and VRRR auctions in particular. While the RBI Governor maintains that this liquidity overhang will ebb by March 2027, it remains a concern. He has said that all steps would be taken to lift the weighted average call money rate to the repo rate, after it had traded, on average, at 14 points below the repo rate since August. This is crucial; a rate hike will be otherwise rendered useless. Besides, a liquidity overhang may push banks to lend to risky borrowers to recover servicing costs of FCNR(B) funds. Malhotra did say at the press conference later that a hike in cash reserve ratio was a possibility, but perhaps an incremental cash reserve ratio hike could have been introduced now, with bank credit growth already strong at 18 per cent. Timely liquidity management matters even more than a rate hike.

POCKET

RAVIKANTH



Tackling mis-selling malaise in insurance

An awareness campaign on the lines of 'mutual fund sahi hai' with the Policyholder Education and Protection Fund will help



POINT BLANK.



LOKESHWARRI SK

Tomy Jose (name changed) had just returned to India after spending almost three decades in Abu Dhabi. He is now retired with a tidy sum saved, which he wanted to invest in a safe option. He consulted his friendly bank manager, who asked him to buy an annuity plan from a life insurer for ₹50 lakh.

A year later, he got a rude shock when the insurance company asked him to pay an annual premium of ₹50 lakh on the policy. He had been made to understand that it was a one-time lump-sum payment. Since he had retired, paying the hefty annual premium was next to impossible. He had to choose between letting the policy lapse, surrendering it or continuing with a reduced premium plan.

This is just one kind of mis-selling, where the essential details are withheld from policyholders. A person who approaches an agent for life insurance policy would typically be sold an endowment plan, where the cover is very low and premium high, instead of term plans where higher cover can be purchased for lower premiums. Many would have purchased unit-linked insurance plans, believing that they would give guaranteed or fixed returns, akin to bank deposits.

The trouble is that conceptual understanding about insurance products is quite low not just in India, but across the globe. These are complex products that are difficult to comprehend. It does not help that the insurance agents are making the most of this poor understanding to earn higher commissions. Thankfully, the authorities appear to be turning serious about tackling the malaise of mis-selling in the country. The consultation paper released recently by IRDAI on distribution reforms outlines the problems as well as the solutions in a succinct manner.

HIGH COMMISSIONS

According to the IRDAI paper, the number of life insurance policies have been stagnating over the past decade, though the value of premium collected has grown multi-fold. This reflects the state of affairs in the industry, where insurers are not doing much to improve penetration, but are targeting the same set of urban and salaried policyholders to generate more revenue. Insurance penetration (defined as gross premium as a percentage of GDP), is at just 3.7 per cent in India, with life insurance at 2.7 per cent and non-life at 1 per cent.

Insurance companies are trying to grow their business through distributors, instead of improving the quality of products and customer experience. The commission structure is tilted towards first-year premiums, and the commissions also vary across products and the term of the policy. This is leading to insurance agents mis-selling policies with higher premiums, without taking the product suitability or the capability of the consumer to pay the premium, into account. The first-year premiums on unit-linked insurance plans range from 5 per cent to 40 per cent, while the commission on other insurance-linked savings products range from 29 per cent to 60 per cent. Intermediaries are, therefore, pushing these savings products to consumers instead of pure term plans. In credit life products, where insurance is bundled with loans, the premium is around 45 per cent of the premium. Banks and NBFCs have been exploiting these products to increase their commission revenue.

The IRDAI could ask all insurers to set aside 2 basis points of annual gross premium to spend for policyholder education and awareness

Mis-selling is resulting in consumers stopping premium payments after a few years. In life insurance, over half of the policies are discontinued before the completion of five years. The crux of these issues is low level of awareness and significant information asymmetry in the sector. Information about the product is limited to insurance companies and agents, who share it rather selectively.

AWARENESS DRIVE

The first step to tackle mis-selling is to launch an awareness drive about insurance; similar to the *mutual fund sahi hai* campaign of the AMFI, or the *RBI kehta hai jaankaar baniye, satark rahiye,* by the central bank. The AMFI campaign, in particular, has been highly successful in increasing awareness about mutual funds as a safe investment option. The sharp increase in mutual fund assets in the past decade can be attributed, in part, to this campaign.

The insurance industry, too, must launch a similar advertising blitzkrieg, maybe using celebrities, to show why insurance is necessary. This campaign should be carried out across media platforms. While the need for insurance can be emphasised in the first phase of advertisements, the second phase can focus on the kind of mis-selling to watch out for.

The Policyholder Education and Protections Fund (PEPF), created by the insurance regulator in June 2026, with an initial corpus of ₹800 crore, must be used for this campaign. While the PEPF is currently being proposed to be created and managed by IRDAI alone, it will be good if all insurers are asked to set aside a sum annually towards a PEPF. In the securities market, mutual fund houses and stock market intermediaries spend more towards investor awareness programmes than the regulator. The same may work in the insurance industry, too.

The IRDAI could ask insurers to set aside 2 basis points of annual gross premiums towards policy holder education and awareness. Involvement of the stakeholders in industry can make the awareness drive much more successful.

BIMA SUGAM PORTAL

Another initiative by the IRDAI, which can prove to be a game-changer in arresting mis-selling, is the Bima Sugam portal. This is being designed as an electronic marketplace for insurance products. The vision is to on-board all insurers and have them display their products across all categories on the portal, so that consumers can easily compare the policies and select the one best suitable for them. What it intends to achieve is quite ambitious: to enable both do-it-yourself and assisted buying and selling of policies, help manage them, raise and track claims, lodge complaints and create awareness. The portal is still work-in-progress. But once completed, it will go a long way in curbing mis-selling by ushering in greater transparency.

India Inc's credit quality remains resilient

In H1FY27, strong domestic demand provided companies with a degree of insulation from volatility in external markets

Sachin Gupta

The geopolitical situation remains tense, energy prices are fluctuating, inflation pressures persist and monetary conditions have tightened in major economies. At the same time, trade policies continue to evolve, requiring businesses to adapt to a changing global operating environment. Nevertheless, India Inc has given an encouraging signal: its credit fundamentals are showing resilience.

Our assessment of credit quality in H1FY27 shows the credit ratio, the proportion of rating upgrades to downgrades, rising to 3.95 times from 1.93 times in H2FY26. There were 300 upgrades against 76 downgrades. The improvement was driven not only by stronger upgrades, but also by a meaningful decline in downgrades. The downgrade rate fell to 4 per cent, an all-time low, while the upgrade rate rose to 16 per cent, above its 10-year average of 15 per cent. The defining strength of the current credit cycle is the resilience of domestic demand.

Consumer-facing sectors — particularly automobiles and textiles — benefited from healthy consumption, supporting revenues, profitability and credit profiles. Infrastructure-led demand provided an additional boost to sectors such as capital goods and iron and steel. This domestic momentum has provided Indian companies with a degree of insulation from volatility in external markets.

The reduction in US tariffs to around 10 per cent during the year also aided the restocking of goods and revived demand from the American market, offering some support to export-oriented businesses, albeit with the renewed risk of a possible rise in tariffs, with India being a major Russian oil importer.

Targeted policy measures have further eased sector-specific pressures. Safeguard duties and anti-dumping duties helped protect the domestic steel industry from import competition, while duty-free cotton fibre imports provided relief to the textile value chain.

Our confidence is underpinned by a sustained improvement in corporate financial health. Between 2016 and 2026, overall gearing (that is, total debt/equity) nearly halved from 1.04 times to 0.50 times (based on an aggregated analysis of around 8,000 entities over the past decade, with financials sourced from the Ace Equity platform), while Profit Before Interest, Lease, Depreciation and Tax margins expanded from 10 per cent to 14 per cent, and interest coverage sustainably increased from 4.10 times to 7.59 times.



ON A ROLL. Manufacturing and services sector saw healthy credit profile

These improvements are fundamental, and they enhance companies' ability to withstand external shocks. Lower leverage provides greater headroom to absorb higher input costs or temporary demand weakness, stronger profitability supports internal cash generation, and improved interest coverage cushions fluctuations in financing costs.

RESILIENCE IS BROAD-BASED

The manufacturing and services sector maintained a healthy credit profile, with its credit ratio improving to 2.84 times in H1FY27 from 2.06 times in H2FY26. Upgrade momentum was supported largely by domestic-focussed mid-sized companies, while large-sized companies also continued to demonstrate a healthy credit profile. Tariff cuts to around 10 per cent during the year and consequent restocking of goods, as well as protection to sectors like steel and textiles, have provided support.

Infrastructure recorded the sharpest improvement, with the credit ratio rising to 8.31 times in H1FY27 from 1.67 times in H2FY26. Upgrades were driven largely by project commissioning, particularly in Hybrid Annuity Model Road projects and renewable power, while timely payments from most state distribution utilities supported faster deleveraging. Further, part of these upgrades can be attributed to a large portfolio-level rating action triggered by a change in the credit profile of the sponsor of a large group.

The BFSI sector also posted a material improvement, with its credit ratio rising to 5.40 times from 2.25 times in H2FY26. Upgrades were supported by stable asset quality and funding profiles, M&A activity, equity infusions and improvements in scale and profitability, while banks remained well capitalised with net NPAs at historical lows. The second half of FY27 may present a sterner test. For now, India Inc stands on a significantly stronger footing, backed by healthier balance sheets, resilient domestic demand and improving credit metrics.

The writer is Chief Rating Officer and Executive Director, CareEdge Ratings. Views are personal

LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

RE policy shines

Apropos 'Boost for Renewables (Oct 7). It is a good augury that the Cabinet has approved a massive outlay of ₹1.86 lakh crore under Green Energy Corridor III (GEC III) Scheme for robust transmission infrastructure, including evacuation of generated power and its storage. The size of the current outlay is manifold when compared to 2015 & 2022. The Centre has addressed two vital impediments in facilitating the usage of renewable energy to the fullest extent. This will avoid many unpleasant situations, such as the forceful curtailment of solar power or a reduction in its buying during peak production periods. Unlike the older versions of GEC, which covered only a few States rich in RE power, the current GEC-III covers many States, including Odisha and Assam. The Centre must find a permanent solution to remove the existing legal impediments and practical constraints in the execution of power purchase agreements by stakeholders for seamless utilisation of RE energy.

RV Baskaran
Pune

Power of the narrative

This refers to the tribute 'Jeffrey Archer – Mightier than the Sword' (Oct 7). The death of Jeffrey Archer marks the end of an era for popular fiction. Beyond his political controversies, Archer's real legacy lies in the millions of readers he captivated with tightly plotted thrillers, memorable characters and cliffhanger endings. His stories brought genuine joy to a global readership. For aspiring writers and ordinary readers alike, he demonstrated the power of narrative, the importance of discipline and the lasting impact of a well-told tale. Indian readers were among his biggest fans. His death reminds us that flawed lives can still produce enduring art.

Bal Govind
Noida

Approach to education

This refers to 'Pocket' (Oct 7). The cartoon makes a telling point about our obsession with marks. Parents often expect children to excel in every subject as if success depends on being proficient in all areas. Yet, the Nobel Prize recognises outstanding achievement in a particular field, not excellence in every discipline. A child may be exceptional in science, literature or mathematics while being average in other subjects. Schools and parents should, therefore, identify individual strengths and nurture them, rather than measure every child by the same yardstick. A broader approach to education can help children discover their real abilities and pursue them with absolute confidence.

Abbharna Barathi
Chennai

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Climate risk to micro loans

Climate events hurt borrower livelihoods, repayments

Abhinav Jindal
Shweta Rai

Microfinance is one of India's deepest financial-inclusion networks, serving about 6.27 crore active borrowers across 685 districts. These households often depend on agriculture, livestock, vending, informal work and small businesses, making them particularly exposed to floods, heatwaves, droughts and erratic rainfall.

The Economic Survey 2025-26 records NBFC-MFIs with 39 per cent of microfinance loan outstanding, followed by banks at 32 per cent, small finance banks at 16 per cent and other NBFCs at 12 per cent. While conventional asset-quality risks are closely monitored, climate-related credit risk remains less visible.



VERIFY. Microfinance delinquency attributable to climate events

INCOMPLETE DIAGNOSIS

Microfinance lenders track days past due, portfolio at risk, collection efficiency, and NPAs. These indicators show what happened to a loan, but not necessarily why. A borrower may become delinquent because of over-borrowing — or because a flood destroyed a crop, extreme heat prevented outdoor work or a cyclone disrupted local commerce.

Evidence already points to this connection. MFIN has reported heatwaves affecting borrower livelihoods and repayment ability. Bandhan Bank has linked Assam floods to weaker collections and slippages, while rating agencies have highlighted natural calamities as risks to repayment and collection efficiency.

A World Bank analysis of Northern Arc Capital's portfolios provides stronger evidence. Across 27,000 microfinance loans in nine districts during the 2018 Kerala floods, collection efficiency fell from 96 per cent to 60 per cent during the flood month. After Cyclone Fani, analysis of 75,000 loans across 14 districts found collection efficiency declining from 97 per cent to 90 per cent before recovering. Yet India lacks a standard public dataset showing what proportion of microfinance delinquency is attributable to verified climate events.

The treatment exists, but is at best fragmented. For instance, The Credit Guarantee Scheme for Microfinance Institutions 2.0 facilitates up to ₹20,000 crore of credit and was estimated to benefit around 36 lakh borrowers. However, it primarily addresses funding stress rather than identifying climate-affected portfolios.

The RBI's natural-calamity framework permits restructuring and fresh lending to affected borrowers. Meanwhile, MFIN, with ADB support, is developing a parametric natural-catastrophe insurance initiative.

Three steps can help bridge the gap between climate risk and microfinance risk.

First, capture the cause alongside delinquency. When repayment deteriorates after a verified flood, drought, cyclone or heatwave, lenders should tag the event against geography, livelihood and subsequent repayment performance.

Second, make climate information part of credit-risk assessment. MFIs can combine district-level hazard data with borrower livelihoods and branch concentration. A dairy borrower in a drought-prone district and a trader in a flood-prone market face different risks even when conventional credit indicators appear similar.

Third, pre-design relief mechanisms. Temporary disruption may require repayment flexibility or emergency liquidity, while persistent livelihood damage may require restructuring, insurance or adaptation finance. Research on BRAC's pre-approved emergency loans for flood-exposed borrowers found benefits for household resilience alongside improved repayment and branch profitability.

India has microfinance support schemes, disaster-relief provisions and emerging climate-risk tools, but these remain disconnected. Linking physical events to livelihood losses, repayment deterioration and appropriate relief can turn climate risk from an episodic disruption into a measurable credit-risk factor.

Jindal is a Senior Economist, and Rai is Vice President, at a private Indian bank. Views are personal



Modest rate hike cycle commences

DAMPENERS. Weakened agricultural outlook, renewed tensions in West Asia prompt MPC to raise inflation projections



ADITI NAYAR

The Monetary Policy Committee's (MPC's) fourth bi-monthly meeting for FY27 marked the onset of the rate tightening cycle in India, in line with the recent actions of major central banks.

A worsening inflation outlook, amid external and domestic headwinds, prompted the Committee to hike the policy repo rate by 25 basis points (bps) and change the policy stance to 'calibrated tightening' from 'neutral', both in line with ICRA's expectations. Interestingly, the change in stance was not unanimous, with two members voting to keep the same unchanged, likely to preserve policy flexibility.

India witnessed deficient Southwest (SW) Monsoon rains, at 87 per cent of the long period average (LPA), during June-September 2026 owing to the development of El Nino conditions — this was the lowest rainfall since 2015 (86 per cent of LPA).

The temporal and spatial distribution was highly uneven, which has raised concerns around kharif crop yields, even though sowing was limited to around 1 per cent lower than last year's levels.

Moreover, deficient rains constrained the build up in reservoir storage, particularly in the Southern and Northern regions, where the lag *vis-à-vis* historical averages is quite severe, at 27 and 21 percentage points, respectively. This is likely to pose concerns for the upcoming rabi sowing season.

These developments have dampened the agricultural outlook, posing material upside risks to food inflation, which has already risen quite rapidly, and is set to edge close to the 7 per cent-mark in September 2026.

Additionally, renewed tensions in West Asia pushed up crude oil prices, which have remained above the $100/barrel mark in September 2026 and early-October.

This accentuated the marketing losses of the Oil Marketing Companies (OMCs) and could portend unpalatable increases in the retail selling prices (RSPs) of the auto fuels, unless a sustained correction in crude prices is forthcoming.

This poses another material concern and could lead to a faster generalisation of inflationary pressures, which has already been underway, depending on the extent and the timing of the RSP hikes.

These risks prompted the MPC to raise its CPI inflation projection for FY27 to 5.2 per cent from 5 per cent earlier. It now expects the headline print to average at 6 per cent in Q3 FY27, the upper end of its medium-term target range of 2-6 per cent, and ease only feebly to 5.7 per cent in Q4 FY27 and 5.6 per cent in Q1 FY28.

GROWTH PROJECTIONS

The MPC's GDP growth projections have also been revised upwards, with the print estimated at 7.1 per cent in FY27 as against 6.7 per cent in the August meeting, in line with ICRA's base case. This follows from the stronger-than-expected growth print for Q1 FY27, and a sizeable 80 bps upward revision in the estimate for Q2 FY27, aided by continued strength in high frequency indicators.

The tailwinds from the previous fiscal on account of the income tax cuts, GST rationalisation, low inflation, monetary easing, and healthy crop output growth are now starting to dissipate. The outlook for agriculture and rural demand remains clouded by the poor monsoon turnout and is likely to manifest into weaker consumption in the near term. Additionally, the strong base of GST rationalisation would weigh on volume growth trends through H2 FY27. Further, elevated input prices would impact growth in value-added of businesses, while rising inflation and the onset of monetary tightening would start weighing on household consumption. Overall, the current rate tightening cycle is likely to be shallow; at the current juncture, it seems as though another 25 bps rate hike in December 2026 should suffice, given the downside risks to growth highlighted above. This is also evident in the softer shift in the policy stance to 'calibrated tightening' instead of 'tightening', notwithstanding the cautiousness in the overall tone of the document.

The tailwinds from the previous fiscal on account of the income tax cuts, GST rationalisation, low inflation, monetary easing, and healthy crop output growth are now starting to dissipate

LIQUIDITY SITUATION

On the liquidity front, with the Weighted Average Call Rate (WACR) persistently trailing the repo since August 2026 amid the deluge of funds owing to the FCNR(B) deposit inflows, the RBI Governor stressed on the need to align the former with the latter. We expect the seasonal currency leakage to drain liquidity by at least ₹3-4 trillion by end-FY2027 from the current levels. Given this, we expect the RBI to stick with Variable Rate Reverse Repos (VRRRs) through H2 FY27 to impound excess liquidity from the banking system, preferring this over other tools, including the more permanent Open Market Operations (OMOs).

Bond yields, which had already hardened following the global bond sell-off, ticked up only slightly after the policy announcement, which was largely in line with market expectations. Once the likelihood of the anticipated rate hike in December 2026 starts to become clearer, yields are likely to harden further. This, along with the paced transmission of the repo hike to bank lending rates, amid ample systemic liquidity, are expected to accentuate the ongoing shift in fund raising towards the banking system from the debt markets in the near term.

The writer is Chief Economist, Head-Research & Outreach, ICRA

China alerts on suspected plague case in Russia

Bloomberg News

Beijing made its first official comments on the suspected case of pneumonic plague in Siberia, saying it's cooperating with Russia as health concerns intensify around the world.

"China and Russia maintain close communication and cooperation in the prevention and control of infectious diseases, including the plague," Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesman Guo Jiakun said Tuesday in response to a question about whether Moscow has informed Beijing of the incident.

The brief remarks, which came during a week-long public holiday in China, follow the death last week of a worker at an anti-plague research institute in Russia's region of Irkutsk that led to almost 200 contacts reportedly being placed under observation.

Coverage of the incident has been limited in Chinese state media.

Just over a month ago, the institution in Irkutsk concluded an emergency response trial with China on handling infectious disease outbreaks. Russian and Chinese participants also discussed how to monitor and control the spread of diseases in their border regions.

The Irkutsk region lies north of Mongolia and doesn't directly border China, but the local capital is a major hub with frequent flights and rail links to Chinese cities. China's consulate in Irkutsk didn't respond to a request for comment.

ASSESSING THE RISK

Mongolia's Ministry of Health released a statement on Wednesday saying it assesses the risk from the incident to be "low."

The ministry added that work will continue to control border security and monitor health at the frontier with Russia in cooperation with relevant agencies. The 28-year-old laboratory worker died after developing severe pneumonia. Unconfirmed local news reports said the researcher may have been exposed to the bacterium that causes plague after breaking a test tube.



HOTSPOT. The Medical Assistance and Rescue Centre in Russia REUTERS

Russia's public health agency has said an investigation showed no laboratory accident involving dangerous microorganisms. It also determined that extensive testing of samples from the woman found no microorganisms associated with her work. The official cause of her illness remains pneumonia of "unknown" origin. No plague infections have been confirmed among her contacts, and Russian authorities say the epidemiological situation is stable.

A FEARED DISEASE

Plague is one of the world's most feared diseases, responsible for pandemics that killed tens of millions of people. Today, though, human cases are rare and can usually be treated with antibiotics.

US President Donald Trump said Tuesday he has a call scheduled with Russian President Vladimir Putin to discuss the case "very soon."

He indicated that the US would have more to share about the matter. "So far, we're in very deep discussions. We'll be able to report about it probably tomorrow," the president said.

thehindu businessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

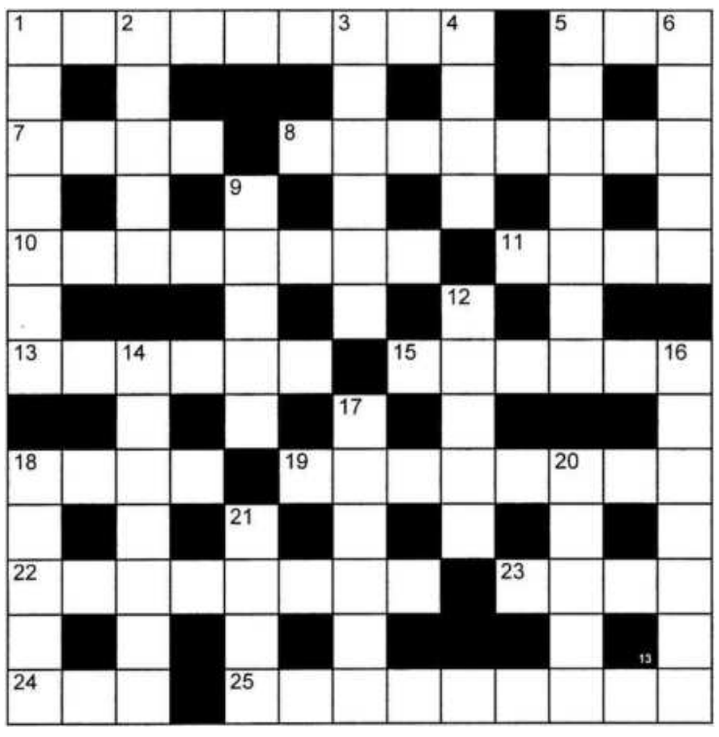
October 8, 2006

'Navaratna' cos to help revive bleeding PSUs
Having failed to make much headway in its efforts to disinvest loss-making Central Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs), the Centre is now working with the revised strategy to turn around bleeding firms by handing over their management to bluechip 'Navaratna' enterprises, with the option of transferring controlling stake also on the cards.

SEZs: States to be responsible for land acquisition
The Centre will make it mandatory for State governments to look into the type of land that would be acquired before it sends its recommendations for setting up Special Economic Zones and industrial projects, the Minister for Industry, Mr Kamal Nath, said. First priority would be given to wasteland, he said.

Rlys to set up rolling stock units through jt ventures
Indian Railways plans to set up rolling stock units in partnership with international companies. It is likely to have a 26 per cent ownership in the joint venture. Railways has decided in principle to set up the proposed coach, loco and wheel factories by inviting joint venture partners through a global competitive bidding.

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2752



EASY

ACROSS
1. A sideways somersault (9)
5. Fuel (3)
7. Ground set aside for pleasure (4)
8. Frightening (8)
10. Dresses a wound (8)
11. Zone (4)
13. Take into one's arms (6)
15. Something showy but of little value (6)
18. Tub (4)
19. Photographic developing area (8)
22. Seemingly mocked by fate (8)
23. Cable (4)
24. Pluto; the underworld (3)
25. With no comfort, gloomy (9)

DOWN
1. Qualified, skilful (7)
2. Arrange race afresh (5)
3. Devonshire city (6)
4. Piece of mischief, frolic (4)
5. Crawls in fear (7)
6. Perspire (5)
9. Waste time by trifling (5)
12. Shaky; not in good condition (5)
14. Silly, imbecile (7)
16. Gasteropods; clinging mines (7)
17. Untamed, wild (6)
18. Sightless (5)
20. Oil-producing tree (5)
21. A record (4)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS
1. Acrobatic move one may need a spokesman to complete? (9)
5. Idle talk is what makes car run in America (3)
7. Leave the car at the pleasure-ground (4)
8. Be afraid of part that is awe-inspiring (8)
10. It takes the musicians so long to get dressing (8)
11. It may have to be tightened if one is straitened (4)
13. In the end, half follow to take you in their arms (6)
15. Cheap glitter one may have to listen to (6)
18. West Country city in which to come clean (4)
19. How to mark door behind which things are developing (8)
22. Hard metal one takes to California as if mocked by fate (8)
23. Down to which the race is run in full (4)
24. The underworld is back inside (3)
25. As it's gloomy, don't sound so approving (9)

DOWN
1. It could be alpaca, endlessly used by the skilful (7)
2. To get a second impression, do the race again (5)
3. Previous partner planted out tree here in Devon (6)
4. A bird is something not to be taken seriously (4)
5. Abases oneself as might lover in G&S (7)
6. It could be a waste of perspiration (5)
9. Exchange caresses with first love, twice in 24 hours (5)
12. Not being well, took this back seat (5)
14. The Football Association turned us out for being so silly (7)
16. They stick fast to the pelts I'm making (7)
17. A wise man going around Virginia finds it wild (6)
18. Is unable to see Venetian at the window (5)
20. Is sort of green and stony-hearted (5)
21. No longer in the Top Ten because it's slipped? (4)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2751

ACROSS 1. Mussel 4. Mystic 9. Niagara 10. Scrum 11. Gull 12. Room 13. Err 15. Prop 16. Skit 19. Cos 21. Gold 22. Grin 24. Erato 25. Termini 26. Kernel 27. Wangle

DOWN 1. Managing clerk 2. Scallop 3. Elan 5. Yashmaks 6. Three 7. Comprehensive 8. Capon 14. Mongoose 17. Turning 18. Clots 20. Stair 23. Aria

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CHENNAI
businessline.
THURSDAY - OCTOBER 8 - 2026

Global shares, euro slide as energy shock, France fiscal worries escalate

UNDER PRESSURE. Europe's Stoxx 600 down 1.1%, near its lowest level since June, US S&P 500 slides 0.6%

Reuters



BOND BITES. Equities across Europe fell on Wednesday, including DAX of Germany, amid concerns over debt markets REUTERS

Global stocks and the euro pulled back on Wednesday as oil prices rose above $100 amid renewed West Asia tensions while concerns France's fiscal woes could affect broader debt markets continued to weigh on overall sentiment.

The S&P 500 slid 0.6 per cent, a day after it hit a new record. The tech-heavy Nasdaq fell 0.85 per cent, also pulling back from a fresh all-time high.

MSCI's main world stocks index fell 0.9 per cent, while Europe's Stoxx 600 was down 1.1 per cent, near its lowest level since June.

"In the very early stages of the fourth quarter, typically the best quarter of the year for equity returns, markets are being driven by a confusing 'stocks up, US breadth down, yields up, oil down and up, and down...' narrative," said Jeremy Batstone-Carr, an economist at Raymond James.

Brent crude rose 1.65 per cent to $102.24 per barrel as the market weighed supply constraints from a storm heading for US oil-producing regions and attacks by Yemen's Iran-backed Houthis on Saudi Arabia.

Aneeka Gupta, Director of research at WisdomTree, credited still "really strong" earnings expectations for the stock market's relative resilience in the face of rallying oil prices. "That's what's really holding up the market so far," Gupta said.

The French yield spread against safe-haven German Bunds — a market gauge of the risk premium investors demand to hold French debt — was about 11 basis points (bps) wider after narrowing for two days. It was last at 140 bps, and reached almost 160 bps last week.

French bonds have been under pressure as expectations of higher European Central Bank rates and political uncertainty before the 2027 election raise doubts over France's ability to fix its finances.

"Clearly the market is punishing France on its level of debt," WisdomTree's Gupta said.

EURO DWINDLES

The rekindling of investor concerns weighed on the euro, which slipped 0.7 per cent to $1.118. It slid to a 17-month low against the dollar at $1.1161 earlier this week.

Markets also closely watched the rate divergence between the US and the euro area as they priced in a more hawkish Federal Reserve after the mid-September policy meeting.

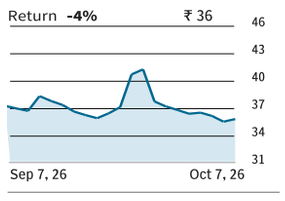
"The interest rate spread between Germany and the US became more negative, which provided support to the US dollar against the euro," Georgette Boele, senior currency and oil strategist at ABN AMRO, said.

Market participants will closely watch a 10-year Treasury bond auction later in the day and a 30-year auction on Thursday, which will show the depth of investor demand for US debt, analysts said.

QUICKLY.

Ola sets ₹27 as price for ₹1,000-crore rights issue

Ola Electric



Bengaluru: Ola Electric has fixed the price of its ₹1,000-crore rights issue at ₹27 a share, a discount of about 26 per cent to the company's current market price, as the electric two-wheeler maker seeks to raise fresh capital from existing shareholders. The company said its board approved the issue price and a two-call payment structure. Under the arrangement, shareholders will pay 60 per cent of the issue price, or ₹16.20 a share, on application, while the remaining ₹10.80 will be payable through a final call on a date to be decided by the board. The two-stage payment structure spreads the funding requirement for investors while allowing Ola Electric to raise capital without requiring the entire amount upfront. OUR BUREAU

Merchant banker norms eased for debt issuers

New Delhi: SEBI has exempted certain listed issuers from mandatory appointment of merchant bankers for private placement of debt securities. The relaxation aims to ease the issuance of debt securities and expand retail investors' access to high-rated securities. On Wednesday, the watchdog said they must be registered with a financial regulator such as SEBI, RBI, IRDAI or PFRDA, and should have been listed on a recognised stock exchange for at least one year. Also, there should be no pending fines or penalties imposed by SEBI or exchanges for non-compliance with listing obligations. PTI

JM Financial, ICICI Sec top IPO deals in H1

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

JM Financial managed the highest number of mainboard IPOs in the first half of FY27, handling 22 issues, according to Prime Database.

The firm also topped the broader equity issuance table by value, managing issues worth ₹75,775 crore, followed by ICICI Securities at ₹73,310 crore and SBI Capital Markets at ₹72,879 crore.

The IPO market saw strong activity in the first half of the current financial year, with 78 companies mobilising ₹94,205 crore, up 35 per cent from the previous high of ₹69,533 crore in the year-ago period.

JM Financial was followed by Axis Capital, which managed 15 offerings. The broader league table covers IPOs and other equity-linked instruments, including QIPs, InvITs and REITs.

For JM Financial, the data highlighted the breadth of its capital-markets franchise, which spans investment banking and institutional equities and research, as well as wealth management and broking.

Neha Agarwal, MD & Head of Equity Capital Markets, JM Financial, said fundraising surged as markets stabilised on the back of lower crude prices, allowing corporates with strong capex requirements to leverage the short window of opportunity.

"Looking ahead, our pipeline remains strong. However, escalating geopolitical uncertainties and crude volatility will likely pivot investor behaviour from momentum-driven to quality-driven. We expect the market to remain active but highly selective, placing a premium on reasonable valuations, proven business models and clear earnings visibility," she added.

HD Fire Protect IPO fixes ₹258-271 as price band

Our Bureau
Mumbai

HD Fire Protect has fixed a price band of ₹258- 271 per share for its proposed initial public offering (IPO), which will open on October 13.

The IPO is entirely an offer for sale for ₹712 crore. The OFS consists of 2.63 crore shares by promoters Harish Narshi Dharamshi and Kusum Harish Dharamshi.

A discount of ₹25 a share is being offered to eligible employees bidding in the employee quota. Investors can bid for a minimum of 55 shares. The company has appointed Ambit, Anand Rathi Advisors and IIFL Capital Services as the book-running lead managers for the IPO.

The company supplies its products to Saudi Aramco. It produces fire suppression equipment and has two manufacturing facilities and eight product categories across Thane and Jalgaon, with a total export footprint exceeding 90 countries.

It offers water, foam and gas-based fire suppression systems in domestic and international markets, which contributed 65 per cent and 35 per cent of revenue from operations in FY26.

Titan slips 4% on Q2 update, but analysts stay positive

Madhu Balaji
Bengaluru

Titan shares fell nearly 4 per cent on Wednesday after the company's Q2FY27 business update showed domestic jewellery growth of 21 per cent y-o-y, below some brokerage estimates, while the festive calendar shift to Q3FY27 and weaker investment-led coin demand also weighed on the quarter.

The stock closed 3.8 per cent lower at ₹4,377 on the NSE, after hitting a low of ₹4,335.60.

The company's consumer businesses registered growth of 25 per cent y-o-y in Q2FY27. Titan's jewellery portfolio across all brands recorded 21 per cent y-o-y growth in Q2FY27.

Consumer demand remained healthy for most of the quarter, with some softening towards the close due to the shift in the festive calendar to Q3FY27.

Studded jewellery grew in the early thirties, supported by the 'Festival of Diamonds' and brand-level promotions, while plain gold jewellery grew 20 per cent y-o-y. Investment-led coin demand declined in the high single digits y-o-y off a high base.

The watches business recorded 30 per cent y-o-y growth. Analog watches grew in the early thirties, while the smart watches business recovered with high single-digit growth during the quarter. Eye care delivered 28 per cent y-o-y growth.

Among emerging businesses, fragrances grew in the mid-thirties, women's bags grew in the twenties and Taneira recorded high single-digit growth.

Mixed targets

	Reco.	Target (₹)
Antique Stock Broking	Buy	5,678
Nomura	Buy	5,425
Citi	Buy	5,700
CLSA	Outperform	5,590
HSBC	Buy	5,510
Morgan Stanley	Overweight	5,483
JPMorgan	Overweight	5,540
360One	Hold	4,950

'BELOW EXPECTATIONS'

Citi retained its 'Buy' rating on Titan with a target price of ₹5,700. It said domestic jewellery growth, excluding bullion was around 20 per cent y-o-y, below its 27 per cent estimate, but attributed the miss primarily to the festive shift to Q3FY27 and weaker investment-led coin demand rather than an underlying slowdown in demand.

CLSA maintained an 'Outperform' rating with a target price of ₹5,590. It noted domestic jewellery growth of 21 per cent y-o-y, above its consensus expectation of 19.3 per cent. CLSA also highlighted 30 per cent growth in watches and 28 per cent growth in eye care. HSBC retained its 'Buy' rating with a target price of ₹5,510. It said Titan reported lower-than-expected Q2 sales partly due to the shift in festive timing, while the mix was expected to be better, given lower gold coin sales and a higher studded jewellery share.

JPMorgan maintained an 'Overweight' rating with a target price of ₹5,540. It said Q2FY27 revenue was below expectations, with domestic jewellery growth moderating to 21 per cent y-o-y due to softer buyer growth, a high single-digit decline in gold coins and consumption deferment linked to the festive shift into Q3.

SME textile companies stitching their growth path through IPOs

Gayathri G
Chennai

Looms to listings

Companies	IPO size (₹ cr)	Segment
Vinod Texworld	43.00	Dyed and printed fabrics
Panchatv Bharat	25.00	Unstitched denim fabrics
Vivekanand Cotspin	22.20	Cotton and yarn
Unitec Fibres	34.47	Recycled polyester staple fibre
Paramount Syntex	84.00	Synthetic fibres, dyed fibres and yarns
TNA Solutions	37.86	Home textile products

The textile industry, traditionally dominated by closely knit family businesses, is increasingly turning to the capital markets to fund its next phase of growth.

A growing number of small and mid-sized textile and apparel companies across the value chain are tapping the SME IPO route to raise funds for capacity expansion, working capital, debt reduction and diversification into higher-value products.

TNA Solutions, Kumar Cotton Mills, Decent Spinners and Manisha Textiles have filed draft papers in the textiles category in 2026, while Tirupati Balaji Exim and Unitec Fibres are among those in the textiles-fabrics segment.

Textile manufacturing is working-capital intensive, with companies having to fund raw material purchases, inventory and receivables. Customer recovery cycles can stretch to 90-120 days, adding to the pressure on cash flows and interest costs.

"More small and mid-sized textile and apparel companies are choosing the SME IPO route because it gives them a practical way to raise ₹10-70 crore for expansion, machinery, working capital and debt reduction — needs that are central to textile businesses but often difficult to fund through bank borrowing alone," said Anish Maheshwari, CEO and MD, VSure Investments Affairs.

EXPANSION PUSH

The sector is also moving beyond conventional yarn and fabric manufacturing. Companies are increasingly entering synthetic fibres, technical textiles, nonwoven fabrics, specialised fabrics and value-added apparel, opening up newer markets.

The government's push for man-made fibre textiles and technical textiles has also encouraged investments in newer segments. For smaller manufacturers, equity capital can help finance such investments without relying entirely on bank borrowing.

"The best textile SME IPOs are those where capital is clearly tied to capacity utilisation, export orders, product diversification or technology upgrades," he said.

EXPORT OPPORTUNITY

Export potential is another factor driving interest. According to domestic brokerage PL Capital, the global apparel market stood at approximately $1.9 trillion in 2025 and is expected to grow at a 4.1 per cent CAGR between 2026 and 2034.

Against this backdrop, India's textile and apparel exports stood around $37 billion in FY26, it said.

"India's apparel export share was approximately 3 per cent in 2025, compared with 27.3 per cent for China, 6.8 per cent for Bangladesh and 6.5 per cent for Vietnam, highlighting the headroom for India to increase its participation in global sourcing," the brokerage added.

Maheshwari said export recovery, free trade agreements (FTAs), China-plus-one sourcing and improved capacity utilisation were positive factors, but their impact remained uneven across the sector.

For promoters of family-run businesses, a public listing could provide access to equity capital while creating a platform for future fundraising as the company grows.

"Investors are not adequately pricing the risks in many small textile IPOs," Maheshwari said.

Subscription interest, grey-market activity and small issue sizes could sometimes obscure weak earnings quality, customer concentration, commodity exposure and poor liquidity, he cautioned.

Kotak Securities rebrands retail as Kotak Neo

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

Kotak Securities Ltd on Wednesday rebranded its retail business as Kotak Neo, consolidating its digital trading platform, research services and relationship-based wealth management under a single customer-facing identity.

The rebrand, effective October 7, does not alter the legal entity, existing customer accounts or regulatory framework. Kotak Securities remains the incorporated company; Kotak Neo is the retail brand through which it will now engage customers.

Alongside the rebrand, the company launched two new business lines: Kotak Neo Private Client Group, which targets high net worth individuals with open-architecture wealth solutions, and Connect Plus, a distributor programme offering mutual funds, equity broking, insurance, portfolio management services and alternative investment funds.

Shripal Shah, MD and CEO of Kotak Neo, said investors were increasingly looking beyond individual products toward integrated wealth-building and that the rebrand aimed to consolidate that experience within one ecosystem.

BROKER'S CALL.

Aditya Birla Capital

PHYSICSWALLAH (BUY)
Target: ₹150
CMP: ₹139.4
PhysicsWallah has built one of India's largest education ecosystems through its community-led digital funnel, anchored by JEE and NEET and expanding across multiple education categories. The platform supports both a scaled online business and a rapidly maturing offline network.
While online remains the primary earnings engine, we believe the next phase of value creation is likely to be driven by increased monetisation of its learner base and improving offline economics as more centres mature. With scale largely proven, the focus is increasingly shifting towards monetisation, profitability and returns. The scale of the existing learner base provides meaningful headroom to increase revenue per user.
We estimate revenue to grow from ₹3,900 crore in FY26 to ₹7,450 crore in FY29E (24.1 per cent CAGR), with EBITDA margins expanding from 9.8 per cent to 21.3 per cent and PAT reaching ₹840 crore. While offline profitability is likely to depend on improving centre maturity, utilisation and academic outcomes, we believe the current valuation underappreciates PhysicsWallah's earnings potential and improving return profile.
We initiate coverage with a Buy rating and a SOTP-based target price of ₹150/share.
Key risks include slower online monetisation, weaker student outcomes, delayed offline profitability, AI-led disruption, and adverse regulatory developments.

Motilal Oswal

MOLBIO DIAGNOSTICS (BUY)
Target: ₹1,800
CMP: ₹1,543.75
Molbio is a diagnostics technology company built around Truenat, its portable molecular testing platform that enables rapid point-of-care testing (POCT) with minimal infrastructure — bringing molecular diagnostics closer to the patient.
With 12,500+ Truenat devices across 90+ countries, 43 assays covering 30 diseases and a $9.3 billion global POCT infectious-disease market growing at about 23 per cent CAGR, Molbio has a long runway for growth.
We believe Molbio is well positioned to capture the opportunity in decentralised molecular diagnostics via its integrated Truenat ecosystem, combining proprietary molecular diagnostic devices with a recurring test-kit franchise. The expanding installed base, widening assay menu and global scale-up are key levers for sustainable growth, while increasing utilisation should drive operating leverage.
We model a 23 per cent revenue CAGR, 910bp margin expansion, and 50 per cent PAT CAGR over FY26-29E. We assign a 45x 12-month forward earnings multiple to arrive at a target price of ₹1,800. (bull case TP: ₹2,575; bear case TP of ₹1,100). We initiate coverage with a Buy rating.
Key risks are customer concentration, high revenue contribution of TB testing, delays in regulatory approvals and slower-than-expected adoption of Truenat.

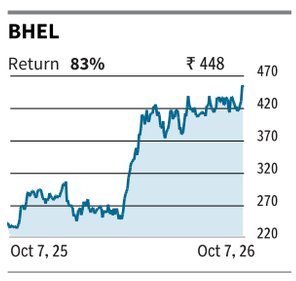
businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

BHEL (₹448.90): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

BHEL



The short-term outlook is bullish for Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd (BHEL). After surging over 5 per cent on Tuesday, the stock remained stable on Wednesday.

Tuesday's rise has taken the share price well above a key resistance level of ₹439. It also marks the end of the consolidation that was in place since mid-July. The region between ₹439 and ₹437 will now act as a good support and limit the downside.

The BHEL share price can rise to ₹490 in the coming weeks. Traders can buy the shares now at ₹449. Accumulate on dips at ₹441. Keep the stop-loss at ₹421 initially. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹455 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹462. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹465 and ₹475 when the price touches ₹472 and ₹480 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹488.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

22618 » **Nifty 50 Futures**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
22600	22485	22760	22860	Go long on a break above 22760. Keep the stop-loss at 22730

₹704 » **HDFC Bank**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
701	695	709	715	Take fresh shorts below 701. Keep the stop-loss at 703

₹992 » **Infosys**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
989	979	1005	1025	Go short only below 989. Stop-loss can be kept at 991

₹264 » **ITC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
262	258	266	270	Take fresh shorts below 262. Keep the stop-loss at 263

₹222 » **ONGC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
221	219	223	226	Go long only above 223. Stop-loss can be kept at 222

₹1207 » **Reliance Ind.**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1195	1180	1225	1255	Go long now and at 1198. Keep the stop-loss at 1190

₹955 » **SBI**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
946	940	960	965	Take fresh longs above 960. Keep the stop-loss at 959

₹2086 » **TCS**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2075	2040	2105	2125	Go long on dips at 2080. Stop-loss can be placed at 2070

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers ▼ 173.05 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
ICICI Bank	1357.50	22.77	16.31	9.30
Bharti Airtel	1833.90	15.38	31.43	5.33
Kotak Bank	440.00	12.89	21.57	3.10
BSE Ltd	3356.00	4.50	48.51	1.31
Coal India	414.50	1.48	8.19	0.95
Max Healthcare	908.00	0.88	60.64	0.65
HDFC Life	546.05	0.49	60.06	0.56
Bajaj Finance	963.85	0.44	29.06	2.51
Apollo Hosp	7917.00	0.06	52.41	0.78
Dr Reddys Lab	1203.80	-0.55	31.56	0.70
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	216.44	-1.04	69.16	0.68
TataConsumerProduct	968.50	-1.06	58.37	0.60
Trent Ltd.	2890.30	-1.13	84.93	0.92
Bajaj Finserv	1743.30	-1.14	13.53	0.97
Tata Motors PV	283.00	-1.27	0.00	0.57
Eternal Ltd.	328.00	-1.57	731.02	2.27
Cipla	1327.20	-1.58	31.95	0.71
Tech Mahindra	1491.10	-1.84	28.31	0.91
ONGC	221.88	-1.95	6.23	0.82
ITC	265.70	-2.08	16.50	2.45
SBI Life	1726.10	-2.32	66.59	0.74
UltraTech Cement	10658.00	-2.35	36.64	1.21
NestleIndia	1324.00	-2.70	66.99	0.91
Eicher Motors	6960.00	-2.71	33.10	0.92
IntGlobeAvi	4990.00	-2.96	0.00	1.08
Bajaj Auto	9884.00	-3.14	23.51	1.03
Axis Bank	1242.50	-3.42	13.85	3.42
Grasim Ind	2921.10	-3.91	17.47	1.05
PowerGrid Corp	253.05	-4.06	14.81	1.10
State Bank	954.00	-4.24	9.82	3.77
TCS	2080.30	-4.35	15.04	2.03
HCL Tech	1185.00	-4.42	18.44	1.19
NTPC	316.75	-4.83	10.84	1.44
Maruti Suzuki	11450.00	-4.92	25.11	1.42
Asian Paints	2372.10	-5.09	47.04	1.03
Shriram Finance Ltd.	948.00	-5.16	19.71	1.27
Sun Pharma	1781.00	-5.29	35.27	1.80
Tata Steel	175.64	-5.47	19.47	1.39
Adani Ports	1750.10	-5.64	30.73	1.31
Hind Unilever	1865.40	-5.71	41.77	1.58
JSW Steel	1230.00	-6.16	10.74	1.13
Bharat Elec	378.30	-7.04	44.98	1.30
Adani Enter	2743.00	-7.83	49.42	0.89
Hindalco	910.85	-9.28	12.48	1.26
M&M	2800.00	-10.62	17.20	2.39
Reliance Ind	1207.70	-14.88	18.54	7.72
Titan	4377.00	-15.45	67.46	1.73
Infosys	992.00	-16.68	13.28	3.35
L&T	3701.50	-17.33	25.95	4.14
HDFC Bank	702.75	-28.82	13.13	10.30

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers ▼ 569.70 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Adanigreenenergy	1341.40	27.19	102.96	1.85
Punjab Natl Bank	114.59	26.26	5.95	1.62
Union Bank	173.15	25.99	6.40	1.38
Avenuesuper	3636.00	24.93	77.57	2.41
Polycab India	8310.00	24.89	43.10	1.83
Divis Lab	9588.00	13.80	87.02	5.02
Canara Bank	119.15	12.77	5.45	1.65
Power Finance	325.55	12.27	3.19	1.95
Bank Of Baroda	234.55	9.64	6.59	1.79
Siemens Energy India .	3344.00	9.22	80.03	1.22
Bajaj Holdings	10662.00	7.67	13.19	1.90
Varun Beverages .	440.75	5.66	43.73	2.48
Hitachi Energy	31610.00	-1.09	122.47	1.66
Solar Industries	20050.00	-1.46	88.49	2.01
Idea Cellular	13.18	-2.36	3.82	1.49
Tata Capital	320.55	-2.43	24.84	0.73
Zyduslifesciences	1153.00	-4.60	25.04	1.18
Indian Railway Finance Corp	76.15	-6.08	13.84	0.70
Mazagoan Dock	2064.40	-7.94	29.18	0.65
Godrej Consumer	865.55	-7.98	46.29	1.43
Ambuja Cements	356.90	-8.28	17.10	0.92
Hindus Zinc	551.00	-9.13	13.64	1.09
Muthootfin	2654.40	-9.68	9.30	1.17
Samvardmothersoninternatl	159.20	-10.09	36.89	2.89
Gail (India)	170.71	-10.55	11.37	1.89
Ltimindtree	3930.00	-10.90	22.43	1.50
Bosch	44410.00	-14.62	55.43	1.59
Siemens	3793.00	-15.40	92.98	1.38
Indian Oilcorp	130.00	-17.07	5.14	2.00
Wipro	159.60	-17.33	11.90	1.78
Abb India	7005.00	-17.62	95.45	1.51
Hyundai Motor India .	1945.00	-17.88	31.92	1.14
Cummins Inida	4872.20	-18.06	57.05	2.71
Dlf	656.00	-18.50	36.52	1.73
Vedanta	261.40	-21.12	6.12	1.89
Hdfc Amc	2314.80	-21.93	33.70	1.95
Torrent Pharma	4716.20	-23.46	83.20	2.86
Bpcl	296.35	-23.79	7.50	2.45
Jindal Steel	1061.00	-26.38	39.96	1.62
Pidilitind	1488.50	-28.39	56.62	1.90
Adani Energy Solutions .	1318.80	-29.17	52.19	1.77
Tata Power	345.15	-31.18	20.98	2.39
Vedanta Aluminium	394.00	-34.13	0.00	2.75
Cg Power & Ind Sol	894.50	-34.29	113.82	2.53
Britannia Ind	4780.00	-34.92	44.11	2.32
Tata Motors Cv	427.90	-35.24	37.64	3.68
Tvs Motor Cmp .	3926.00	-36.90	51.79	3.80
Hindustanaeronautics	4746.30	-37.77	34.05	3.71
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1564.70	-57.36	23.24	2.79
Adani Power .	196.94	-64.89	26.13	3.37

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

Paytm Payments Bank no more a scheduled bank



Mumbai: The Reserve Bank has officially removed Paytm Payments Bank from the list of recognised scheduled banks following the cancellation of its banking licence. In April, the RBI had cancelled the banking licence issued to PPBL for non-compliance with norms, saying affairs of the bank were conducted in a manner detrimental to the interest of its depositors. Later, the Delhi High Court ordered that PPBL be wound up. "PPBL has been excluded from the Second Schedule to the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934...," the RBI said. PTI

India, Canada agree to extradition co-operation



New Delhi: India and Canada have agreed to deepen coordination on combating transnational organised crime, terrorism, violent extremism, and the extradition of criminal offenders, a move that comes amid New Delhi's growing concerns over the activities of pro-Khalistani elements from Canadian soil. These issues were discussed during talks in New Delhi on Tuesday between National Security Adviser Ajit Doval and David Morrison, the Senior Diplomatic and International Affairs Advisor to the Canadian prime minister. Morrison was on a three-day visit to India from October 5 to 7. PTI

UPI payment players look beyond MDR to build bigger merchant-service biz

NEW REVENUES. Most small merchant transactions are below ₹2,000, prompting payment firms to focus on other services

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

Payment companies are looking beyond UPI transactions to build broader merchant-services businesses, as the introduction of merchant discount rate (MDR) creates a new, albeit limited, revenue stream from select transactions.

The new MDR applies only to person-to-merchant (P2M) UPI transactions above ₹2,000, leaving a large share of everyday merchant payments outside its scope. As a result, fintech firms are increasingly focusing on lending, reconciliation, analytics, loyalty programmes and other value-added services that can generate higher revenues from merchants.



EYEING NEWER AVENUES. Fintech firms are increasingly focusing on lending, reconciliation, analytics, loyalty programmes and other value-added services

LIMITED IMPACT

According to Sabyasachi Senapati, COO of BharatPe, nearly 95 per cent of transactions, particularly in smaller towns, are unlikely to attract MDR because average ticket sizes remain below ₹2,000.

"MDR will benefit the overall ecosystem by supporting continued investment in payments infrastructure, technology and distribution, but it will not be a significant revenue driver for companies," he said.

"The larger opportunity will continue to be in building a stronger merchant proposition through lending and value-added services such as soundboxes, instant settlements and bill payments."

The distinction is particularly relevant for fintechs serving small merchants, where payments continue to function primarily as a customer-acquisition and engagement layer rather than a standalone profit centre.

Raman Khanduja, Co-founder and CEO of Mintoak, said the real opportunity lies in deepening merchant relationships rather than merely monetising payment flows.

"Payments are the only financial service that touches a merchant's business every day, making them a natural entry point to understand business needs and offer adjacent services," he said. "The long-term economics will therefore come from combining sustainable payment revenues with deeper financial and business services."

SMALL SHARE

For larger merchants, however, MDR could alter the economics of merchant acquisition and servicing.

Ashish Singhal, Co-founder of CoinSwitch and Lemonn, said the fee would apply to only a small share of merchant transactions, with payment providers retaining only a fraction of the MDR after sharing it among participants in the payments ecosystem. "The race is no longer for the most QR codes, but for the merchants whose average ticket size exceeds ₹2,000," Singhal said.

Singhal expects payment companies to increasingly bundle merchant credit, reconciliation and settlement software, smart POS devices and soundboxes with services such as billing, GST invoicing and inventory management.

Credit-on-UPI acceptance could also emerge as a key focus area, while loyalty programmes and analytics tools are likely to be used primarily to improve merchant retention.

The shift could gradually move the industry away from measuring success by the number of QR codes deployed towards assessing the quality, engagement and monetisation potential of acquired merchants.

Gabriel India, Forvia set up ₹100-crore JV for auto seating business

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Gabriel India and France's Forvia are joining forces to target about 10 per cent of India's automotive seating market within five years through a ₹100 crore equity joint venture, as the market is projected to reach €4 billion by 2030.

At that size, a 10 per cent share would represent roughly €400 million, or about ₹3,500 crore, in annual business.

This is an implied market opportunity, not company revenue guidance.

The partnership combines Forvia's global seating technology with ANAND Group's manufacturing and customer network, significantly expanding Gabriel's addressable market beyond its traditional ride-control business.

Forvia expects India's seating market to grow about 7 per cent annually between 2025 and 2030, driven by higher vehicle volumes and rising content per vehicle.

Jaisal Singh, Vice-Chairman, ANAND Group, called the partnership "a natural extension of Gabriel India's transformation into a broader mobility solutions enterprise".

OEM OPPORTUNITY

Forvia already counts Mahindra, Tata Motors, Maruti Suzuki, Skoda and Volkswagen among its Indian customers.

It has also secured its first complete-seat contract in India with an international automaker and announced a dedicated complete-seat assembly plant, its 10th facility in the country.

The combination of Forvia's engineering capabilities and ANAND's domestic manufacturing and supplier network could bring global seating technology closer to Indian production lines.

Greater localisation could reduce freight costs, lead times and foreign-exchange exposure, while locally adapted seat architectures could shorten development cycles.

Lightweight seating is also gaining importance with the growth of EVs, as lower vehicle weight can improve efficiency and driving range. Complete-seat sourcing can simplify supplier coordination while adding another competitor on cost, technology, safety and delivery.

OPERATING FOOTHOLD

Faurecia Anand Seating India Pvt Ltd will acquire the existing Indian seat-frame business of Faurecia Automotive Seating India, giving the joint venture an operating base as it expands into complete seats.

Forvia will own 50 per cent plus one share and Gabriel 50 per cent minus one share.

The planned ₹100-crore equity capital will be funded in two stages — ₹20 crore at incorporation and ₹80 crore at closing — with Gabriel contributing about ₹50 crore.

UP THE VALUE CHAIN

For Gabriel, seating expands the potential content it can supply per vehicle across petrol, diesel, hybrid and electric powertrains.

Forvia's global seating division generated €8.2 billion in sales in 2025 and targets €8.7-9.1 billion by 2028.

"India is a key growth driver for Forvia," Chief Executive Officer Martin Fischer said.

The JV gives Forvia a route to scale its India business while giving Gabriel access to global seating technology and higher-value programmes.

Tata Power partners with Norwegian company for membrane-based floating solar project

Ramesh M
Chennai

Tata Power has partnered with Norway-based renewable energy technology company Ocean Sun to bring its membrane-based floating solar technology to India. Unlike conventional systems that use floats, the technology mounts solar modules on a membrane that floats directly on the water, potentially reducing costs.

The collaboration agreement was signed on the sidelines of the 2nd India–EFTA Prosperity Summit, reinforcing the growing India–Norway and India–EFTA partnership in technology, innovation and clean energy.

PILOT AT MULSHI

Tata Power and Ocean Sun will undertake a ~300-kWp floating solar pilot at Tata Power's Mulshi reservoir in Maharashtra. The pilot will evaluate Ocean Sun's proprietary membrane-based technology for performance, reliability, cost competitiveness and scalability under Indian conditions, while generating operational insights for potential wider deployment, according to a press release from Tata Power.

CENTRE'S SOPS

The Centre recently announced incentives of up to ₹1 crore per MW for floating solar plants to help realise India's estimated 102-GW potential. Unlike conventional floating solar systems that typically use interconnected pontoon structures, Ocean Sun's technology deploys solar PV modules on a thin, hydro-elastic membrane that floats directly on the water surface. The lightweight design could simplify transportation and installation while reducing structural requirements.

The close proximity of the PV modules to the water surface may also provide a cooling effect, potentially improving generation performance.

Asked if the two partners would jointly own floating solar assets, a Tata Power spokesperson told *businessline* that Ocean Sun is primarily a technology partner, providing its proprietary membrane technology.

"The modules and project assets will be owned by Tata Power; this is not a joint asset-ownership arrangement," he said.

BPL Medical bets on critical care, imaging to quadruple revenue to ₹2,000 cr by 2032

Aishwarya Kumar
Venkatesha Babu
Bengaluru

BPL Medical Technologies is aiming to quadruple its revenue to around ₹2,000 crore by 2032, with critical care and imaging expected to drive the next phase of growth as the medical-device maker broadens its focus beyond its traditional cardiology business.

Speaking to *businessline*, Guruswamy Krishnamoorthy, CEO of BPL Medical Technologies Pvt Ltd, said more than 50 per cent of the company's revenue currently comes from the critical-care segment, which has emerged as a core business over the past decade following its expansion into anaesthesia, patient monitoring, ventilators and infusion pumps.


Guruswamy Krishnamoorthy, CEO, BPL Medical Tech

Imaging, meanwhile, remains a relatively young business for BPL but is expected to play a much larger role in the company's future growth strategy.

ACQUISITION-LED EXPANSION

BPL is also leveraging acquisitions to strengthen its technology capabilities and build an export platform.

The company recently acquired 100 per cent of South Korea-based BM Tech, a manufacturer of bone densitometers, and a controlling stake in Belgium-based Medec, which develops high-end anaesthesia and ventilation products.

While the BM Tech acquisition provides BPL with access to a new product category and a broader footprint in South-East Asia, Medec is expected to serve as both a technology centre and a gateway to global markets.

BPL plans to introduce some of Medec's products in India and localise their manufacturing, while using the Belgian company to expand its presence in West Asia, Africa and Latin America.

The company's international expansion strategy is centred on markets that share characteristics with India, including Thailand, Vietnam, the Philippines and Indonesia.

MANUFACTURING BASE

BPL also intends to capitalise on its manufacturing capabilities in India to support its expanding portfolio.

Its Bengaluru facility, spread across nearly 90,000 sq ft and backed by advanced machining and fabrication capabilities, is expected to manufacture mechanical components for products such as anaesthesia machines. The company also sees India taking on a larger role in software development, including embedded and application software, for its global operations.

Brookfield buys eight Grade A parks from ESR, bets ₹4,300 crore on logistics real estate

Our Bureau
Chennai

Global investment firm Brookfield on Wednesday announced the acquisition of a 100 per cent interest in a 10.5 million sq ft industrial and logistics portfolio from ESR India, marking its entry into India's industrial and logistics real estate segment.

Brookfield has committed ₹4,300 crore ($450 million) towards the acquisition and future development of the portfolio. ESR will continue to manage the properties in the near term, according to a statement from Brookfield.

KEY CORRIDORS

Spread across about 400 acres in six metro clusters, the portfolio comprises eight Grade A parks across major gateway cities, including Mumbai, Pune, Delhi-NCR, Chennai and Kolkata.



Developed and managed by ESR, the assets are located along industrial and freight corridors close to key manufacturing and warehousing hubs, providing access to established consumption centres and logistics catchments.

The acquisition builds on the relationship between Brookfield and ESR in Asia-Pacific and underscores ESR's integrated development and fund management platform and its ability to develop and manage institutional-quality logistics infrastructure at scale.

BROOKFIELD'S PORTFOLIO

Brookfield is a major owner and operator of real estate assets in India, with a portfolio of more than $13 billion across office and hospitality. Its holdings include Brookfield India Real Estate Trust, India's only institutionally managed REIT, and The Leela Palaces Hotels and Resorts Ltd.

Brookfield is also one of the largest foreign investors in India, with about $33 billion of assets under management across infrastructure, energy, private equity, real estate and credit.

Ankur Gupta, Deputy Chief Investment Officer and Head of Asia-Pacific and Middle East, Real Estate, Brookfield, said India's growing integration with global supply chains would increase the importance of high-quality logistics infrastructure in improving the country's logistics capabilities and cost competitiveness.

Abhijit Malkani, CEO, India, ESR, said: "Brookfield's acquisition of the portfolio underscores the value created through ESR's integrated platform and the strength of our logistics business in India. ESR will continue to manage the portfolio, providing continuity for customers while supporting its next phase of growth."

Amazon, Flipkart and Myntra take q-comm beyond grocery

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

A month before Deepavali, India's biggest e-commerce platforms are opening their festival shopping battle, seeking to capture consumer spending well ahead of the festival as rapid delivery spreads beyond groceries into home, electronics and fashion.

Amazon's Great Indian Festival and Myntra's Big Fashion Festival begin on October 8, followed by Flipkart's Big Billion Days on October 9.

The scale is expanding at the same speed. Flipkart Minutes will offer 77,000-plus products across 1,400-plus categories; Amazon is integrating Amazon Now into its Great Indian Festival for the first time, while Myntra's M-Now will put 1.5 lakh styles from 1,500 brands on rapid delivery. The moves increasingly blur the distinction between conventional e-commerce, built around vast selection, and quick commerce, built around immediacy.

AMAZON NOW

Amazon Now, which started predominantly with grocery, has been adding home, kitchen, and electronics over the past three to four months.

"We have added lots of, for example, kitchen and dining products, mixer grinders, air fryers, some fans, and small-size furniture," Aman Deep Lohan, Director, Home, Kitchen and Outdoors at Amazon India, told *businessline*. Products from his categories on Amazon Now are growing three-to-five-fold.

Amazon Now operates in about 120 cities through more than 800 micro-fulfilment centres, offering 10–15-minute delivery. Across Amazon's wider network, more than one million products are available for same-day delivery and four million for next-day delivery.



SPREADING WINGS. E-commerce platforms are seeking to capture consumer spending ahead of the festival as rapid delivery goes beyond groceries to home, electronics and fashion

Flipkart Minutes has grown four-fold year-on-year and now reaches more than 150 cities and 9,000 PIN codes through nearly 1,200 micro-fulfilment centres. Its festive assortment stretches from groceries to premium electronics, fashion and gifting. "Thirteen years ago, digital commerce in India was a novelty. Today, it is infrastructure," Flipkart Group CEO Kalyan Krishnamurthy said, pointing to the platform's 500 million registered customers, 1.4 million sellers and expanding reach into smaller markets.

That infrastructure is getting bigger. Flipkart has added 14 million cubic feet of warehousing, increasing storage capacity by 50 per cent, and more than 900 delivery hubs. Its overall Big Billion Days assortment runs to 150 million products.

Myntra is testing whether the same expectation of immediacy can extend to a discovery-led category such as fashion. M-Now will offer 1.5 lakh styles across 12 cities, with delivery starting in 30 minutes.

At the same time, its Big Fashion Festival assortment has doubled to more than eight million styles, with 21,000 emerging brands and labels participating.

"We are combining that festive spirit with cutting-edge technology, leveraging our AI tools and expanded delivery network to make fashion accessible, personalised, and seamless for over 80 million shoppers," Myntra Head Sharon Pais said.

THE FESTIVE WALLET

The October push is consequently becoming as much a logistics contest as a discount war. Amazon has added 20 fulfilment centres and 150 last-mile delivery centres, while Flipkart's network now spans more than 8,200 fulfilment and delivery facilities. Myntra says faster deliveries cover 98 per cent of its serviceable PIN codes.

UNDP, Generali Central launch challenge to bridge MSME insurance gap

Our Bureau
Kolkata

The United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) and Generali Central, representing the Generali Group's general and life insurance businesses in India, on Wednesday launched an insurance innovation challenge to identify and scale solutions that strengthen the resilience of India's micro, small and medium-sized enterprises (MSMEs).

India has more than 73 million MSMEs, which contribute about 30 per cent of the country's GDP and 44 per cent of its exports, while employing 60 per cent of its workforce.

However, climate shocks, supply-chain disruptions, workplace risks and unexpected personal shocks affecting owners and workers are placing these businesses under growing strain.

ADDRESSING RISKS

Insurance can help MSMEs absorb shocks, keep operating and recover faster. However, coverage remains limited due to low awareness, perceived costs and products that do not always reflect their needs.

The UNDP–Generali Insurance Innovation Challenge aims to close this protection gap by identifying and scaling accessible and relevant solutions.

It is seeking proven insurance products and distribution models that address key risks facing MSMEs, including health-related events, business interruption and asset loss.

Angela Lusigi, Resident Representative, UNDP India, said, "This challenge will help identify insurance solutions that respond to these real risks and can reach more MSMEs. Stronger MSMEs mean more secure livelihoods, more resilient communities and an economy better prepared for future shocks."

KG Krishnamoorthy Rao, MD and CEO, Generali Central Insurance, said, "Strengthening MSMEs' ability to withstand disruption is critical to India's sustainable economic growth. Insurance has an important role to play, but solutions must be relevant and accessible to the businesses they aim to protect."

GRANTS FOR WINNERS

Up to three winning solutions will each receive grants of up to $40,000 to support development or scaling.

Applications close on November 20, 2026, with the winners expected to be announced in February 2027.

CHENNAI
businessline.
THURSDAY - OCTOBER 8 - 2026

QUICKLY.

Robust $, Treasury yields take sheen off gold



Gold declined to a two-month low on Wednesday, pressured by a strong US dollar and Treasury yields, while investors awaited the minutes of the Fed's September meeting. Spot gold fell 1.6 per cent to $4,096.13 per ounce by 1320 GMT. Silver eased 2.9 per cent to $59.89, and platinum fell 4.8 per cent to $1,620.38. REUTERS

Crude oil up as investors weigh supply threats

Crude oil prices rose with Brent futures holding above $100 a barrel, on continued West Asian supply risks and a storm heading for oil-producing regions in the US. Brent crude futures were up 75 cents to $101.33 a barrel at 1200 GMT. US WTI crude was up 39 cents to $89.83. The International Energy Agency held an informal meeting at 1100 GMT to discuss a proposed release of oil and diesel stocks. REUTERS

Mine strike supports copper, offsets $ pressure



London: Copper prices recovered as supply worries, driven by a possible walk-out by Chile mine workers, offset pressure from a stronger dollar. Benchmark three-month copper on the LME was little changed at $14,420 a tonne. Aluminium lost 0.7 per cent to $3,112. REUTERS

El Nino effect: Tomato prices more than double in a month

WEATHER DRAG. Warmer Sept, deficit rain & below-normal night temperature hit fruit-setting and increased leaf curl virus incidence, leading to lower arrivals

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Tomato prices have more than doubled at agri market terminals over the past month, with the crop facing an unusual rise in September temperatures due to the El Nino weather, lack of water availability and below-normal night temperatures, stakeholders said.

This is particularly true in the main tomato-growing regions in Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh. This has resulted in Maharashtra tomato growers in the Nashik region sending their produce to Kolar to get better returns. This has had some sobering impact on the surging rates, they said.

According to the Agmarknet portal, a unit of the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare, the modal price (the rates at which most trades take place) had more than doubled to ₹1,500 a quintal currently from the ₹800 on September 10 at the Kolar Agricultural Produce Marketing Committee (APMC) yard. Quality tomatoes, however, cost upwards of ₹3,000.

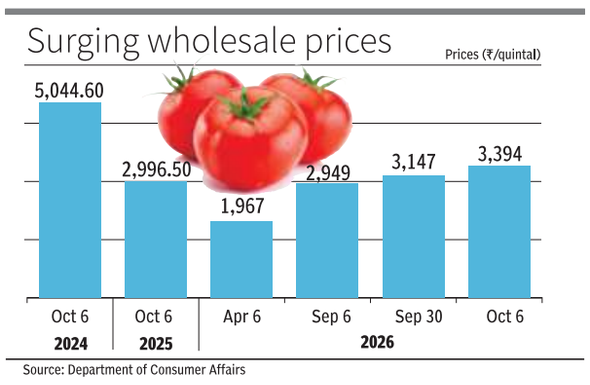
DROP IN ARRIVALS

At Andhra Pradesh's Palamaner APMC in Chittor district, prices have increased to ₹3,300 a quintal from ₹1,500 a month ago.

However, at the Nashik APMC, the vegetable's prices have dropped to ₹1,250 from ₹2,100 a month ago.

Agmarket data show that tomato arrivals have dropped to below 1,200 tonnes over the past week from 1,700 tonnes a month ago. At the start of this month, arrivals dropped to below 950 tonnes before rising on additional inflows from Nashik.

In Palamner, less than 10 tonnes of tomatoes are arriving against 60 tonnes a month ago. In Nashik, the arrivals have dropped to 1,250 tonnes from 2,100 tonnes.



Source: Department of Consumer Affairs

COOLING EFFECT

The retail prices, which were ₹20-25 a kg a fortnight ago, are now ruling around ₹50 a kg in major cities such as Mumbai, Chennai, Kolkata, Bengaluru and Hyderabad. Delhi is the sole exception, with prices ruling at ₹34.

"Tomato prices jumped over ₹1,600 earlier this month. But arrivals from Nashik have had some cooling effect," said a trader at the Kolar APMC.

"The tomato crop in the Kolar region has been affected by higher temperatures of 38 degrees Celsius against the normal 30 degrees in September. Farmers are also facing non-availability of water. In addition, tomato leaf curl virus has affected the crop," said Anurag Bajpai, Business Head, Vegetable and Flower Seeds at Crystal Crop Protection Ltd in Bengaluru.

"There is no Kolar crop now, leading to a surge in prices, particularly in the past fortnight. The farmers here have not taken proper care as the prices were lower a few months ago," said H Uday Kumar of CMR Tomato Mundy in Kolar.

LOW PRICES

KN Chandrasekar, a farmer at Kajikalhalli near Kolar in Karnataka, said a few months ago, growers hardly got ₹3 a kg for tomato, but it had increased to over ₹50 now.

"Usually, farmers spray crop protection materials on alternate days. But since the prices were lower, they cut the spraying to once in 5 days or a week," said a trader.

Chandrasekar said the fruit setting had been affected due to this and it had also led to leaf curl virus incidents. "Some of the fruits are smaller in size as a result, fetching lower prices," he said.

Kumar said good quality tomatoes command over ₹40 a kg at the APMC market.

MAY SURGE FURTHER

Traders said prices could surge to the levels seen two years ago, when they topped ₹100 a kg in retail outlets.

"It is likely to happen, given the lack of rainfall and fall in production," said a trader, who did not wish to be identified.

This year, the South-West monsoon is 13 per cent deficit, with States such as Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh and Telangana being particularly affected. Andhra Pradesh has declared 18 districts as drought-hit, while Telangana's 21 districts have received deficient precipitation.

Karnataka has declared that 217 taluks were affected by drought, and over 10 districts in Tamil Nadu have been hit.

Central banks' gold purchases net positive in August as China leads the way

Our Bureau
Chennai

Central banks across the world continued purchasing gold in August, with China continuing to lead the pack by accumulating 20 tonnes, data from the World Gold Council (WGC) showed.

"Global central banks remain on pace with gold accumulation this August, with reported net buying totalling 39 tonnes. Large, consistent buyers of gold in 2026 showed continued activity in the month, with China taking the lead, followed by Uzbekistan and Poland," said Marissa Salim, Senior Research Lead, APAC, WGC.

On a year-to-date basis, central banks have reported total purchases of 170 tonnes. She said putting August's purchase of the yellow metal in broader context, analysis of reported central bank gold purchases between 2016 and 2025 suggested modest seasonal variation, although differences across years remain substantial.

LONG-TERM OBJECTIVES

"Heightened economic or geopolitical uncertainty may play a role, but further analysis is needed to identify any strong and persistent underlying drivers. The composition of August's buying is as notable as the headline total: Demand was again led by familiar participants pursuing multi-year accumulation programmes," said Salim.

Central banks' gold accumulation

	(in tonnes)
August gross purchase	48.00
August gross sales	9.00
Net buying Jan-August	170.00
Monthly average buying	21.25

Source: World Gold Council

Central banks' purchases reflected long-term reserve objectives.

The monthly fluctuations capture differences in market conditions and country-specific liquidity needs.

China's gold buying continued for the 22nd consecutive month with the 20 tonnes. Beijing has added a total of 80 tonnes this year to its gold reserves, with its reserves making up nine per cent of the total reserves at 2,387 tonnes.

POLAND AHEAD

The National Bank of Poland continued the precious metal's accumulation, buying 8 tonnes in August.

Poland tops in year-to-date gold purchases, buying 98 tonnes.

It has accumulated 648 tonnes of gold, with its target of 700 tonnes of reserves getting closer in sight.

Salim said China could catch up with Poland in gold buying this year.

On the other hand, the Central Bank of Russia continued to offload gold in August, selling another six tonnes.

Its total sales this year have reached 56 tonnes, taking Moscow's gold holdings down to 2,271 tonnes.

Stakeholders launch regen mustard farming initiative in Rajasthan

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

The Solvent Extractors' Association of India (SEA), AWL Agri Business Ltd, Solidaridad Network Asia Ltd and Bharatkhand Foundation have joined hands to launch 'Sarson Sankalp'.

It is a five-year farmer-focused programme to promote regenerative mustard farming in Rajasthan's Bundi, Tonk and Jhalawar districts.

The programme will target 15,000 active farmers in 2026-27 and gradually expand its outreach to 40,000 by 2030-31, with a total budget of ₹16 crore.

'Sarson Sankalp' will combine farmer training, demonstrations, model farms, soil and crop advisory, field-level extension, farmer records, and monitoring and measurement of performance indicators.

Model and demonstration farms will serve as local learning hubs, allowing farmers to see regenerative practices in action, compare results and learn from field-based evidence.

CSR PROJECT

Key interventions will include improving soil health and crop nutrition, promoting efficient use of water and agricultural inputs, strengthening climate resilience of mustard-based farming systems, supporting biodiversity and sustainable agriculture, providing locally relevant soil and crop advisory, strengthening farmer knowledge and field-level extension, and measuring farm-level outcomes to support evidence-based scaling.

Under the partnership, AWL Agri Business will provide CSR support, while SEA will coordinate the programme and undertake qualitative monitoring.

Solidaridad will provide expertise in regenerative agriculture, programme guidance, quality assurance, and knowledge and learning support.

Bharatkhand Foundation will be the principal field implementation partner.

Sanjeev Asthana, former President of SEA, said 'Sarson Sankalp' demonstrated how the edible oil industry could support farming communities through a structured CSR programme with scale, accountability and measurable field outcomes.

Thunderstorms to strike TN, Puducherry, Karaikal for the next six days, says IMD

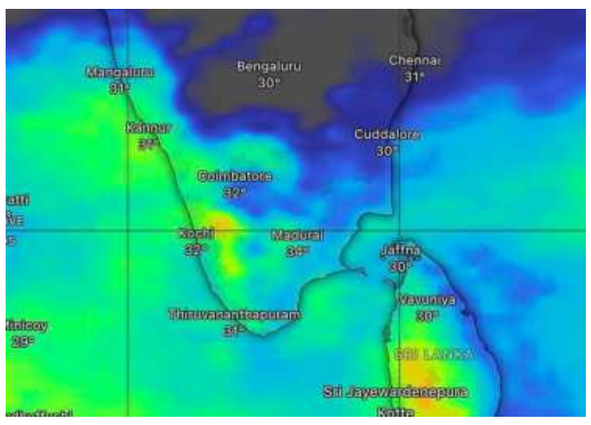
Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) said the conditions may become favourable for the further withdrawal of the South-West monsoon from some more parts of Maharashtra and Chhattisgarh, where it is currently stalled, as well as parts of Telangana and north interior Karnataka over the next 2-3 days.

This came a day after Myanmar, India's north-eastern neighbour and a Bay of Bengal littoral country, declared the 2026 monsoon season over.

The move could signal the beginning of a regional shift towards the North-East monsoon.

In India, the IMD said thunderstorms and lightning — characteristic features of the transition — are likely over Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal during the next six days.



RAIN ALERT. Widespread thunderstorms and rain are forecast for Kerala, coastal Karnataka and south and west Tamil Nadu until Saturday

UNSETTLED WEATHER

The transition is likely to keep parts of the South Peninsula unsettled. Strong surface winds are expected over coastal Andhra Pradesh, Yanam and Rayalaseema on Thursday and Friday.

Kerala, Mahe and Lakshadweep could see thunderstorms and lightning on Friday and Saturday, with gusty winds likely over Kerala and Mahe on Thursday and Sunday, and over coastal Andhra Pradesh, Yanam and Rayalaseema on Thursday and Friday.

WIDER SPREAD OF RAIN

The rainfall pattern is expected to persist, although its intensity and coverage will vary. Isolated to scattered rain is likely over Lakshadweep and Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal on Thursday and again for three days from Saturday.

Kerala and Mahe could receive isolated to scattered rain on Monday and Tuesday, while coastal Andhra Pradesh, Yanam, coastal Karnataka, Rayalaseema and south interior Karnataka are likely to see such rain during the next six days.

North interior Karnataka may also receive rain on Friday and Saturday.

The broader rain belt is expected to become more pronounced towards the end of the week.

Rainfall is likely to be fairly widespread to widespread over Lakshadweep, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal on Friday, and over Kerala and Mahe for three days from Thursday.

The IMD has also forecast isolated heavy rain over Kerala, Mahe, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal for three days from Thursday.

FIELD PREP


BETTER FARM PRACTICES. A farmer leads a pair of bullocks through a turmeric field in Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh. Traditional bullock-drawn ploughing helps smallholders control weeds, loosen the soil and improve water infiltration and nutrient absorption, supporting healthy crop growth KVS GIRI

Psyllium husk finds its way into food and health products

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Until a few years ago, psyllium (isabgol) was consumed for constipation and gut issues. But now, it is finding its uses in food, including for pets, health and wellness, says Niraj Wadhwa, Managing Director of Gujarat-based Sidhpur Sat-Isabgol Factory Pvt Ltd.

"Over the years, studies have been done on isabgol, and it is reported to help reduce cholesterol levels. Your blood sugar level can also be controlled. So the usage is now wide, basically since it is a dietary fibre," he told *businessline* in an online interaction.

Stating that the market had evolved in terms of usage of psyllium, he said people were now consuming it for weight loss. Psyllium, which is grown mainly in Rajasthan, has seen its use rising in the past decade, extending to the bakery industry and pet food industry, besides health and wellness.

DIETARY SUPPLEMENT

"There has been a big surge in bakery usage in the past 10 years. Its use in pet food is growing. Psyllium is used as a dietary supplement or dietary fibre because it has the highest soluble fibre. It is supposed to be the best fibre for gut health. Overall, there has been good growth in export and Indian markets," he said.

Psyllium is a crop which is grown commercially only in India, nowhere else. It all started in Gujarat, but now 80-85 per cent of the crop is cultivated in Rajasthan. Madhya Pradesh, too, grows the crop, said Wadhwa.

> Studies have been done on isabgol, and it is reported to help reduce cholesterol and blood sugar levels
>
> **NIRAJ WADHWA**
> MD, Sidhpur Sat-Isabgol Factory



Currently, psyllium annual production is 2.62 lakh tonnes. It is the raw material for psyllium husk. Sidpur Sat-Isabgol buys seeds from various agricultural produce market committee (APMC) yards. In some cases, the seeds are bought directly from farmers with whom the company has contracts, he said. After buying the seeds, the firm processes them into husk through a simple milling process, removing the husk. It is then packed and marketed in retail outlets.

"There is a huge demand for the husk in bulk. Some 90-95 per cent of our production is exported in bulk to the US, Europe and South-East Asia. The US and Europe are our biggest markets," said the company's Managing Director.

The seeds that remain after the husk are removed and used as cattle feed as they have protein content. They are particularly handy for the dairy units which are thriving here.

RETURNS FOR FARMERS

On returns for farmers over the past decade, Wadhwa said it had increased from ₹75-80 a kg to ₹130-140 now. "This is why farmers are growing more. If prices drop below ₹120, farmers may switch to some other crop," said Wadhwa.

Dhanuka Agritech launches fungicide for rice blast disease in paddy

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

Dhanuka Agritech Ltd, an agri input company, has launched Fujita, a systemic fungicide for the control of rice blast (*Pyricularia oryzae*), one of the major fungal diseases affecting paddy cultivation.

Fujita is designed to provide systemic protection against rice blast and support effective disease management. Through products such as Fujita, the company continues to expand its crop protection portfolio to address key crop health challenges in Indian agriculture, it said in a statement.

Buy copper futures if the price breaks out of ₹1,432

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Copper futures have been in a sideways trend recently. While the broader trend is bullish, the price action shows a loss of momentum.

COMMODITY CALL.

The October contract has been oscillating between ₹1,395 and ₹1,425 for about two weeks. Also, there is a broader range at play between ₹1,360 and ₹1,432. So, for the futures to establish a fresh leg of trend, they have to breach either ₹1,360 or ₹1,432. If it crosses ₹1,432, it could extend the rise to ₹1,480, a resistance. The subsequent barrier is at ₹1,500. On the other hand, if it breaches the support at ₹1,360, it could slip to ₹1,300. Although there is a minor support at ₹1,340, it is unlikely to arrest the fall.

The chart shows the futures continue to form high bases; the price is above both 21- and 50-day moving averages. So, the probability of a breakout of ₹1,432 is comparatively higher.

TRADE STRATEGY

Buy copper if it decisively breaks out of ₹1,432. Place the initial stop-loss at ₹1,400. When the contract rises to ₹1,460, tighten the stop-loss to ₹1,440. Book profits at ₹1,480.

QUICKLY.

Veegaland Developers posts 79% rise in revenue

Kochi: Veegaland Developers Ltd has registered 79 per cent increase in revenue from operations in Q1 of FY27, supported by strong sales growth and robust project progress. The company said that all ongoing projects progressed as per schedule. During the quarter, it launched one new project in Kochi, Veegaland Amora, adding 1.59 lakh sq ft to its portfolio of ongoing projects. OUR BUREAU

DP World expands warehousing capacity



Mumbai: DP World has inaugurated the second phase of Nhava Sheva business park near Mumbai adding one million square feet of warehouse capacity. The facility developed with an investment of ₹500 crore was unveiled by company's Executive Chairman Essa Kazim during his first visit to India on Wednesday. The first phase spans 44 acres and provides one million sq ft of warehousing space. OUR BUREAU

CU Denver to set up campus in Hyderabad

Hyderabad: The University of Colorado Denver (CU Denver) has received the letter of intent from India's University Grants Commission to establish a campus in Hyderabad. The Hyderabad location will offer pathways in fields including business, computing, engineering, and analytics, while encouraging interdisciplinary thinking and problem-solving. OUR BUREAU

Govt frames pricing norms for land acquired to lay transmission lines

RIGHT OF WAY. Guidelines will apply to ISTS lines in cases where landowners object to the compensation

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The Power Ministry has issued price guidelines for land acquired to lay inter state transmission system (ISTS) lines.

These guidelines for determining compensation for laying of ISTS lines are to address the Right of Way (RoW) issues in a bid to expedite the laying for power evacuation infrastructure. RoW is among the main reasons for the delay in laying transmission lines, particularly for evacuating renewable energy, from key producing States such as Gujarat and Rajasthan.

The Centre has proposed that the compensation in normal cases will be based on the circle rate or guideline value or the Stamp Act rates of the land. However, in cases where the market rate exceeds the circle rate, the land value will be determined based on the prevailing market rate as ascertained by the Market Rate Committee (MRC) and in the manner as specified by the State government.

The determined land value will serve as the basis for compensation and will be communicated by the respective District Magistrate or District Collector or Deputy Commissioner to the Transmission Service Provider .

The MRC will include the District Magistrate as the chairperson and the District level officer of Registration Department, SDM of the concerned Sub Division and administrative representative of the civic body in the area. The chairperson can also co-opt up to two additional members as may be required.



PEGGING THE VALUE. When the market rate exceeds the circle rate, the land value will be based on the prevailing market rate as ascertained by a panel led by the District Magistrate REUTERS

MINIMUM CAPACITY

However, the compensation will be paid only for transmission lines supported by a tower base of 66 kV voltage level and above, and not for sub-transmission and distribution lines below 66 kV. "These guidelines shall apply to ISTS lines only in cases where landowners have objected to the compensation because the Circle Rates are below the market rates. State governments may adopt these guidelines in their entirety or issue their own modified policy," the Power Ministry said.

Besides, the guidelines will apply in cases where State governments are yet to specify the manner of determination of value of land. In the absence of State policy, these guidelines issued by the Centre shall apply for determining compensation, it added.

For evaluating the market rate of the land holding, the district administration will select three valuers from the list of land valuers empanelled by the Insolvency & Bankruptcy Board of India . They should preferably be from the same State. In case there is no adequate pool of valuers in the concerned state, then they may approach adjoining States.

According to a June 2026 report by Axis Securities, India added 12,139 circuit km (ckm) against a target of 15,382 ckm in FY26. The official target for transmission line was revised downwards to 15,382 ckm from 24,400 ckm in August 2025, citing RoW challenges.

Flexi-staffing market recovers in Q1, led by manufacturing, tech

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The flexi-staffing sector demonstrated a steady recovery in the first quarter of 2026–27, with net employment rising 2.6 per cent quarter-on-quarter and 7.5 per cent year-on-year, even as the broader formal employment market showed signs of a gradual slowdown.



Capital investment, infrastructure ramp-ups,and plant commissioning generated immediate demand for project-based flexible manpower

MACRO PUSH

According to the latest Flexi Staffing Employment Trends Report for Q1 2026–27 by the Indian Staffing Federation (ISF), the demand was led by the manufacturing, technology and consumer-facing sectors, supported by strong economic activity and increased investment in infrastructure and capacity expansion.

Data from the report suggests that macroeconomic expansion provided a strong demand floor for flexi-staffing, which represent temporary, contract or gig workers, in Q1, with Real GDP growing at 7.8 per cent despite geopolitical tension in West Asia and rising crude oil prices. Capital investment, infrastructure ramp-ups, and plant commissioning generated immediate demand for project-based flexible manpower.

General staffing growth this quarter came mainly from manufacturing and the consumer, retail and telecom verticals while banking, financial services and insurance sector (BFSI) faced regulatory headwinds on what can be outsourced, though NBFCs and fintech still offer openings. Manufacturing sector was the largest volume driver as it grew 7.8 per cent in June, and 19 of the 23 industry groups grew year-on-year. Electrical equipment rose 34 per cent, motor vehicles 17.5 per cent and food products 10.8 per cent. MCG hiring rose 7 per cent, telecom 6 per cent, retail and hospitality each expanded fresher hiring by 30 per cent in May, it said. Retail sales was among the fastest-growing fresher roles at +50 per cent. Suchita Dutta, Executive Director of Federation, stated, "Demonstrating remarkable structural resilience, ISF members expanded the formal contract workforce to 1.95 million this quarter and added 0.11 million new formal flexi jobs over the last 12 months. By bridging India's informal-to-formal employment gap, organised staffing continues to build a transparent, compliant, and dignified labour ecosystem."

Also, Global Capability Centres (GCCs), which now account for 45–67 per cent of its specialised staffing associates and revenue, is now held up for several consecutive quarters, so it is a structural issue rather than a cyclical one.

Day 2 of protest: Rahul, Priyanka detained again



DIGGING IN. Police try to evict Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and others, including Rahul Gandhi and Deepender Singh Hooda, from the protest site ANI

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Escalating their protest, INDIA bloc MPs attempted to march to Jantar Mantar on Wednesday to launch a sit-in dharna, renewing demands for Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation over the alleged 'vote chori'.

Top leaders such as Congress' Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi were detained after women MPs lay down on the street to avoid being evicted from the site. The Delhi Police were trying to prevent them from staging the protest at Jantar Mantar. According to the police, at least 10 days advance permission is needed for holding any dharna.

Defying authorities, the protestors punctured the bus which was carrying the Gandhis and other MPs.

"This is how they treat MPs? This is unprecedented. We will not move from here," Priyanka Gandhi, who was lying on the street holding a copy of the Constitution said, surrounded by women cops. Rahul standing next to her was anxiously watching the incident.

The surprise dharna at Jantar Mantar adds to the previous day's eight-hour long protest march from parliament which was meant to end at Nirvachan Sadan, the headquarters of the Election Commission, but was stopped by the police midway.

SUDDEN MOVE

After having lunch at a restaurant in Rajiv Chowk, hosted by Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge to chalk out future strategy to sustain the oust Gyanesh Kumar campaign, the MPs boarded buses, with some of them — such as Congress' Amarinder Singh Raja Warring, Deepender Singh Hooda, Imran Pratapgarhi and Imran Masood — climbing to the roof carrying the tricolour.

"Today, we feel that we will protest at Jantar Mantar, which is a designated protest site, and tell the country that for us Gyanesh Kumar is not a legitimate Election Commissioner," Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi told reporters.

The police stopped the buses.

Meanwhile, responding to an FIR registered for their unauthorised entry into Akashvani Bhavan, Rahul Gandhi said, "You may register as many cases as you want; we are not going to be scared."

BJP President Nitin Nabin said on X: "The leadership of Congress must clearly understand that any attempt to create an atmosphere of anarchy in Delhi through anti-social elements will never succeed."

AP clears policy to woo institutes of higher education, foreign varsities

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

The Andhra Pradesh Cabinet approved the AP Policy for Promotion of Foreign Higher Educational Institutions (FHEIs) and Private Universities, 2026, to draw international higher educational institutions to the State.

The policy seeks to create a conducive environment for foreign higher educational institutions and Indian private universities to establish campuses in Andhra Pradesh, while promoting international academic partnerships, investments and access to high-quality higher education.

It lays down eligibility criteria, incentives and the support to be extended by the State government for setting up campuses. It also allows institutions to establish campuses through academic infrastructure service providers selected by the government.

CJI to decide on hearing plea to recall split verdict in CEC selection law case

The Hindu Bureau
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Wednesday agreed to examine and take a call on hearing an application seeking a recall of the September 23 split verdict in a case challenging the Election Commissioners appointments law.

The application, orally mentioned before Chief Justice of India Surya Kant by senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan, questions why one of the judges on the apex court Bench, Justice Satish Chandra Sharma, did not reveal during multiple court proceedings that his son was a standing counsel for the Election Commission of India (ECI).

The application, filed by Naman Sherstra, was mentioned the previous week before Justice Dipankar Datta, who was the lead judge on the Bench which gave the split verdict.

Justice Datta had asked Sankaranarayanan to mention the application before the Chief Justice as the records of the case had already been returned to the CJI.

Sherstra has sought a recall of the opinion given by Justice Sharma, who was the puisne judge on the Division Bench headed by Justice Datta, on September 23 on the question of referring the challenge to the constitutional validity of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023 to a five-judge Bench.

COMMON ORDER

While Justice Datta, in his opinion, had declined the reference to a Constitution Bench, Justice Sharma was in favour of the reference. Eventually, both judges on the Bench had passed a common order for the Chief Justice of India to allocate the case to a Constitution Bench.

The application has objected to this common order, but did not challenge, specifically, the separate opinion given by Justice Datta.

Justice Datta had observed in his opinion that 2023 law was *prima facie* wrong to ignore an earlier Constitution Bench judgment in the Anoop Baranwal case, which had included the Chief Justice of India as a neutral member in the Prime Minister-led selection panel for Chief Election Commissioners (CEC) and Election Commissioners (ECs). The 2023 law had replaced the CJI with a Union Minister nominated by the Prime Minister. Justice Datta had said the replacement gave the Executive veto power over CEC/EC appointments, and reduced the presence of the Opposition Leader of the Lok Sabha an ornamental status in the panel.

Justice Datta had reminded that the appointment and functioning of Election Commissioners was integral to free and fair elections.

Subsequent to the September 23 verdict, media reports had alleged that Justice Sharma's son was a standing counsel for the ECI.

NTPC to buy 10 mt coal from private miners to tide over crunch

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

State-run NTPC will buy as much as 10 million tonnes (mt) of coal from private sector miners in H2 FY27 as it faces a supply crunch due to higher coal burn.

Sources said the country's largest power generator faces supply shortage on account of higher demand for thermal power due to a decline in hydro power generation and a rise in electricity demand, which can be blamed on the El Nino effect.

"NTPC plans to source 10-15 mt coal from commercial miners annually from next year. In the second half of FY27 year, about 10 mt may come from commercial mines. Orders have been placed and delivery will start soon," said one of the sources.

This is the second time the Maharatna company will purchase coal stocks from commercial miners. In FY25, the PSU procured 4 mt from the private sector.

Sunstream to invest ₹1,500 crore in RE projects in Chhattisgarh

M Ramesh
Chennai

Sunstream Green Energy plans to invest ₹1,500 crore in renewable energy projects in Chhattisgarh, with a focus on integrating battery energy storage systems (BESS) to provide more flexible and dispatchable renewable power.

The investment proposal was announced at the inaugural Singapore-India Network for Growth (SING) Forum 2026, organised by the Singapore Business Federation in Singapore.

The non-binding understanding was formalised in the presence of Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai and senior State officials.

The proposed investment is backed by Singapore-based Lighthouse Trust Pte Ltd, Sunstream's anchor investor and a source of institutional capital for its renewable energy platform in India.

Currently, Sunstream has 850 MW of solar projects either commissioned or under construction in various States, including 100 MW at Raighar, Chhattisgarh. The company has also been engaging with the Chhattisgarh State Electricity Board, the State distribution company and the State transmission utility on renewable energy development and grid integration.



The proposal, announced at the SING Forum, focuses on battery storage and firm renewable power

'STRONG OPPORTUNITY'

The company's Chief Operating Officer, Dilip Kumar, told *businessline* that Chhattisgarh, with its existing infrastructure and renewable energy potential, offered a "strong opportunity" to build renewable projects at scale.

"We also see an opportunity to go beyond conventional solar and work with the State on BESS and FDRE solutions," Kumar said.

The company has said that it intends to work with the State on firm and dispatchable renewable energy (FDRE) solutions, combining renewable generation with battery storage. Such projects can help address the intermittency of solar and wind generation by allowing electricity to be delivered when required rather than only when renewable resources are available.

The proposal comes as Chhattisgarh seeks to attract investments in both clean energy and energy-intensive new industries.

The State received total investment commitments of ₹43,250 crore at the SING Forum, including ₹41,750 crore proposed by Singapore-based Energy Capital Global for a 100-MW AI-ready data-centre campus.

'Tamil Nadu has to improve speed of doing biz'

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Confederation of Real Estate Developers' Associations of India (Credai) Tamil Nadu has called for faster and more transparent project approvals in Tamil Nadu.

The State needs to improve the "speed of doing business" in the real estate sector to keep pace with growing investment and development across its cities, said President WS Habib.

Speaking ahead of Credai Tamil Nadu's two-day STATECON event and the launch of FAIRBUILD 2026 in Chennai on October 11 and 12, Habib said that while the approval process had improved since the new government had taken charge, developers continued to face delays. He wanted greater automation and faster decision-making by government agencies.



WS Habib, President, CREDAI Tamil Nadu BIJOY GHOSH

Habib wanted government departments and local bodies to move towards a system where building plans could be submitted online and approvals are processed faster, with greater reliance on automation, he said.

The association also pointed to the possibility of a system in which approvals could be granted by default once an architect and other professionals submit plans that comply with prescribed norms.

Such a system, he said, would reduce delays and make the approval process more predictable for developers.

The issue of faster and transparent approvals, digitisation and sustained investment in urban infrastructure are some of the key issues to be discussed at the event, he said.

'TN HAS TO CATCH UP'

Tamil Nadu will need to continue improving its business environment as neighbouring cities, such as Hyderabad and Bengaluru, have benefited from large investments and positioned themselves as attractive destinations for businesses and workers. Faster approvals will be particularly important as real estate activity spreads to more cities and smaller urban centres in the State, he said.

Credai Tamil Nadu is expanding its presence beyond the larger markets, with the inclusion of new chapters at the Nilgiris, Kodaikanal, Vellore, Thanjavur and Karur, said Habib.

The two-day event will examine other changes affecting the sector, including the changing expectations of home buyers, real estate finance, artificial intelligence and robotics in construction, he said.

SC sends notice to govt, asks why air travel is not disabled-friendly

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Wednesday decided to ask the Union government why millions of passengers with disabilities continue to face humiliation, barriers, broken equipment and digital exclusion in one of the world's fastest growing aviation markets.

A three-judge Bench, headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, issued formal notice to the Ministry of Civil Aviation, the Directorate General of Civil Aviation, the Airports Authority of India, the Central Industrial Security Force and the Digi Yatra Foundation on a petition filed by Turab Chimthanawala, a company secretary and advocate based in Mumbai who suffers a benchmark disability called Leber's Congenital Amaurosis, a condition that causes severe vision loss from childhood.

INCREASED TRAVEL

Advocate Ashutosh Senger, for Chimthanawala, submitted that India was presently the third-largest aviation market globally, with annual passenger traffic exceeding 350 million. Yet, persons with disabilities (PwD) face denial of accessible aviation infrastructure and services, restricting their fundamental right to travel independently and with dignity.

"Domestic passenger traffic has consistently grown at approximately 10–12 per cent annually over the past decade. Even based on the conservative estimate of 2.21 per cent disability prevalence recorded in the Census of 2011, this translates to over seven million air passengers with disabilities annually... The magnitude of affected persons underscores the systemic and national scale of the accessibility failure," Senger submitted.

GAMUT OF SERVICES

The plea highlighted a systemic and nationwide failure of non-implementation of accessibility across all stages of air travel, including booking, web-check-in, airport entry and navigation, counter-check-in, security screening, Digi Yatra processing, immigration, boarding, in-flight services and arrival assistance.

The petition said silent airports fail to provide accessible alternative modes of communication.

"Accessibility is not merely a statutory entitlement but a fundamental right flowing from the guarantee of equality, dignity, and freedom of movement, and imposes a non-derogable obligation upon the State and its instrumentalities to ensure that public infrastructure and services are usable by PwDs on an equal basis with others," the petition said.

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QUICKLY.

Granules expecting first to file status on Ruxolitinib



Hyderabad: Granules India has submitted a paragraph IV certification in connection with its abbreviated new drug application (ANDA) for Ruxolitinib extended-release tablets with respect to applicable patents listed with the US Food and Drug Administration. Based on the timing and status of its ANDA and paragraph IV certification and subject to FDA review and determination, GIL said it believes that it is eligible for first-to-file status for the Ruxolitinib extended-release tablets. If confirmed by the FDA and applicable statutory and regulatory requirements are satisfied, first-to-file status may provide eligibility for 180 days of generic drug exclusivity under US law. OUR BUREAU

GCCs face pressure as some centers cut jobs or close

ESCALATING STRESS. Restructuring, global cost-cutting account for an estimated 50–60% of layoffs in India's GCCs as millions stuck in repeatable roles

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

A string of layoffs and closures at India's GCCs in recent months is highlighting a shift in the country's GCC story, with parent-company restructuring, and AI-led productivity gains putting some centres under pressure even as India continues to attract new investments.

Recent exits include Cambium Networks, which shut its Bengaluru GCC in October, affecting around 200 employees, and Hy-Vee, which closed its India engineering centre in June, impacting around 150 employees.

According to Alouk Kumar, Founder and CEO of Inductus Group, parent-company restructuring and global cost-cutting account for an estimated 50–60 per cent of layoffs in India's GCCs. AI-led productivity and workforce redesign account for another 15–20 per cent, while GCC-specific portfolio weakness contributes 10–15 per cent. Around 5–10 per cent is linked to GCC closures or parent-company exits, with the remaining cases stemming from local restructuring, performance issues, acquisitions and other factors.

Gaurav Vasu, CEO and Founder of UnearthInsight, echoed that key reasons include sector-specific challenges, as automotive, SaaS, and manufacturing face global weakness. More than 400 GCCs could remain under stress over the next few years.



CHANGED MANDATE. Yajna Prakash of Acclime India noted that over 50% of India's GCCs are estimated to be sub-scale, with easily replaceable skills and limited ownership

SHRINKING CYCLES

AI is also shrinking traditional software development cycles and reducing the need for large developer teams, particularly in SaaS and software product GCCs, while driving global restructuring. Additionally, some GCCs face operational constraints as their mandates have changed from when they were set up 10-15 years ago.

"GCCs are tenured, and some may not live up to their full potential, still running like a back-office or support operation. If the leadership doesn't view the India centre as an IP creation or innovation centre, there may be full-fledged shutdowns," he said.

Yajna Prakash, Partner & Executive Director, Acclime India noted that over 50 per cent of India's GCCs are estimated to be sub-scale, with easily replaceable skills and limited ownership across engineering, product or P&L. AI is disrupting these centres, particularly the 1.1–1.3 million employees in repeatable roles.

"80 per cent of GCCs surveyed by EY reported that less than 10 per cent of their leadership roles are based in India. Our Ecosystem Dilemma research, based on structured interviews with GCC leaders across seven industry segments, found a similar pattern. India can design at a world-class level, but decision-making authority often remains with the parent organisation," she said.

LABOUR COSTS

Moreover, Prakash said it is getting more expensive to run a GCC in India, particularly at the specialist end. GCC salaries are projected to rise 10.4 per cent in 2026, while GCC roles carry about a 20 per cent premium over equivalent non-GCC roles. AI, GenAI and ML roles command skill premiums of up to 40 per cent.

"Attrition stands at 15–20 per cent, and 60 per cent of hiring now comes from other GCCs. Smaller centres are competing for the same scarce talent as larger centres with deeper pockets. India remains highly competitive on talent depth and speed to scale. What has changed is the idea that a GCC can justify its existence on labour cost alone," she said. However, smaller GCCs are not necessarily a bad proposition. Kumar noted that the future belongs to smaller but highly specialised GCCs.

"A 75-100 headcount centre specialising in AI/ML, cybersecurity or product engineering can be more valuable than a 500-person centre doing commoditised transaction processing. The new measure is not how many people a GCC employs, but what it owns," he noted.

STRATEGIC SCALING

Prashakth Kamath, Marketing Director & Head of Global Demand Generation at Straive, said the key question is how a GCC's mandate is changing, with centres potentially shrinking in some areas while becoming more strategic in others.

"Scale provides advantages, but by itself does not guarantee relevance. A smaller GCC owning a critical product, platform, AI capability or specialised domain function can be important to the parent organisation," he said.

Experts expect India's GCC landscape to polarise between 2026 and 2030, with large, strategic multi-function centres and small, specialised, AI-native GCCs gaining ground.

Kumar noted that large GCCs may account for 40 per cent of new mandates and specialised centres for 60 per cent, while smaller centres focused on routine, replicable work face the greatest risk of restructuring, consolidation or closure.

Over the next 3–5 years, 30–40 per cent of smaller GCCs could successfully transform and remain captive, 20–30 per cent could become specialised centres, and 10–20 per cent could be acquired or transferred.

Ericsson starts 'Made in India' antenna exports to global markets

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi



Ericsson India Global CEO Andres Vicente at the India Mobile Congress in New Delhi on Wednesday AVI

Leading telecom gear maker Ericsson on Wednesday said 'Made in India' antennas are being exported to Europe and other global markets, adding that the speed of India's 5G rollout has given the country a competitive advantage in moving towards 6G.

The Swedish company also informed that it reached a new milestone in its antenna manufacturing journey in India, with more than 15,000 antennas and 25 million components since July 2025 produced through its growing local ecosystem, strengthening India's role in Ericsson's global engineering, manufacturing and supply footprint.

Speaking at the India Mobile Congress (IMC) 2026, Andres Vicente, Senior Vice-President and Head of Market Area South East Asia, Oceania, and India, Ericsson, said it is impressive that India's mid-band 5G coverage reaches 95 per cent of the population against 45 per cent globally.

"We feel very proud to say that we started our journey in India in 1903. This is 123 years ago, and then we were the first manufacturer in order to produce in India in 1994.

We set our own manufacturing capacities in India. Today, we produce all the 4G and 5G radios that are used in the country, within the country," he said.

6G EVOLUTION

The company also produces the antennas that are being used for massive MIMO (Multiple-Input Multiple-Output) and artificial intelligence (AI) introduction in India. And, not only it produces for India, but also export from India, he said.

According to Vicente, India's transition to 5G standalone has been completed. As a result, its networks are cloud-driven and programmable and can offer differentiated connectivity, which he described as the ingredients needed to evolve to 6G.

"We have 22,000 employees in India and 10 per cent of them – 2,200 are there only to focus for R&D. The focus for R&D will be crucial for a long future. They are focussed on 6G evolution, AI, and they are also focussed on design for own chips and our capabilities. By doing this, Ericsson is already working with chipsets which are 3 nanometres. ," he noted.

AI RESHAPING

Citing 5G adoption figures, Vicente said India has 430 million 5G mobile subscriptions, which make up 35 per cent of the country's total subscriptions. He said 43 per cent of mobile data traffic is carried on 5G.

AI will reshape the telecom industry in two ways, he said, AI for networks and networks for AI. To prepare networks for AI, compute power will have to be introduced at many levels so that networks become more efficient, intelligent, intent-driven, and autonomous.

Air India and Singapore Airlines expand flights ops

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Air India and Singapore Airlines on Wednesday announced the expansion of their commercial cooperation to provide more flight options for travelling on the India-Singapore route.

The expansion is part of the initiatives under the Commercial Cooperation Framework Agreement inked in January this year. From October 15, both airlines will offer travellers bookings to eligible flights between India and Singapore operated by either airline on a standalone basis.

BOOKING FLEXIBILITY

"This covers 126 weekly flights between Singapore and eight Indian cities: Ahmedabad, Bengaluru, Chennai, Delhi, Hyderabad, Kochi, Kolkata, and Mumbai," Air India said in a release on Wednesday.

At present, an eligible Air India-operated codeshare flight booked through Singapore Airlines must include an SIA-operated flight and vice versa. This requirement will be removed from October 15.

WHO advises against drugs, surgery for children under 10

Our Bureau
New Delhi



The World Health Organization (WHO) has advised against the use of weight-loss medicines, bariatric surgery and weight-loss devices in children below 10 years, as part of its first guidelines on the treatment and management of obesity among children and adolescents issued on Wednesday.

The guidelines said that for adolescents aged 10–19 years, approved medicines may be considered only when a supervised, comprehensive lifestyle programme has failed to achieve the desired results. Bariatric surgery may be considered for adolescents with severe obesity under strict conditions.

WHO strongly recommended structured interventions combining dietary changes, physical activity and behavioural support as the primary approach to managing obesity in children and adolescents. Digital health interventions may also be used, subject to supervision by parents or caregivers.

SHARP RISE

The guidelines come amid a sharp rise in childhood obesity globally. An estimated 170 million children and adolescents aged 5–19 years were living with obesity in 2024, including 70 million children aged 5-9 years and 100 million adolescents aged 10-19 years. The prevalence of obesity in this age group has quadrupled since 1990, increasing from 2 per cent to 8 per cent.

"The foundation of obesity care for children and adolescents is not medicine or surgery, but access to comprehensive support that enables healthy eating, physical activity and sustainable behaviour change," said Luz María De Regil, Director of WHO's Department of Nutrition and Food Safety.

"Our priority must be to ensure that every child and adolescent can access quality care and supportive environments from an early age, helping them achieve and maintain a healthy weight and laying the foundation for lifelong health and well-being," she said.

Airtel hikes postpaid tariff, adds free global roaming

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Bharti Airtel has raised its postpaid tariffs by ₹50 with a revamped set of plans that bundle one free international roaming trip, every year, effective Thursday.

Sources in the company also said that existing postpaid subscribers will be moved to the nearest higher plan within a month, with the free international roaming offer worth ₹2,000.

"The complimentary international roaming pack offers 5 GB of data, 60 minutes of calls, 25 outgoing SMS and free incoming SMS, all valid for five days. Customers have complete flexibility to activate the five-day pack at the exact time of their choice, making it easier to stay connected while travelling abroad," the company said. For customers on Airtel Postpaid family plans, the free international roaming option is available for all members of the plan, it said.

FRESH ADDITION

The rental plan ranges between individual postpaid plan of ₹499 and ₹1,799 for a family of five.

In effect, the revamped plans mean a ₹50 hike over current tariffs for the postpaid customers.

Free international roaming is the latest addition to Airtel postpaid plans, which come with superior experience through fast lane technology, unlimited data, network-level protection against spam and fraudulent links.

Customers can also enjoy a range of entertainment subscriptions and access to exclusive experiences through the Airtel Postpaid Advantage Club, the company said.

Henri Kagan and Kenso Soai win 2026 chemistry Nobel prize

Reuters
Stockholm



Henri Kagan and Kenso Soai were announced as the winners of the 2026 Nobel Prize in Chemistry during a press meet at the Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences in Stockholm REUTERS

Scientists Henri Kagan and Kenso Soai won the 2026 Nobel Prize in Chemistry "for the discovery of non-linear effects and auto catalysis in asymmetric organic synthesis," the award-giving body said on Wednesday.

The chemistry Nobel, always the third prize to be awarded during Nobel week, followed those for medicine and physics announced on Monday and Tuesday.

"So this year's prize is about foundational chemistry. Many molecules occur in two different versions. Like my hands. They are one another's mirror image, they look alike, but they are not identical. I cannot put my hands on top of one another. Such molecules are called chiral, from the Greek word for hand," Heiner Linke, Chair of the Nobel Committee for Chemistry, said.

INFLUENTIAL

Sometimes overshadowed by more famous laureates in the fields of physics, literature and peace, the chemistry awards have still recognised many influential discoveries, such as nuclear fission and genetic sequencing techniques. Last year's chemistry award went to scientists Susumu Kitagawa, Richard Robson and Omar Yaghi.

The laureates will receive their medals from Sweden's King Carl XVI Gustaf at a ceremony in Stockholm on December 10. They will also share 12 million Swedish crowns ($1.2 million).

Ladakh launches high-altitude safari for tourists to watch elusive snow leopards

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar

Ladakh has launched a wildlife safari giving tourists a chance to explore its high-altitude landscape in search of elusive snow leopards, Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena said in a post on X on Wednesday.

Saxena said six specially-designed open-back vehicles were flagged off in Leh on Wednesday during the Wildlife Week celebrations for the Ladakh Snow Leopard Safari, about two months after the administration announced the plan.

The safari will initially operate in Rumbak, Shang and Uley, with trained local drivers and wildlife guides taking visitors through designated areas where they can look for snow leopards in the wild. The administration described it as India's first high-altitude wildlife safari and said the programme was aimed at bringing together tourism, conservation and local livelihoods.

MOUNTAIN WILDLIFE

Snow leopards are among the most difficult animals to spot in Ladakh. They live in remote, rocky high-altitude terrain and are known for their ability to remain largely hidden from people.

The safari will also give visitors a chance to see other wildlife, including Himalayan brown bears and wolves. Ladakh is home to more than 340 bird species and around 1,800 species of vascular plants, according to the administration.

Authorities are looking at expanding the safari to more areas, with additional routes



being identified across Hemis National Park, Changthang, Karakoram Wildlife Sanctuary, Nubra, Zanskar, Sham, Kargil and Drass.

LOCAL RECRUITMENT

Locals are expected to play a central role in the programme.

The administration said local drivers and wildlife guides would be involved in the safaris, creating opportunities for young people and communities to earn from wildlife tourism.

The idea is also to make local communities partners in protecting wildlife and the habitat, rather than treating conservation and tourism as separate activities.

Alongside the safari launch, authorities inaugurated an artificial intelligence-based device aimed at helping prevent human-wildlife conflict in Ladakh. The administration described it as the first of its kind. For visitors, however, the main attraction is likely to remain the chance of spotting a snow leopard moving through the barren mountain slopes.

Authorities said more routes would be identified as the programme expands, with community participation and protection of Ladakh's fragile ecosystem remaining key parts of the initiative.

Mumbai airport capacity reduction must be done after assessment, consultations: IATA

Our Bureau
Mumbai



IATA issued the statement after the Civil Aviation Ministry put on hold Mumbai airport's proposal to reduce one-third of all international flights from October 26 REUTERS

The International Air Transport Association (IATA) has said that any significant reduction in capacity at Mumbai airport should be carried out after transparent capacity-demand assessment and meaningful consultations with affected airlines.

IATA issued the statement on Wednesday after the Civil Aviation Ministry put on hold the Mumbai airport's proposal to reduce one-third of all international flights from October 26.

STAKEHOLDERS TALKS

IATA, which represents 370 global airlines, said it supports redevelopment of the Mumbai airport's terminal 1 and development of the Navi Mumbai airport. However, any significant reduction in capacity or any other measures impacting operations should be done after capacity-demand assessment, stakeholder consultations and after providing sufficient time to develop workable transition arrangements that minimise disruption for passengers, it said.

On Tuesday, Civil Aviation Secretary Samir Kumar Sinha chaired a meeting attended by executives of airlines, the Airport Authority of India and the Adani Group, which runs the Mumbai and Navi Mumbai airports.

AIRLINES RESIST

The Adani Group has proposed phased wise development of Mumbai terminal 1 from January 2027. The airport cited safety concerns while pushing for redevelopment. The proposal to reduce one third of international flights at terminal 2 to accommodate domestic traffic from terminal 1 is being resisted by airlines.

The next meeting between the airlines and Adani Airports is planned on October 13.

"The discussion now provides an opportunity for stakeholders using the airport to review the underlying capacity requirements, understand the basis of any proposed capacity reduction, examine alternatives that may mitigate such reductions, and work collaboratively on a transition plan that protects passenger interests, airline operations and the international connectivity of the Mumbai Metropolitan Region," IATA said in a statement.

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Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
20 Microns [5]	207.87	204.56	208.00	210.58	203.50	70.09	238.10	130.50	12	204.50
360 One WAM	1069.50	1063.00	1060.20	1070.80	1053.70	246.15	1236.20	906.05	-	-
3B Blackbio	1575.10	1615.50	1606.00	1667.90	1576.50	11.52	1740.00	1085.00	-	-
3M India	30840.00	30825.00	30910.00	31250.00	30475.00	12.87	38300.00	28747.30	79	30823.95
5PAISA	349.70	348.00	349.05	352.95	344.30	25.16	416.65	245.00	37	349.40
63 MoonsTe [2]	792.95	783.20	791.00	806.70	775.95	164.40	957.70	465.55	63	782.95

A

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
AAA Tech	103.53	106.79	103.51	111.00	103.51	416.48	136.00	81.10	-	-
Aadhar Hsg	453.80	455.05	451.05	460.25	443.15	218.91	563.00	427.30	-	-
Aarey Drugs	107.85	108.81	108.10	110.00	104.48	497.49	110.00	50.31	-	-
Aarti Drugs	428.80	417.55	425.00	429.95	415.00	147.08	533.60	318.60	22	416.75
Aarti Ind [5]	481.15	491.25	481.75	492.90	478.40	570.69	551.45	338.20	34	490.60
Aarti Pharm	975.00	953.35	980.05	980.50	950.00	522.30	1002.40	585.00	-	-
Aavas	1215.10	1231.70	1218.00	1236.60	1194.00	44.35	1774.95	1050.25	14	1230.05
AB Capital	378.90	372.10	377.50	380.20	370.05	4394.04	430.55	288.00	31	374.00
AB Real Est	1078.00	1049.40	1080.90	1090.00	1040.20	209.94	1914.00	1040.20	-	-
AB Sun Life	1009.65	1015.50	1009.65	1040.40	1009.65	201.36	1224.90	708.00	-	-
ABB [2]	7122.50	7005.00	7122.50	7122.50	6989.00	133.62	7923.35	4640.50	96	7015.00
Abbott (I)	26115.00	26095.00	26150.00	26200.00	25950.00	8.95	30598.00	25140.50	34	26087.15
ABFRL	45.68	44.62	45.49	45.55	44.48	4104.35	86.58	44.05	-	44.71
ACC	1177.00	1165.50	1180.00	1182.70	1160.10	95.19	1986.90	1161.00	11	1166.25
ACCELYA	1097.50	1100.10	1102.80	1108.50	1097.00	50.00	1523.95	1017.10	15	1099.95
ACEVECTOR	25.93	31.11	25.80	31.11	25.27	66714.95	31.11	23.37	-	-
ACME Solar	448.20	436.15	450.00	450.00	433.40	813.27	476.90	195.90	-	-
Action Cons [2]	1252.20	1249.90	1251.00	1263.00	1235.90	245.93	1267.05	746.10	33	1249.95
Acutaas Chem	3156.70	3174.20	3160.00	3194.10	3136.10	209.53	3740.00	1374.00	-	-
Adani Ent [1]	2849.90	2743.00	2827.00	2848.30	2732.00	1738.03	3245.00	1753.45	112	2744.00
Adani Green	1313.00	1341.40	1313.00	1377.80	1310.70	6420.42	1631.35	767.00	323	1341.00
Adani Ports [2]	1783.40	1750.10	1782.50	1786.00	1739.40	1187.84	1891.80	1293.10	146	1748.10
Adani Pwr [2]	202.40	196.94	202.00	203.45	196.00	18844.73	254.15	128.35	32	196.60
Adani T Gas	588.45	581.90	588.45	595.45	580.20	570.26	859.85	462.80	-	-
Adani Wilm	185.93	187.11	185.81	188.85	183.53	2805.36	282.90	171.19	-	-
Adani.E.Sol	1350.10	1318.80	1349.90	1370.50	1305.10	1468.66	1789.00	803.10	-	-
ADF Foods [2]	293.10	291.70	295.00	297.90	290.35	217.58	346.95	153.65	31	291.50
AdityaBirlaL	73.16	73.69	73.00	76.46	72.61	8210.03	150.79	72.20	-	-
AdityaInfote	3976.00	4064.90	4023.00	4099.00	3945.00	208.91	4188.90	1304.00	-	-
AdityaVisi	595.10	621.10	597.70	625.00	591.15	180.61	705.00	436.55	-	-
AdorWelding	1535.00	1552.10	1549.80	1574.90	1517.00	26.36	1766.40	848.00	-	-
Advait Ener	1946.90	1910.80	1958.00	1958.00	1883.20	29.83	2485.00	1351.00	-	-
Advent Hotel	122.21	121.77	122.50	125.45	120.15	121.58	345.05	120.02	-	-
Advenzymes [2]	273.10	270.05	273.10	274.95	269.25	186.35	419.80	251.90	36	270.10
Advit Jewels	330.35	360.80	329.45	363.35	327.25	1711.53	363.35	161.60	-	-
Aegis Log [1]	1395.90	1460.20	1399.10	1481.00	1383.40	1713.09	1528.00	576.00	40	1459.95
Aegis VopakT	293.35	294.25	294.00	301.80	290.50	1371.00	320.95	158.00	-	-
Aequs	286.10	288.15	284.75	292.15	278.55	4796.95	294.70	113.30	-	-
Aeroflex Ind	560.75	563.85	566.40	567.00	550.35	1019.70	584.15	158.00	-	-
AeroflexEnt	132.56	129.01	131.90	131.90	128.20	422.83	159.60	62.20	-	-
Aether Ind	1799.80	1787.60	1781.10	1807.90	1770.50	273.75	1814.10	728.00	-	-
Afcons Infra	242.15	244.38	240.95	245.70	240.17	230.74	479.40	225.35	-	-
Affle [2]	1450.20	1436.00	1450.20	1453.00	1428.00	116.54	1992.50	1251.85	140	1435.30
AGI Greenpac	786.40	787.50	786.00	795.75	773.30	85.35	896.15	465.00	-	-
AGI Infra	259.10	257.15	259.00	259.65	255.30	199.47	1408.00	224.70	-	-
Ahluwalia [2]	576.05	561.50	574.95	574.95	558.00	28.08	1076.60	542.25	17	562.30
AIA Engg [2]	3914.70	3858.00	3933.00	3933.00	3825.60	45.14	5175.00	3151.10	28	3858.40
Ajanta Ph [2]	3573.40	3569.80	3573.40	3611.00	3529.30	93.21	3796.95	2380.90	44	3569.45
Ajax Engg	585.85	582.75	589.00	589.00	579.00	33.51	678.00	394.80	-	-
Ajmera [2]	116.24	117.99	116.50	118.85	115.01	151.32	221.23	98.10	20	117.95
Akme Fin	7.90	7.54	7.93	7.95	6.95	1086.23	11.10	3.92	-	-
Akums Drugs	814.65	822.55	819.80	833.00	814.65	153.95	838.80	409.30	-	-
ALEM PHA [2]	834.20	833.80	834.10	839.00	821.25	135.89	998.00	635.30	21	833.05
Alembic Ltd [2]	104.99	103.57	105.00	105.28	102.81	360.07	117.91	70.64	22	103.45
Algoquant Fi	70.56	70.20	70.56	73.73	69.37	1930.09	76.20	47.80	-	-
Alicon [5]	866.90	901.40	871.20	909.00	855.00	131.46	1024.95	580.55	34	900.10
AlivusLife	1384.00	1370.20	1389.90	1389.90	1361.60	79.36	1493.80	819.00	-	-
Alkem labs [2]	5292.00	5350.50	5297.00	5404.50	5292.00	205.15	5933.00	5052.05	28	5360.00
ALKYL AMI [2]	1962.20	1918.90	1925.20	1930.00	1886.10	189.99	2115.00	1212.35	44	1918.35
Allcargo Glo [2]	10.50	10.28	10.50	10.52	10.22	3180.67	16.18	7.10	-	10.31
Allcargo Glo	12.77	12.63	12.71	13.13	12.51	853.86	22.00	12.03	-	-
Allcargo Ter	24.71	25.67	24.67	26.00	24.24	381.12	38.69	18.20	-	-
ALLIED DIGIT [5]	103.82	102.04	102.39	104.28	101.32	137.11	203.55	86.50	-	102.25
AlliedBlend	714.65	694.25	719.60	719.60	690.30	398.47	753.80	382.10	-	-
AllTimePlas	184.36	184.43	184.79	188.80	181.55	66.20	314.70	180.01	-	-
Alok Ind	7.83	8.29	8.00	8.50	7.95	63108.26	18.45	6.92	-	-
Alpine Texwo	46.44	46.04	45.79	47.59	45.79	107.86	105.00	45.50	-	-
Amagi Media	564.15	561.45	558.55	568.95	557.20	140.26	727.40	310.20	-	-
AMAL.	753.70	798.05	754.95	817.00	753.70	69.70	822.00	636.05	-	-
Amar.Raj.Enr	742.90	733.25	744.00	745.00	729.75	347.79	1023.00	670.00	-	-
Amber	6869.00	6925.00	6810.00	6925.00	6767.50	91.29	8970.00	5404.00	165	6900.00
Ambuja Cem [2]	361.55	356.90	362.40	362.75	352.45	3466.43	588.55	352.65	24	356.50
AmirChand Ja	209.24	218.44	208.40	219.70	208.40	1610.25	219.70	117.02	-	-
Anand RathiW	2142.00	2127.20	2149.00	2167.50	2120.90	282.65	3735.00	1710.60	-	-
AnandRathiS	551.55	571.15	551.50	574.70	545.10	606.94	794.85	416.00	-	-
Anant Raj [2]	608.90	612.15	613.70	622.55	601.55	2034.13	744.10	403.00	72	611.55
Anant Raj Gl	124.10	122.24	124.10	124.39	121.23	240.41	186.30	109.10	-	-
Andhra Paper	70.48	70.07	70.82	70.98	69.85	190.58	86.89	58.00	-	-
Andhra Sug [2]	94.42	93.37	94.56	95.95	92.80	274.46	107.00	63.27	10	93.61
AngelOne	295.00	302.00	293.50	306.25	291.25	13538.34	2867.00	208.63	-	-
Anlon Health	29.66	28.18	28.18	28.18	28.18	2139.00	172.75	12.91	-	-
ANNU PRO	44.33	45.53	44.40	46.00	43.84	414.11	75.60	43.22	-	-
AntelopusSel	1100.60	1130.20	1113.90	1160.00	1107.70	378.32	1290.90	357.00	-	-
AnthemBiosci	890.35	887.05	892.00	892.90	881.30	163.48	977.55	579.15	-	-
Antony W Hdg	355.20	348.70	357.10	357.10	346.00	114.38	605.00	337.55	-	-
Anuh Phar	87.57	85.51	87.98	88.00	85.00	53.00	99.50	67.00	-	-
Anup Engg	1575.90	1547.00	1575.00	1577.00	1535.00	11.00	2524.00	1422.30	-	-
Anupam Ras.	1170.20	1165.10	1166.00	1172.00	1159.50	55.56	1415.00	1047.90	-	-
A-ONE STEELS	384.80	420.35	387.95	425.00	379.25	1184.04	470.00	366.45	-	-
Apar Ind	18016.00	18160.00	18200.00	18308.00	17960.00	106.71	19269.20	6800.00	64	18171.00
Apcotex Ind [2]	610.70	592.70	608.10	608.60	585.50	78.15	712.45	310.15	19	593.10
Apex	339.80	343.40	339.80	345.00	332.50	86.81	514.20	218.80	22	343.25
APL Apollo [2]	2152.00	2135.00	2128.60	2156.50	2115.10	613.42	2300.90	1691.05	102	2120.65
APOLLO [1]	408.05	414.75	407.25	422.45	405.00	9053.89	466.70	180.80	120	416.25
Apollo Hosp. [5]	7914.50	7917.00	7850.00	7917.00	7822.00	545.50	9326.80	6680.00	72	7898.75
Apollo Pipes	529.80	531.45	530.65	539.00	521.00	90.31	668.80	252.10	-	-
Apollo Tyres [1]	401.55	407.60	397.70	408.15	397.05	546.10	540.30	365.35	13	407.50
Aptech Ltd	88.19	86.87	88.50	88.50	86.02	57.27	128.65	69.50	22	87.04
Aptus V Hsg	223.90	219.46	223.35	224.50	217.29	1540.79	326.15	193.03	-	-
Archean Chem	474.50	476.20	471.40	478.05	466.85	110.91	685.35	446.00	-	-
Ardee Indus	50.22	50.79	50.00	51.00	49.29	1828.32	73.19	46.50	-	-
Arfin IndiaL	96.36	103.06	98.50	104.00	97.70	11566.94	106.20	47.00	-	-
Arih.Capital	94.13	97.38	94.49	98.00	93.43	1292.99	120.00	56.97	-	-
Arisinfra So	143.66	142.31	143.66	144.50	139.72	1545.69	178.30	82.18	-	-
Arman Fin	1743.70	1741.20	1742.90	1750.90	1716.00	19.58	2159.10	1302.30	43	1739.00
ARMEE IN	271.05	269.95	273.95	273.95	263.05	959.16	375.00	251.05	-	-
Arrow green	891.75	893.35	896.15	905.80	887.65	19.83	950.00	342.00	23	896.70
Artemis Med	318.35	318.30	316.00	323.15	316.00	249.72	378.80	203.35	-	-
Arvind Fash [4]	406.40	397.95	405.00	408.80	396.00	139.45	572.20	366.60	383	398.15
Arvind Ltd	534.65	529.30	534.65	535.50	526.30	382.76	607.00	278.00	53	529.75
ArvindSmart	603.80	612.50	600.45	618.45	597.20	102.44	707.20	490.35	41	612.50
Asahi Ind. [1]	956.95	976.25	961.00	981.50	950.00	142.79	1072.95	775.05	58	976.40
Ashapura [2]	502.90	488.00	500.00	504.90	479.50	732.92	924.70	456.50	31	489.10
Ashok Ley [1]	153.70	149.20	152.91	153.41	148.64	11928.15	215.35	134.20	23	149.35
Ashoka [5]	106.42	104.03	106.40	106.80	103.75	569.92	214.35	101.00	15	104.10
Asian Energy	463.75	480.15	465.60	484.00	459.25	246.81	565.70	230.00	-	-
Asian granit	48.10	47.19	47.80	48.69	47.10	299.62	79.08	42.50	-	47.21
Asian Paints [1]	2424.20	2372.10	2371.80	2403.20	2360.20	522.76	2985.50	2116.00	48	2370.00
ASK Auto.	609.75	626.55	606.75	632.70	602.00	298.69	687.70	375.30	-	-
ASSET RECONS	145.74	160.31	149.00	160.31	148.00	15925.02	160.31	124.50	-	-
ASTECFE	704.70	748.20	724.95	773.70	714.90	414.24	936.00	512.35	-	747.70
ASTERDM	684.70	680.30	685.05	690.05	676.30	1205.26	890.95	519.80	192	680.15
Astha Spint	29.54	30.12	29.70	31.00	29.62	579.92	140.01	29.29	-	-
Astra Micro [2]	1705.90	1701.10	1704.60	1723.90	1688.00	197.60	1960.00	835.90	92	1701.15
Astral Poly [1]	1402.30	1427.70	1401.30	1448.00	1390.20	759.82	1767.95	1311.90	58	1430.00
Astrazeneca [2]	5980.50	5918.00	6000.50	6000.50	5802.00	6.18	9850.00	5805.00	85	5918.55
Atal RealTe	12.36	12.12	12.33	12.33	11.75	1832.76	36.70	11.70	-	-
AtherEnergy	1446.00	1455.00	1436.00	1466.00	1418.40	4057.01	1744.00	582.00	-	-
Atlanta Elec	1869.30	1875.80	1869.00	1938.50	1857.60	281.59	2152.60	707.60	-	-
ATUL AUTO [5]	427.50	426.25	428.60	430.30	424.00	33.90	596.65	381.00	22	426.50
ATUL.	6000.00	5999.50	6000.00	6025.00	5917.00	45.52	7198.20	5563.00	25	5998.70
AU SFB	1028.00	993.40	1018.40	1027.00	988.30	1757.70	1144.65	751.90	26	994.00
AUGMONT ENTE	1162.20	1216.20	1153.00	1220.30	1137.50	653.47	1254.90	806.05	-	-
Aurionpro So	616.05	612.80	617.10	620.20	604.65	94.00	1247.15	595.60	31	612.15
Aurob Ph [1]	1692.80	1682.00	1696.20	1698.90	1670.50	438.15	1739.95	1066.00	37	1685.00
Aurum Prop	231.14	231.20	229.06	236.40	227.11	124.14	264.64	151.90	-	-
Authum Inv	550.15	549.65	554.70	555.80	545.45	81.52	3318.70	400.00	-	-
Avadh Sugar	873.30	937.55	880.10	947.95	880.10	570.10	947.00	307.75	28	936.05
Avalon Tech	2400.40	2429.70	2400.40	2475.00	2353.30	364.77	2618.00	777.30	-	-
Avantel	151.08	153.28	150.97	154.29	150.03	734.20	215.00	117.05	-	-
Avanti Feeds [1]	714.10	722.30	714.10	730.00	707.00	237.91	1592.30	635.40	21	721.75
AvenueSai	15.35	15.56	15.45	15.80	15.25	9135.28	20.50	12.92	-	-
Avro India	6.85	6.13	7.09	7.09	5.82	965.87	158.70	5.82	-	-
AVT Natur [1]	90.18	88.75	89.30	89.58	87.81	129.67	101.80	53.34	20	88.39
Awfis Space	243.54	250.75	244.91	256.20	241.00	1503.52	639.40	229.05	-	-
Axis Bank [2]	1248.00	1242.50	1240.20	1259.00	1230.20	9678.42	1418.30	1150.50	15	1243.90
AXISCADES [5]	2288.50	2245.60	2268.00	2285.90	2223.30	122.67	2360.00	1061.00	-	2245.40
Aye Finance [2]	165.56	167.63	165.07	169.90	163.00	614.55	197.95	162.80	21	167.75
AYM Syntex	289.25	277.50	290.80	291.70	275.00	146.55	330.00	144.35	87	277.30
Azad Engg	3062.60	3048.20	3050.00	3064.90	2996.50	585.88	3127.90	1360.00	-	-

B

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Baazar Style	375.45	379.90	375.00	388.50	371.55	1166.93	447.10	229.95	-	-
BAJAJ AUTO	10017.00	9884.00	9970.00	9997.00	9727.00	442.31	12470.00	8606.00	25	9861.10
Bajaj Cons [1]	493.50	483.00	491.50	492.70	481.05	191.50	691.15	238.20	28	483.10
Bajaj Elect [2]	300.25	300.70	299.70	303.00	297.60	90.03	561.05	296.00	-	301.05
Bajaj Fin [1]	963.10	963.85	969.15	984.40	952.30	11415.16	1177.60	788.40	33	964.10
Bajaj Finser [1]	1752.40	1743.30	1740.00	1758.60	1728.10	990.04	2194.65	1598.15	126	1741.00
Bajaj HCare	323.10	323.30	320.25	326.65	319.30	68.14	506.45	272.35	-	-
Bajaj Hindus [1]	21.33	21.05	21.16	21.64	20.84	19089.11	26.00	14.89	-	21.05
Bajaj Holdng	10600.00	10662.00	10699.00	10779.00	10568.00	39.08	13245.00	8597.50	39	10640.90
Bajaj HsgFin	82.36	84.08	82.11	84.41	81.70	4604.05	113.45	72.65	-	-
Bajel Proj.	164.08	162.34	163.88	163.88	161.71	67.79	219.64	135.10	-	-
Balaji Amine [2]	2287.70	2155.90	2269.20	2269.20	2132.10	709.75	2627.95	905.15	35	2158.85
Balkrish Ind [2]	2082.70	2006.60	2079.00	2079.00	2002.00	295.28	2775.00	1971.50	28	2007.05
BalmerLawrie	158.78	158.88	158.20	159.95	154.10	346.20	208.90	148.35	11	158.90
BalramChini [1]	691.30	706.60	692.05	710.00	687.60	1646.55	781.00	393.40	44	705.85
Balu Forge	526.95	507.50	525.15	525.90	505.70	538.06	678.00	341.05	-	-
Banco Prod [2]	602.65	600.20	599.00	605.00	594.70	61.31	875.95	503.00	21	600.25
Bandhan Bk	164.15	162.99	164.15	167.59	161.33	10016.17	220.70	134.30	19	163.10
Bank of Maha	80.80	84.15	80.80	84.50	79.89	20883.27	94.50	54.70	9	84.07
Bansal Wire	325.70	324.00	327.80	330.90	320.15	110.11	370.00	222.50	-	-
BASF India	3472.10	3453.80	3472.10	3495.40	3434.00	9.47	4690.00	2906.90	24	3453.60
Bata India [5]	619.85	615.10	619.85	624.00	613.60	45.93	1236.85	605.55	46	615.30
Batliboi Ltd [5]	96.16	94.80	96.83	98.82	93.01	93.59	157.00	66.41	62	95.06
Bayer Crop	3533.40	3491.50	3535.00	3549.80	3478.00	26.50	5133.00	3480.10	21	3490.80
BCL Ind.	32.03	31.55	32.03	32.09	31.12	332.00	41.70	25.53	-	-
BDL [5]	1101.80	1085.00	1104.90	1104.90	1078.60	790.11	1633.15	1071.30	76	1086.00
Behari Lal	510.05	514.40	510.05	518.80	503.00	1287.18	548.00	415.00	-	-
Belrise Inds	236.81	246.31	236.70	247.25	233.66	3749.66	268.20	142.59	-	-
BEML [5]	2042.20	2006.20	2042.20	2042.60	1992.10	146.91	2276.75	1361.10	91	2005.85
BergerPaints [1]	472.55	463.90	470.60	471.90	461.80	189.88	594.20	391.50	46	464.05
BF UTILI [5]	498.90	496.20	495.90	500.45	492.00	36.84	834.00	369.00	-	497.20
BHAGIL [5]	393.55	377.55	393.00	403.60	370.55	173.07	424.70	128.15	22	379.30
Bhagira.Chm	239.91	235.82	240.48	240.95	234.10	174.48	316.90	170.60	-	-
Bhagynagar [2]	432.95	454.55	441.00	454.55	430.00	601.01	469.80	95.20	-	453.95
BHANSALI [1]	128.63	127.61	129.60	129.60	126.82	541.54	138.50	75.52	16	127.50
BHARAT BI [5]	2068.80	2042.00	2070.00	2084.80	2037.00	18.09	3403.40	2009.45	21	2040.05
Bharat Elect [1]	387.40	378.30	386.50	386.50	378.00	13636.29	473.25	377.00	45	378.85
Bharat Forge [2]	1880.00	1841.80	1871.00	1871.00	1826.90	410.63	2293.00	1182.85	73	1838.20
Bharat Wire	165.28	171.99	165.90	174.39	163.72	771.20	262.20	149.15	17	171.75
BharatCoking	32.05	32.09	32.05	32.32	31.85	3011.31	45.09	29.74	-	-
BharatSeats	206.14	204.59	206.15	207.54	203.61	52.20	263.18	133.60	-	-
Bharti Airte [5]	1810.50	1833.90	1823.00	1854.70	1810.50	13920.83	2174.70	1726.05	66	1833.00
Bharti Hexa	1386.80	1477.90	1386.80	1485.00	1376.50	1512.59	1955.60	1359.20	-	-
BHEL [2]	452.00	448.50	451.50	455.95	446.60	14451.00	455.90	229.70	65	448.90
Bikaji Fds	481.10	483.55	484.90	490.30	482.00	137.07	768.50	477.55	-	-
Billionbrain	193.19	197.75	192.80	198.27	189.45	42404.06	227.20	112.00	-	-
Biocon [5]	369.10	360.00	368.40	368.40	358.40	4416.75	447.00	337.95	195	360.50
BIRLA CORPN.	803.45	814.40	803.40	820.50	793.00	52.42	1245.70	773.90	26	814.80
Birla Eric	395.45	385.05	398.00	404.35	377.25	529.87	418.00	104.00	25	384.95
Birlanu Ltd	1406.50	1321.30	1410.70	1411.90	1190.30	133.94	1999.00	1190.10	-	-
Birlasoft	279.45	278.05	278.00	281.80	275.20	958.77	474.00	267.05	-	-
Bk of baroda [2]	232.73	234.55	231.80	236.38	230.18	6320.16	325.55	223.90	6	234.55
Bk of India	132.16	133.55	132.59	135.19	130.26	9853.57	178.45	122.20	5	133.80
Black Box	839.95	884.85	840.95	893.10	815.85	2262.49	1103.00	444.30	-	-
BLS [1]	223.97	220.84	224.00	225.53	220.23	512.07	358.90	212.15	62	220.75
BLS e-Svc	160.90	158.20	158.30	160.75	156.50	339.93	339.80	124.30	-	-
Blue CloudSo	20.01	20.35	20.35	22.87	20.08	58789.24	24.50	18.85	-	-
Blue Jet Hlt	538.15	541.35	540.00	546.00	535.70	207.77	692.90	325.00	-	-
Blue Star [2]	1571.50	1530.10	1562.90	1575.00	1530.10	436.49	2032.00	1432.00	88	1538.25
BlueDart Exp	4562.80	4555.20	4596.90	4620.80	4519.30	18.78	7030.15	4460.05	34	4559.30
BluestoneJew	813.85	831.10	812.65	835.00	805.40	707.91	969.90	399.80	-	-
BluspringEnt	144.53	142.71	144.53	147.29	141.50	134.33	152.50	43.98	-	-
BMW Ventures	50.37	50.11	50.02	50.89	49.76	47.12	73.20	48.00	-	-
Bom Dyeing [2]	102.91	101.63	102.91	102.91	101.01	416.07	178.70	92.10	100	101.75
BombayBu [2]	1298.20	1269.40	1301.30	1301.30	1263.20	113.93	2135.00	1263.90	111	1270.15
Borosil	286.85	281.15	287.00	290.70	280.00	197.20	363.40	213.73	-	-
Borosil.Ren.	449.85	438.10	447.90	448.00	433.80	357.44	721.00	374.40	-	-
Bosch Home	1976.90	1948.10	1993.00	1993.00	1928.20	34.82	2036.90	1021.30	-	-
BOSCH	45000.00	44410.00	45000.00	45000.00	44305.00	21.19	49629.50	28650.05	56	44450.00
BPCL	300.50	296.35	297.00	298.65	294.75	6249.90	391.85	266.55	8	297.00
BrainbeesSol	177.57	172.20	178.01	178.01	171.20	1240.46	389.65	163.37	-	-
Brigade	569.10	554.20	572.00	573.80	552.45	160.21	801.56	461.25	52	554.75
BrigadeHotel	56.93	56.87	56.93	57.40	56.10	58.03	87.79	54.36	-	-
BrightcomGr [2]	9.07	9.08	9.07	9.15	9.05	2283.35	15.

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Park MediWo	274.85	272.80	274.00	275.90	270.00	689.82	305.00	138.10	-	-
PashupatiCot	69.91	69.60	71.45	75.04	68.15	3311.37	1036.40	67.75	-	-
Patanjali Fd	363.00	360.95	362.45	363.00	354.00	3163.36	614.05	328.20	-	-
Patel engg [1]	25.93	25.74	25.85	26.09	25.62	1235.70	37.43	22.08	6	25.73
Patel Retail	227.01	227.86	225.88	233.39	223.00	234.78	266.00	150.25	-	-
Paushak	704.30	697.55	722.85	722.85	692.50	40.67	826.75	342.50	-	-
PayTM	1694.00	1732.00	1686.50	1774.00	1680.10	5016.09	1855.50	930.60	-	-
PB Fintech	1034.90	1040.00	1034.50	1041.20	1012.00	3508.12	1964.20	945.10	-	-
PC Jeweller [1]	12.93	13.14	12.95	13.25	12.87	208486.73	14.87	7.45	-	13.15
PCBL	327.70	326.90	328.70	329.00	323.65	499.46	394.00	226.50	-	-
PDS	347.40	342.00	348.35	348.40	337.15	76.94	418.50	246.05	-	-
PENNAR IND [5]	177.85	180.85	177.85	182.95	175.23	368.40	279.80	128.90	24	181.55
PERSISTENT [5]	5521.00	5507.00	5513.50	5529.00	5447.50	298.34	6597.00	4242.65	50	5500.10
Petronet LNG	297.50	297.00	295.00	299.60	294.25	3121.24	326.40	235.45	11	296.75
Pfizer Ltd.	3852.20	3815.10	3870.00	3870.10	3802.00	11.66	5561.55	3794.40	23	3815.80
PG Electro [1]	527.65	522.00	523.65	531.00	519.20	987.71	644.90	436.85	136	522.75
PGIL [5]	1266.70	1273.10	1265.00	1311.00	1261.40	177.38	1356.55	605.50	203	1273.75
Phoenix Mill [2]	1883.50	1845.50	1861.00	1886.30	1845.00	277.95	2168.65	1465.30	211	1850.60
PhysicsWall	131.86	139.57	131.02	140.20	130.70	34917.95	161.99	77.72	-	-
PI INDUS. [1]	2250.00	2210.00	2259.00	2259.00	2197.80	167.30	3829.90	2193.60	24	2214.70
PiccadilyAgr	594.20	589.00	592.55	602.00	584.00	57.00	809.70	515.00	-	-
Pidilite [1]	1520.50	1488.50	1515.00	1515.00	1483.10	537.27	1707.95	1259.45	59	1486.90
Pine Labs	172.73	177.67	173.00	184.70	171.54	40833.33	284.00	134.73	-	-
Piramal Fin	2018.50	1981.50	2018.00	2022.70	1970.20	377.33	2326.40	1260.00	-	-
Piramal Phr	200.52	203.01	200.06	205.10	199.99	2298.29	231.93	132.30	-	-
Pitti Engg [5]	1122.00	1118.40	1122.00	1149.80	1115.00	86.46	1228.15	677.20	42	1118.80
Pix Transm	1796.70	1788.40	1784.00	1808.80	1756.10	24.83	2089.00	1252.00	-	-
PLASTIBL [5]	202.40	205.09	205.00	207.00	200.20	47.82	215.95	121.00	12	204.50
PlatinumInd	203.58	200.56	203.63	207.00	200.00	50.71	299.00	183.50	-	-
PN Gadgil Jw	588.60	597.05	587.80	603.95	582.60	424.42	736.40	503.00	-	-
Pnb Gilts	71.42	71.52	71.50	72.64	71.00	343.48	99.90	58.75	13	71.54
PNB Housng	1102.10	1131.00	1105.10	1139.70	1105.10	1125.06	1210.80	730.00	12	1139.00
PNC Infra [2]	138.74	136.93	138.74	139.00	135.85	441.40	293.20	116.25	7	137.05
PNGS Reva Di	547.20	631.00	551.45	653.00	549.90	4514.80	653.00	324.25	-	-
POCL Enterp	133.71	135.86	133.71	137.70	131.57	42.71	168.97	131.57	-	-
Pokarna Ltd [2]	709.90	704.45	712.00	712.20	698.30	31.83	1147.35	685.00	-	703.35
Poly Medicu [5]	1633.80	1615.00	1635.00	1641.00	1599.50	114.74	2093.95	1184.00	48	1615.05
POLYCAB INDIA	8147.00	8310.00	8130.50	8335.50	8038.00	531.31	10126.00	6663.00	-	-
Polyplex	1034.30	1023.30	1028.30	1030.00	1010.40	38.43	1267.75	743.00	65	1025.45
PonawallaFin	460.45	448.90	459.70	459.70	447.85	1030.92	570.40	361.20	-	-
Pondy Oxides	447.25	448.40	448.45	450.95	438.00	181.02	1619.00	427.60	-	-
Ponni Sug(er	374.55	365.40	375.00	379.80	362.15	76.41	454.20	253.50	10	366.15
Power Finan	322.60	325.55	322.90	332.25	321.95	15838.63	486.45	313.50	5	325.25
Power grid	257.20	253.05	256.60	256.65	252.85	4339.99	324.80	250.05	15	253.40
Power Trad	157.14	151.72	150.80	152.14	149.35	1807.62	229.40	149.20	12	151.70
Powerica Ltd	601.70	600.95	600.05	613.60	590.00	167.82	676.95	365.10	-	-
POWERMECH	2426.00	2429.30	2414.50	2449.40	2401.00	26.53	3008.85	1718.00	22	2426.75
Prabha Energ	221.33	225.82	220.91	229.00	220.01	156.05	262.80	137.91	-	-
PRADEEP MET	544.25	620.90	572.20	653.10	572.20	514.85	653.10	357.05	-	-
Praj Ind.ltd [2]	315.05	300.40	315.05	315.90	299.20	649.18	427.75	273.05	39	300.40
Prakash Ind.	119.70	118.31	119.35	119.40	117.11	264.93	173.00	110.00	7	118.30
PRANAV CONST	90.90	94.22	90.29	95.88	89.10	3367.70	165.10	89.10	-	-
PRASOL CHEM	821.45	878.90	824.20	889.95	821.45	609.94	914.90	601.00	-	-
Precam	113.27	113.85	112.65	115.98	109.00	155.01	201.00	104.05	30	113.25
Precision Wr [1]	515.15	516.60	515.00	522.05	509.35	455.69	524.00	193.10	54	516.10
Premier Enr	907.00	910.00	900.15	917.70	894.35	918.75	1134.00	660.00	-	-
Premier Expl [2]	685.10	687.05	685.90	693.90	682.10	200.27	829.95	378.80	107	688.45
prestige Est	1467.70	1429.30	1467.50	1467.50	1425.50	589.96	1804.65	1090.45	340	1434.40
Pricol Ltd [1]	677.65	661.25	681.00	687.00	658.65	609.35	822.35	506.65	37	660.95
Prime Focus [1]	292.70	284.00	294.85	296.10	265.00	8031.09	367.25	161.05	-	283.35
Primo Chemic	26.97	25.62	27.44	27.44	25.25	277.27	29.80	16.10	-	-
Prince Pipe	258.20	256.65	256.55	262.00	253.15	104.91	352.20	205.00	-	-
PRIORITY J	311.85	319.55	315.00	342.70	305.30	1457.43	342.70	209.61	-	-
Prism Cement	103.48	100.71	103.75	103.75	100.21	332.14	165.80	97.70	50	100.55
Privi Speclt	3504.90	3519.20	3504.90	3545.00	3476.00	78.11	3785.30	2380.20	-	-
Procter&Gam	6865.00	6921.00	6900.00	7012.00	6840.00	11.95	14471.65	6575.70	28	6918.60
ProstarmInfo	132.91	131.36	133.52	133.76	130.50	115.04	208.70	114.64	-	-
Protean EGov	689.25	669.95	685.00	696.00	666.95	469.53	899.95	444.00	-	-
Prozone Rlty	52.45	54.06	52.98	55.50	50.99	710.01	72.77	39.55	-	-
Prudent Corp	3204.30	3223.30	3172.00	3247.50	3170.70	19.84	4105.50	2121.00	-	-
PSPPROJECT	761.75	765.60	762.50	785.00	760.00	36.10	1142.00	569.30	45	767.00
PTC Ind.	23125.00	24685.00	23850.00	24800.00	23755.00	117.09	24800.00	14499.00	-	-
PTCFIN SER	27.29	27.12	27.48	27.51	26.90	890.16	40.51	23.78	8	27.11
Pudumjee [1]	96.16	96.36	96.22	97.59	95.70	73.27	125.40	63.11	10	96.74
Punjab Na [2]	111.92	114.59	111.60	115.10	110.55	18275.90	135.15	98.50	6	114.30
PUNJABNSIND	21.05	21.06	21.10	21.26	20.87	1039.24	32.47	20.46	11	21.04
Puravankara [5]	210.75	209.68	208.99	211.95	206.82	58.46	288.65	160.00	32	210.10
PURPLE STYLE	518.60	531.45	516.50	535.00	516.50	46.94	588.90	501.05	-	-
PVR Inox	1249.40	1343.80	1287.00	1374.80	1276.00	5065.41	1374.80	907.40	-	-
Pyramid Tech	159.71	151.27	157.84	157.90	148.21	115.00	198.69	131.80	-	-

Q

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Quadrant Fut	547.40	534.40	547.40	549.00	531.25	209.07	567.20	248.55	-	-
QualityPower	1648.80	1615.00	1664.00	1666.00	1595.00	318.50	1681.00	581.00	-	-
QUESS	334.45	328.40	332.25	342.75	324.10	239.91	386.35	166.05	20	328.35
Quickheal	140.42	140.97	141.12	145.85	139.14	65.68	371.00	125.00	-	140.90

R

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
RACL Geartch	1593.40	1589.50	1603.00	1618.00	1568.10	15.99	1927.70	921.80	-	-
RadiKhait [2]	4460.10	4495.00	4451.00	4531.20	4425.30	460.03	4747.95	2504.60	86	4500.00
Raghav Prod.	1835.60	1820.90	1859.90	1925.00	1751.00	249.60	1943.70	561.30	-	-
Rail Tel	257.65	254.65	258.45	258.45	252.90	317.22	400.80	245.00	-	-
RAIN [2]	212.63	218.95	211.14	220.89	210.26	4431.42	251.95	99.85	-	218.95
Rainbow Ch.	1239.70	1270.70	1237.00	1288.70	1198.00	409.46	1610.00	1084.00	-	-
Rajoo Engine	56.95	62.37	57.74	62.90	56.76	2912.37	95.06	46.00	-	-
Rajputa Sta	176.06	174.51	177.00	177.00	174.00	174.32	202.22	101.70	-	-
Rajratan Glo	467.30	460.60	468.00	471.80	455.60	74.37	563.95	305.55	-	-
Rajsh.sugar	29.58	27.40	28.69	30.15	27.08	368.63	45.48	22.80	-	27.61
Rallis India [1]	200.30	200.03	199.90	200.47	197.75	320.14	310.10	196.70	17	199.90
Ram Ratna Wr	641.20	637.40	639.05	641.50	630.55	113.96	669.20	268.00	-	-
Ramco Systm	563.50	574.35	563.50	578.00	557.05	49.52	968.20	342.50	71	574.10
Ramco Cem [1]	848.25	845.00	850.25	850.25	833.50	165.10	1214.00	816.80	107	844.10
Ramco Inds. [1]	297.75	299.70	299.00	302.50	295.75	90.55	395.80	230.70	21	299.20
RANE MADRAS	1394.40	1336.40	1380.00	1392.00	1330.00	54.93	1439.45	612.50	29	1337.85
Rashi Perip.	958.25	939.70	958.30	969.00	933.50	216.98	1004.70	313.05	-	-
Rashtr.chem.	108.94	107.58	108.70	108.70	107.02	451.97	157.40	106.10	14	107.65
RatanindiaEn	26.13	25.78	26.21	26.21	25.45	959.21	54.50	24.40	-	-
Rategain Tr.	854.45	854.55	848.05	863.05	845.55	173.48	1050.00	437.00	-	-
Ratnamn [2]	2601.20	2524.30	2617.00	2617.00	2511.00	50.92	3342.35	1900.05	50	2526.80
Ratnaveer Pr	335.25	336.45	336.00	351.90	334.35	5211.84	357.70	130.50	-	-
Ravindra Enr	147.25	148.58	146.60	150.79	145.00	539.79	196.45	117.07	-	-
Raymond	1294.30	1206.70	1287.50	1289.20	1193.70	1774.22	1338.30	320.40	-	1207.40
Raymond Life	649.85	624.85	649.60	651.40	623.10	167.85	1246.40	615.00	-	-
RaymondReal	707.80	701.80	702.45	726.50	690.30	1304.10	741.95	349.00	-	-
RAYS OF BELIEF	232.64	229.68	234.99	236.98	226.11	161.23	267.61	208.03	-	-
RBLBank	414.50	412.00	412.50	416.80	410.30	1657.56	429.55	272.05	73	413.40
RECL	300.00	298.90	300.00	306.85	297.45	6950.42	388.00	286.25	5	299.75
Redington [2]	405.70	406.50	406.00	411.00	401.50	2508.65	419.55	191.25	23	406.30
Redtape	114.80	113.63	114.70	114.70	112.95	146.07	158.99	107.53	-	-
Refex Refrig [2]	265.15	266.35	263.00	275.00	262.40	191.34	382.05	188.00	13	266.90
RegaalResour	85.94	85.49	86.79	86.79	84.67	166.09	103.00	57.27	-	-
Relax Foot [1]	290.55	287.75	290.55	292.00	285.95	77.34	455.45	236.55	39	287.65
Reli Indlnf	681.70	705.05	682.00	740.45	675.00	440.48	963.65	620.50	103	704.10
Reliance	1218.00	1207.70	1212.00	1220.80	1203.50	11880.73	1611.20	1161.00	42	1206.65
Religare ent	227.75	224.92	226.20	228.79	223.86	1529.14	284.85	197.00	-	224.75
Remsons Ind [2]	108.67	104.02	104.99	110.88	101.00	869.36	152.40	75.36	28	104.40
Renaiss.Glo	163.62	168.47	163.62	170.19	162.68	600.67	173.80	85.00	-	-
RENTOMOJO	545.20	618.95	551.40	643.50	550.00	18424.26	643.50	482.45	-	-
REPCO HOME	326.45	339.80	326.45	342.50	325.80	156.58	455.40	325.70	5	339.45
Respon Ind [1]	156.31	159.73	156.00	166.23	155.80	443.32	242.25	117.80	-	160.30
RestaurBrand	95.10	96.08	95.39	96.60	93.40	3125.93	111.15	57.15	-	-
Rhetan TMT L	16.59	17.40	17.41	17.41	17.40	12917.22	34.87	14.42	-	-
RHI Magnesit	373.40	369.45	377.25	381.70	366.80	402.45	508.30	323.05	-	-
Rico Auto [1]	121.83	123.45	122.85	126.19	120.53	908.34	157.90	78.10	60	123.45
RIR Power El	183.49	183.81	184.80	188.35	181.10	593.11	213.94	154.00	-	-
Rishabh Ins	688.40	674.20	689.00	690.00	670.15	103.62	852.00	315.00	-	-
RITES	203.51	200.74	203.50	203.79	199.65	441.77	259.30	175.10	24	200.85
RK Forgings [2]	732.65	716.40	734.00	734.00	714.00	562.43	772.40	460.15	107	715.85
Rolex Rings	188.18	183.67	189.00	189.04	182.61	2364.47	1423.10	99.79	-	-
Rossari Bio	427.45	422.90	429.00	431.65	421.60	38.54	690.30	375.00	-	-
Rossell Tech	1612.10	1622.40	1615.00	1643.40	1581.40	141.89	1699.00	551.90	-	-
Roto Pumps	62.24	62.35	62.24	63.16	61.90	280.04	80.77	47.50	-	-
Route Mobile	430.80	426.50	431.95	433.00	424.40	127.80	799.20	410.70	-	-
RPG lifesc [8]	2933.20	2892.80	2940.00	2948.90	2860.00	15.91	3130.50	1731.25	41	2897.55
RPOWER	20.49	20.32	20.59	20.72	20.20	20012.31	50.70	19.10	-	20.33
RPSG Vent.	833.10	870.15	887.00	916.40	861.00	134.47	1179.00	551.90	-	-
RR Kabel	2789.70	2722.50	2785.00	2789.00	2683.30	502.68	2983.80	1218.90	-	-
RSystems Int [1]	246.30	252.35	248.65	255.30	242.80	1316.81	435.65	213.50	13	252.45
RTNPOWER	6.75	6.70	6.71	6.76	6.68	6903.51	11.94	6.65	-	6.70
Rubicon Rese	1596.80	1575.60	1596.80	1596.80	1553.70	147.28	1899.00	570.75	-	-
RUNWAL ENTE	290.60	279.10	289.00	293.70	275.00	866.94	307.75	275.00	-	-
RUPA & CO [1]	128.99	127.62	128.35	131.48	126.90	114.84	205.25	109.50	13	127.95
RVNL	198.78	195.87	198.00	198.25	194.65	2797.76	400.70	194.05	-	-

S

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
S&W Solar	172.54	168.11	172.54	173.55	167.45	833.68	260.80	148.00	-	-
SaatvikGreen	402.50	405.30	406.80	421.75	399.00	150.42	567.00	328.00	-	-
Safari Ind	1318.00	1319.20	1324.90	1345.00	1306.40	25.29	2507.10	1299.20	-	-
Sagility Ind	43.88	43.11	43.88	44.35	43.00	8174.50	57.89	35.83	-	-
Sai Life Sci	1558.10	1561.80	1558.00	1590.00	1544.10	656.47	1697.00	783.85	-	-
Sai Parenter	522.90	521.65	524.00	528.90	515.40	127.85	706.00	400.00	-	-
Sai Silks	77.36	77.01	77.01	77.55	76.11	218.60	223.03	73.10	-	-
Sakar Health	1048.50	1020.10	1056.60	1058.50	1011.10	62.17	1229.85	345.50	-	-
SAKSOFT [1]	142.74	139.08	142.74	142.74	137.30	207.98	222.50	108.00	22	139.45
SALASAR [1]	4.22	4.17	4.15	4.22	4.13	2607.16	11.53	3.81	-	4.18
SALSTEEL	89.60	86.44	89.20	93.23	85.41	989.98	102.40	26.11	-	86.60
SambhvStee	162.19	158.32	161.24	162.20	157.41	1552.88	171.70	81.42	-	-
Samhi Hotels	149.73	147.25	151.60	151.60	146.00	665.34	217.30	127.00	-	-
Samman Cap.	134.40	132.94	134.90	135.10	132.00	2802.06	192.95	129.00	-	-
Samvard.Moth	160.00	159.20	158.73	159.98	156.99	1181.77	173.27	101.01	-	-
Sanathan Tex	525.65	522.85	525.65	530.95	512.90	33.87	544.30	352.60	-	-
Sandhar	558.10	561.30	561.85	565.95	553.10	92.07	764.10	423.90	18	562.65
Sandur Mang.	183.38	181.19	182.88	182.90	179.67	317.13	273.00	170.51	-	-
Sangam India	642.40	624.05	636.90	649.40	620.55	27.37	692.95	391.50	25	626.85
Sanghvi Mov [1]	419.50	410.65	423.95	423.95	408.25	213.15	532.40	221.00	22	411.65
Sanofi ind	3047.00	3023.80	3047.00	3051.80	3010.00	8.73	4896.00	3000.00	20	3024.80
Sansera Engg	4232.90	4261.70	4226.00	4328.00	4209.20	125.96	4743.50	1382.70	-	-
Sanstar	104.07	104.23	103.55	105.09	102.60	85.78	137.49	74.30	-	-
Sapphire Fd	215.16	215.03	215.90	216.80	213.64	168.96	310.50	139.91	-	-
SaraswatiSDL	68.57	66.20	69.29	69.99	65.51	88.46	90.00	46.15	-	-
Sarda EnMin [1]	500.70	499.35	500.90	505.00	497.50	189.89	624.00	452.75	20	499.40
Saregama (I) [1]	503.70	503.75	502.20	507.90	496.10	160.90	574.85	305.65	42	504.15
SarveshwarFd	3.58	3.61	3.60	3.69	3.57	2446.54	6.64	2.50	-	-
SASKEN COMM	1679.50	1665.10	1684.30	1708.60	1656.00	11.59	2785.05	993.05	29	1658.40
SATIN	228.35	223.79	229.90	239.40	221.25	1191.62	274.20	136.25	6	224.50
SBC Exports	61.70	61.77	61.80	62.62	61.05	13158.77	64.43	22.06	-	-
SBFC Fin.	83.28	81.10	83.27	83.50	80.81	1102.48	123.00	79.60	-	-
SBI FUNDS MAN	502.85	501.20	501.95	503.00	494.30	1247.45	624.95	494.00	-	-
SBILIFE	1750.00	1726.10	1735.00	1750.50	1701.80	1030.11	2132.90	1653.00	67	1714.10
SchlossBanga	582.70	602.45	580.00	607.25	576.50	627.33	607.25	384.50	-	-
SCHNEIDER [2]	1274.00	1256.20	1276.00	1276.00	1240.00	119.14	1548.30	572.60	155	1254.65
SE INVESTM [1]	83.10	84.23	83.31	85.48	83.11	1691.83	94.84	30.00	31	84.08
Sedemac Mech	3399.60	3425.60	3398.00	3478.40	3360.20	116.38	3650.00	1413.10	-	-
Senco Gold	318.75	320.60	318.75	326.30	315.00	1246.46	430.00	276.00	-	-
Senores Phar	1388.60	1389.60	1399.90	1424.00	1380.00	197.47	1599.00	700.75	-	-
SEPC	5.05	5.03	5.06	5.08	5.00	3570.45	12.19	4.65	-	-
Servote.Pwr	72.06	71.15	72.06	72.29	70.75	332.10	141.50	57.51	-	-
Sesha.paper [2]	233.87	231.31	234.05	235.00	230.20	260.19	311.00	210.15	17	232.00
Seshaasai Te	369.70	369.70	364.15	374.45	364.15	34.51	434.70	209.11	-	-
SFL [5]	623.40	620.05	625.90	628.90	615.40	81.57	832.00	460.75	44	619.85
SG Mart L	742.85	752.25	743.00	774.80	736.55	152.65	860.60	313.10	-	-
SGFinserveLt	662.15	663.70	666.00	674.00	656.00	231.76	727.45	323.00	-	-
Sh Renu Sug [1]	22.65	22.78	22.58	23.27	22.45	11798.51	31.34	20.92	-	22.76
Shadowfax Te	288.00	292.85	289.70	296.35	287.00	5496.57	296.35	98.55	-	-
Shaily Eng	3100.30	3085.30	3085.00	3119.20	3064.20	60.56	3615.20	1770.90	-	-
SHAKTI PUMPS	449.35	447.40	451.00	454.70	445.00	441.29	834.85	441.00	29	448.20
Shank Jewel	92.21	96.51	91.79	99.72	91.36	6866.80	115.90	86.58	-	-
Shankara Bld	125.58	119.98	125.58	125.89	118.10	102.79	156.45	98.50	-	119.65
Shankara Bui	1301.50	1302.00	1311.60	1326.00	1275.60	111.59	1380.00	636.00	-	-
ShantiGoIInt	336.65	341.05	340.00	351.00	335.30	3025.04	351.00	155.00	-	-
Sharda Crop	741.75	742.05	744.00	749.00	732.00	70.58	1297.80	698.15	10	742.60
SHARDA [2]	928.55	924.85	928.90	933.95	916.25	42.59	1189.00	701.85	16	925.05
ShareInd Sec	211.40	207.27	212.10	212.90	206.00	791.11	233.35	115.36	-	-
Shilchar Tec	4094.20	4000.90	4095.00	4100.00	3990.60	15.95	5399.00	2852.50	-	-
SHILPA M [1]	1073.70	1071.20	1072.40	1086.80	1055.10	433.19	1095.65	260.00	134	1072.10
Shipping Cor	289.00	285.35	288.05	289.00	283.90	1736.88	368.50	195.45	8	285.05
Shipping Cor	37.68	37.85	37.86	38.40	37.36	227.04	55.00	34.30	-	-
Shiprocket L	131.43	133.11	130.93	134.50	127.76	4177.51	156.90	116.64	-	-
Shivalik Bi	1099.60	1099.30	1111.60	1129.10	1088.60	170.00	1215.70	368.60	-	-
Shivalik Ras	386.25	365.05	388.10	388.10	363.35	64.88	471.00	206.40	-	-
SHK	142.32	141.62	141.61	143.00	139.85	190.75	251.70	111.70	-	141.10
SHOPPER ST [5]	398.15	392.40	400.70	400.70	389.25	16.54	558.60	267.00	-	389.90
Shree Cem	22210.00	21780.00	21905.00	22160.00	21690.00	43.00	30274.00	21365.00	52	21738.30
ShreejiShipp	796.50	802.10	796.90	808.00	796.90	1943.74	808.00	222.00	-	-
SHREEPUSHK	510.10	517.50	505.00	521.85	505.00	50.64	544.75	273.40	36	516.75
Shringar Hou	223.32	221.03	223.99	225.00	219.20	376.22	266.50	166.00	-	-
Shriram Fin	965.05	948.00	959.00	960.00	930.00	6096.55	1153.70	646.50	-	-
Shriram Pist	4405.00	4411.60	4370.00	4475.90	4359.80	52.24	4843.00	2525.80	-	-
Shriram Prop	68.13	68.05	68.00	69.05	67.13	195.95	99.44	60.57	-	-
Shukra Pharm	72.58	68.32	73.33	74.10	67.61	7458.02	75.40	40.06	-	-
ShyamMetalic	1054.00	1067.30	1061.60	1072.00	1043.70	514.92	1148.00	746.00	-	-
Siemens Ener	3307.50	3344.00	3300.00	3406.90	3276.30	426.58	3968.00	2115.00	-	-
Siemens Ltd. [2]	3854.00	3793.00	3848.00	3848.00	3772.00	247.48	4149.40	2827.00	105	3804.45
Sigachi Ind	29.89	29.36	29.94	30.85	29.10	1800.98	40.80	16.65	-	-
Sigma Solve	45.24	45.71	45.91	47.50	44.42	120.22	64.30	35.46	-	-
SignatureGlo	719.35	712.50	717.60	722.40	710.10	202.72	1153.90	705.20	-	-
Signpost Ind	262.10	267.45	260.05	273.35	258.45	64.34	336.80	191.41	-	-
Sika Interpl	1029.30	1068.60	1034.40	1080.00	1019.10	41.21	1359.40	870.10	-	-
Silver Tou.	137.68	135.11	138.00	138.69	134.50	93.39	1690.